Foreword

As a learner driver, it is important that you have all the information you need to drive safely and in a socially responsible way on our roads. Before you drive on a public road or in a public place you must have a learner permit or a driving licence for the vehicle you want to drive. In most cases you must also pass a driver theory test to show that you understand what you must do to drive safely. The questions in the car, tractor, work vehicle,motorcycle and moped driver theory tests, which are all in this book, are designed to test your knowledge and also to make you think about the different situations you will come across as a driver. By studying the learning material and passing the test you will have taken an important first step to becoming a safe driver. It is essential that you then apply your knowledge when you are on the road.

Learning to drive needs time and patience, and the best way to learn is to take driving lessons while practising as much as you can with an experienced driver. Learners taking out a first learner permit for a car must take the Essential Driver Training (EDT) programme, and learners taking out a learner permit for a motorcycle must take Initial Basic Training (IBT) – for more information, see www.rsa.ie. It is important to find an Approved Driving Instructor (ADI) that you are comfortable with and to listen carefully to the advice you get. Ask for help if you aren't sure of something and look up your copy of the Rules of the Road for guidance.

Finally, remember that driving should be enjoyable, and we wish you many years of safe driving.

Introduction and how to obtain a driving licence

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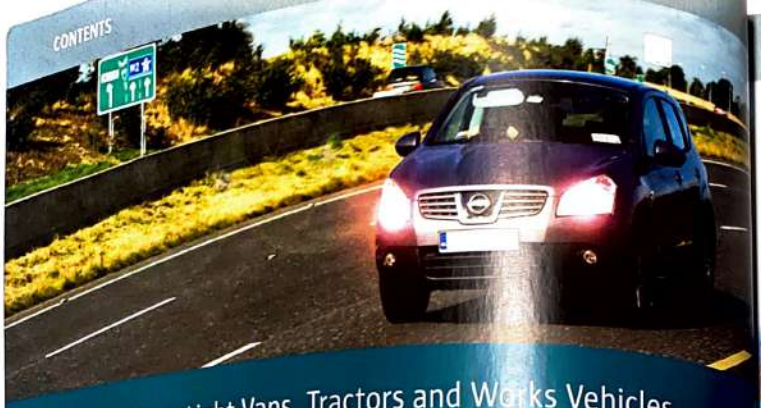

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Introduction

To drive a motor vehicle on the public road in Ireland, you must hold a driving licence or a learner permit that covers the particular category of vehicle you plan to drive. For licensing purposes, there are fifteen categories of vehicle, identified by code letters – for example a motorcar is category B, a moped is category AM.

With a learner permit, a number of restrictions apply, the most important of which is that for most types of vehicle you must be accompanied at all times by the holder of a full driving licence in the category of vehicle you are driving.

Who must take the driver theory test?

Before you can apply for your first learner permit in any driving licence category, you must have passed a driver theory test that relates to that category, and you must submit the driver theory test certificate to the licensing authority within two years of passing the test.

There are four different driver theory tests; which one you take depends on the category of vehicle you are planning to drive. This book covers all questions for the Car, Motorcycle, Works vehicles and Tractor driver theory tests, and different parts of the book are relevant to different tests, as shown below.

Category of vehicle you intend to drive		Parts of this book you need to study for driver theory test
B	Car and light van BW	Parts 1 and 2
BE	Car and light van with trailer	Parts 1 and 2
W	Tractor and works vehicle	Parts 1 and 2
A	Motorcycle	Parts 1 and 3
A1	Small motorcycle	Parts 1 and 3
A2	Restricted motorcycle	Parts 1 and 3
AM	Moped	Parts 1 and 3

Note that you do not have to pass the same theory test more than once. For example, if you pass the theory test for category B and obtain a learner permit for category B, and you subsequently wish to obtain a learner permit for category BE, you are not required to take another driver theory test, provided you still have a valid learner permit or driving licence for category B.

Preparing for the driver theory test

You should use this book, and/or the Driver Theory Test CD-ROM as well as the Rules of the Road to prepare for the driver theory test. This book contains the actual questions that will be asked in your Car Motorcycle Tractor and driver theory tests, along with the correct answer and a brief explanation. All of the questions and learning materials contained in this book along with practice exams are also available via the online learning service at https://dttstore.prometric.com/

If you spend sufficient time and effort preparing for your test, you should not find it difficult, and you should pass. More importantly, the knowledge you gain in preparing for the test will help to make you a better and a safer driver.

Learning App now available for iOS devices

Our new iOS Learning App helps you to pass first time!
This Driver Theory Test learning app offers you unlimited access to the Official Driver Theory Test learning material, and also tracks your progress as you learn.

In addition, you will be able to complete Official Driver Theory Test sample tests, ensuring you are fully prepared and confident on the day of your theory test.

- Learn anywhere, at any time
- Lifetime access
- The only official app available to help you pass first time

To download the app visit:
https://www.theorytest.ie/learning-app/

How to Obtain a Category B Driving Licence (Car)

Test Preparation

- Study The Official Driver Theory Test (DTT) Question & Answers Book or The Official Driver Theory Test CD-ROM. Available to purchase at **www.theorytest.ie** and also at major book stores in Ireland.
- Some Approved Driving Instructors (ADIs) help prepare learners for their Driver Theory Test.

Theory Test

- Book Category B Theory Test online via **www.theorytest.ie** or by telephoning **1890 606 106**
- Sit & pass Theory Test
- Obtain DTT Certificate

Learner Permit

- Apply for Category B learner permit at any National Driver Licence Service (NDLS) Public Office See **www.ndls.ie**

ADI & Sponsor

- Study the learning to drive process. Get to know what you should expect and what if any preparatory work you need to do ahead of your first formal driving lesson.
- Choose an ADI and a Sponsor so you can begin the process of learning to drive. Scan here to watch this video on the role of a Sponsor:

EDT

- In addition to the standard formal driving lessons, learners are now required to complete the Essential Driver training (EDT programme)
- When advised you are ready, complete each of the 12 hours EDT with an RSA registered Advanced Driver Instructor (ADI). Your ADI will let you know when you are ready for your next EDT lesson. Scan here to watch a video on Essential Driver Training
- Complete planned practice sessions with your Sponsor
- Ensure Official Log Book is completed
- Visit 'MY EDT' on RSA website to ensure all your EDT lessons records have been uploaded

Note: Be guided by your ADI on when to practice your driving and what to practice.

Practical Driving Test

- Once your ADI advises you to, you should book your Practical Driving Test via **www.drivingtest.ie.**

Note: It will not be possible to sit your test until the RSA have received confirmation that your EDT has been completed

- Sit and pass Practical Driving Test. Scan here to watch this video on the Day of the driving test
- Obtain Certificate of Competency

Driving Licence

- Apply for Category B Driving Licence at any National Driver Licence Service (NDLS) Public Office. See **www.ndls.ie.**
- Obtain Category B Driving Licence.

IMPORTANT

Continue to practice what you have learned. Drive in a safe and socially responsible manner to keep you, your family and friends as well as other road users safe.

How to Obtain a Category A Driving Licence (Motorcycle)

Test Preparation

- Study The Official Driver Theory Test Question & Answers Book or The Official Driver Theory Test CD-ROM. Available to purchase at **www.theorytest.ie** and also at major book stores in Ireland.
- Some Approved Driving Instructors (ADIs) help prepare learners for their Driver Theory Test.

Theory Test

- Book Category AM Theory Test online via **www.theorytest.ie** or by telephoning **1890 606 106**
- Sit & pass Theory Test
- Obtain DTT Certificate

Learner Permit

- Apply for relevant Motorcycle category learner permit at any National Driver Licence Service (NDLS) Public Office. See **www.ndls.ie**.
- Read the Initial Basic Training (IBT) information book.

ADI

- Choose an Approved Driving Instructor (ADI) so you can begin the process of Initial Basic Training (IBT). IBT is a mandatory training course that teaches basic riding skills to learner motorcyclists.

IBT

- Complete at least 16 hours of Initial Basic Training (IBT) with an RSA registered Advanced Driver Instructor (ADI).
- Ensure Official Log Book is completed
- Be guided by your instructor as to when you should apply for your practical driving test
- Obtain Certification of Satisfactory Completion

Practical Driving Test

- Book Practical Driving Test via **www.drivingtest.ie**.

Note: It will not be possible to sit your test until the RSA have received confirmation that your IBT has been completed.

- Sit and pass Practical Driving Test
- Scan to watch this video on the day of your practical driving test
- Obtain Certificate of Competency

Driving Licence

- Apply for relevant Motorcycle category Driving Licence at any National Driver Licence Service (NDLS) Public Offices. See **www.ndls.ie**.
- Obtain relevant category of Motorcycle Driving Licence.

IMPORTANT

Continue to practice what you have learned. Ride your motorcycle in a safe and socially responsible manner to keep you and other road users safe.

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Road signs, markings and traffic regulations

As you drive along any road you are receiving information all the time, and you need to be able to take in this information and respond as necessary. Much of the information that you need to understand comes from regulatory road signs and markings that tell you things that you must do.

The questions in this section are designed to check that you know:

The meaning of all the road signs and markings that you might meet when you are driving:

- Regulatory signs and markings that tell you things you must do;
- Signs that give you advance warning of when you should take special care; and
- Motorway signs;

The regulations relating to speed;

The regulations relating to parking; and

The meaning of the various hand signals that a Garda might make, and the hand signals you might need to make yourself.

Regulatory traffic signs

Regulatory traffic signs are those that you must obey. Most of them are circular in shape, have a red border and symbols or text in black. The STOP and YIELD signs have unique shapes so that they cannot be confused with any other signs.

What does this sign mean?
Stop your vehicle.

This sign appears at junctions where a minor road joins a major road. You must stop your vehicle completely at a STOP sign.

What must a driver do when this sign is accompanied by a white stop line on the road?
Stop at the line.

When accompanied by a STOP sign, the white stop line indicates the point at which you must stop your vehicle.

What must a driver do when this sign is NOT accompanied by a white stop line on the road?
Stop at the sign.

Where a STOP sign is not accompanied by a white stop line, you must stop at the sign.

What does this sign mean at a junction?
Yield to traffic on the major road.

At a junction, the YIELD sign tells you that you must give way to traffic on a major road ahead. This means that you must slow down and be prepared to stop.

What does this sign mean at a roundabout? ABMW0005RU19

Yield to traffic coming from the right.

Yield to traffic coming from the right, or already on the roundabout.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0006R

Straight ahead only.

This sign tells you that you must proceed straight ahead. This sign is usually displayed on the entry to a one-way street.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0007

Turn left only.

This sign tells you that you must turn left. It is usually displayed at a junction where all traffic must turn left – for example, in a one-way system that incorporates a junction.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0008U19

Turn right only.

This sign tells you that you must turn right. It is usually displayed at a junction where all traffic must turn right – for example, in a one-way system that incorporates a junction.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0009R

Turn left ahead.

This sign tells you that you must turn left ahead. It is usually displayed on the approach to a one-way system.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0010U19

You must turn right ahead.

This sign tells you that you must turn right ahead. It is usually displayed on the approach to a one-way system.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0011RU19

Keep left.

This sign tells you that you must keep left. It is usually displayed at a traffic island in the centre of the road and also used on occasion to control traffic at roadworks.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0012RU19

Keep right.

This sign tells you that you must keep right. It is usually found in a one-way system where the traffic is required to keep to the right and also used on occasion to control traffic at roadworks.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0013U19

Pass either side.

This sign tells you that traffic may pass on either side of the traffic island.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0014RU19

No entry ahead.

This sign tells you that you must not proceed in the direction of the arrow. This is displayed to prevent traffic going in the wrong direction – for example, the wrong way up a one-way street.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0015R

No right turn.

This sign is displayed at a junction where you may not turn right.

ABMW0016RU19

What does this sign mean?
No right turn.

This sign is displayed at a junction where you may not turn right.

ABMW0017RU19

What does this sign mean?
No left turn.

This sign is displayed at a junction where you may not turn left.

ABMW0018RU19

What does this sign mean?
U-turn not permitted.

This sign tells you that you are not permitted to make a U-turn. It is commonly displayed on approach to junctions on dual carriageways.

Drivers should also be aware that U-turns are also not permitted anywhere there is a continuous white line along the centre of the road or on a one-way street.

ABMW0019U19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum speed is is 30 km/h.

This sign tells you that the maximum legal speed limit permitted for this section of road is 30 km/h. These signs are commonly found in slow zones in residential areas.

ABMW0020U19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum speed is 50 km/h.

This sign tells you that the maximum legal speed limit permitted for this section of road is 50 km/h.

ABMW0021U19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum speed is 60 km/h.

This sign tells you that the maximum legal speed limit permitted for this section of road is 60 km/h.

ABMW0022RU19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum speed is 80km/h.

This sign tells you that the maximum legal speed limit permitted for this section of road is 80 km/h.

ABMW0023U19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum speed is 100km/h.

This sign tells you that the maximum legal speed limit permitted for this section of road is 100 km/h.

ABMW0024U19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum speed is 120km/h.

This sign tells you that the maximum legal speed limit permitted for this section of road is 120 km/h.

ABMW0025U19

What do these signs together mean?
Parking permitted during the times shown.

These signs tells you that parking is permitted in both directions, but only at the times shown on the information plate.

ABMW0026

What does this sign mean?
Parking prohibited.

This sign tells you that parking is prohibited in both directions.

ABMW0027U19

What does this sign mean?
Clearway - no stopping or parking during the times shown.

A Clearway sign means that stopping or parking is not permitted in this area during the times shown on the information plate.

ABMW0028U19

What does this sign mean?
Disc parking operates during the time shown.

This sign tells you that vehicles must display a parking disc when parked during the hours shown on the information plate.

ABMW0029RU19

What does this sign mean?
Designated rank for taxis.

A Taxi Rank sign indicates that this is an area reserved for taxis, and parking or stopping by other road users is not permitted.

ABMW0030U19

What does this sign mean?
Start of cycle track.

This sign indicates the start of a cycle track. If the track is bounded by a broken white line, other road users should avoid using it wherever possible. If it is bounded by a continuous white line, drivers of cars and other vehicles must not drive on it.

ABMW0033RU19

What do these signs together mean?
Pedestrianised street ahead - traffic not allowed except during times shown.

When posted together these signs tells you that there is a Pedestrianised street ahead and that traffic is not allowed to enter except during the times stated on the information plate.

ABMW0034U19

What does this sign mean?
Maximum permitted weight is 3 tonnes.

This sign tells you that that you must not enter this area if your vehicle is over 3 tonnes or 3,000 kg

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ABMW0038U19

What does this sign mean?
Parking of vehicles exceeding the weight shown is not allowed.

This sign tells you that you must not park in this area if your vehicle is over the weight limit indicated.

ABMW0039U19

What does this sign mean?
No overtaking.

This sign tells you that overtaking is prohibited. These signs are usually found in places where overtaking may be dangerous, such as in areas with reduced visibility.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0040RU19

Only buses, cyclists and taxis are allowed to use the lane ahead during the hours indicated.

This sign tells you there is a with-flow near side bus lane ahead on the left – that is, one where the buses move in the same direction as the traffic to their right. The information plate tells the times when the bus lane is in operation. Only buses, taxis and cyclists may use the bus lane during those hours.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0041RU19

With-flow bus and cycle lane ahead on left.

This sign tells you there is a with-flow near side bus lane ahead to the left. Only buses, taxis and cyclists may use the bus lane during the stated operational hours.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0042RU19

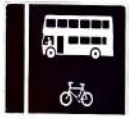
With-flow bus and cycle lane on left.

This sign indicates a near side with-flow bus lane on the left. Only buses, taxis and cyclists may use the bus lane during the stated operational hours.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0043RU19

Bus and cycle lane ahead on right.

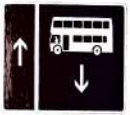
This sign tells you that there is an off side bus lane ahead on the right. Only buses, taxis and cyclists may use the bus lane during the stated operational hours.



What does this sign mean? ABMW0044RAU19

With-flow bus lane on the right.

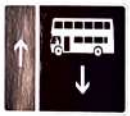
This sign indicates a with-flow off-side bus lane on the right. Only buses, taxis and cyclists may use the bus lane during the stated operational hours.



What does this sign mean? ABMW0045RU19

Contra-flow bus lane on the right.

This sign tells you that you must drive on the left and not use the contra-flow bus lane day or night. A contraflow bus lane is one where the buses are going in the opposite direction.



What does this sign mean? ABMW0046U19

Contra-flow bus lane.

This sign tells you that you must drive on the left and not use the contra-flow bus lane day or night. A contra-flow bus lane is one where the buses are going in the opposite direction.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0050RAU19

Tram lane on right.

This sign tells you there is an off-side tram lane on the right. Drivers should also be aware that there might be pedestrians in the area.

What does this sign mean? ABMW2

Tram lane on left.

This sign tells you there e is a tram lane on the left. Be aware that there might be pedestrians in the area and crossing the road.

Warning signs

Warning signs give you advance notice of changes in the road layout, of junctions and bends ahead, and of anything that might cause a hazard. Most warning signs are diamond shaped with black symbols on a yellow background.

You don't have to do anything when you see a warning sign, but in many cases you will need to make some change in your driving. For example, you might need to slow down as you approach a sharp bend or when you know there is a school ahead.

ABMW0051R

What does this sign mean?
Junction ahead with roads of lesser importance.

This sign gives advance warning of a junction ahead with minor roads on either side. Be aware that vehicles may be emerging from the minor roads.

ABMW0052RU19

What does this sign mean?
Y-junction where main road bears to the left.

This sign gives advance warning of a Y-junction with a minor road ahead. The wider arm of the Y indicates the course of the main road.

ABMW0053R

What does this sign mean?
Staggered crossroads ahead with roads of equal importance.

This sign gives advance warning of a staggered junction ahead with roads to the left and right. Be aware that vehicles may be emerging from these roads.

ABMW0054RU19

What does this sign mean?
Crossroads ahead with roads of equal importance.

This sign gives advance warning of a crossroad junction ahead where the roads are of equal importance. At this type of junction you should yield to traffic approaching from the right and traffic already turning.

ABMW0055R

What does this sign mean?
T-junction ahead with roads of equal importance.

This sign gives advance warning of a T-junction ahead with a road of equal importance. You must give way to traffic already on the road you are joining.

ABMW0056RU19/57RU19

What does this sign mean?
Y-junction ahead with roads of equal importance.

This sign gives advance warning of a Y-junction ahead with roads of equal importance. Approach such a junction with caution and be prepared to react to any changes in the traffic situation.

ABMW0058RU19

What does this sign mean?
Crossroads with major road ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a crossroads junction with a major road ahead. Be prepared to stop.

ABMW0059RU19

What does this sign mean?
T-junction ahead with a road of major importance.

This sign gives advance warning of a T-junction ahead with a major road. Be prepared to yield or stop as necessary.

ABMW0060RU19

What does this sign mean?
Crossroads with dual carriageway ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a crossroads junction at a dual carriageway ahead. Drivers need to be observant, taking extra care for traffic coming from each direction. Yield and/or stop as appropriate.

ABMW0061RU19

What does this sign mean?
T-junction with dual carriageway ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a T-junction at a dual carriageway ahead. Drivers need to be observant, taking extra care for traffic coming from each direction. Yield and/or stop as appropriate.

ABMW0062RU19

What does this sign mean?
Traffic merging from the left.

This sign gives advance warning of traffic merging from the left. You should expect vehicles to join from the left. You may need to slow down, allowing them to merge safely.

ABMW0063RU19

What does this sign mean?
Traffic merging/diverging ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of roads both merging (entering onto the main road) and diverging (exiting the main road). Drivers should be prepared for traffic changing speed and direction as vehicles enter or exit at the junctions on the left ahead.

ABMW0064RU19

What does this sign mean?
Roundabout ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a roundabout ahead. You must be prepared to yield to vehicles already on the roundabout or coming from the right.

ABMW0065RU19

What does this sign mean?
Mini-roundabout ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a mini-roundabout ahead. You must be prepared to yield to vehicles already on the roundabout or coming from the right.

ABMW0066U19

What does this sign mean?
Dangerous corner ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a dangerous corner to the left. You may need to slow down and react to any changes in the traffic situation ahead.

ABMW0067U19

What does this sign mean?
Dangerous bend ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a dangerous bend to the left. You may need to slow down and react to any changes in the traffic situation ahead.

ABMW0068U19

What does this sign mean?
Series of dangerous corners ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a series of dangerous corners ahead. You should slow down and react to any changes in the traffic situation.

ABMW0069RU19

What does this sign mean?
Series of dangerous bends ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a series of dangerous bends ahead. You should slow down and react to any changes in the traffic situation.

ABMW0070RU19

What does this sign mean?
Sharp change of direction to the right.

This sign gives advance warning of a sharp change of direction to the right. You should slow down as you approach the hazard.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0071RU19
Road narrows on the left.

This sign gives advance warning that the road narrows on the left ahead. You should show caution and prepare to adjust your road position.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0072U19
Road narrows on both sides.

This sign gives advance warning that the road is narrowing on both sides ahead. You should show caution and prepare to slow down.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0073RU19
Road divides ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that the road divides ahead. You should prepare to move to the left.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0074
Dual carriageway ends.

This sign gives advance warning of the end of a dual carriageway. You will soon be entering a 2-way road.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0075U19
Two-way traffic ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of two-way traffic ahead, with oncoming traffic in the opposite lane.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0076U19
Steep descent ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a steep descent/downward slope ahead. You should react accordingly by adjusting speed and selecting the appropriate gear.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0077U19
Steep ascent ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a steep ascent/upward hill ahead. You should react by selecting the appropriate gear.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0078U19
Low bridge up ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that you are approaching a low bridge, with restricted headroom as shown on the sign.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0079
Overhead electric cables.

This sign gives advance warning of electric cables overhead. Drivers with a high load should be particularly careful.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0080R
Level crossing ahead unguarded by gates or barriers.

This sign gives advanced warning of an unguarded level crossing ahead. This is a crossing without gates or barriers and you should cross it with extreme caution.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0081
Level crossing ahead guarded by gates or barriers.

This sign gives advance warning of a railway crossing ahead that is protected by gates or lifting barriers. You should be prepared to stop and follow the required procedure.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0082U19
Level crossing ahead protected by lights and barriers.

This sign gives advance warning of a railway level crossing ahead protected by lights and barriers. The crossing may also have an audible warning alarm. You should be prepared to stop.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0083
The driver must stop when red lights show.

This sign gives advance warning that you must stop when red lights show. This sign may be displayed at a railway level crossing.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0084RU19
Automatic level crossing ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of an automatic level crossing ahead. Drivers should approach with caution and be prepared to slow down or stop as necessary.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0085R
Sharp rise in the road ahead - for example, a humpback bridge.

This sign gives advance warning of a hump in the road. You should adjust your speed accordingly.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0086RU19
Sharp depression or dip ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a dip or depression in the road ahead which may be hidden and could obscure your view of oncoming traffic. You should reduce your speed accordingly and be aware that overtaking is dangerous in these areas.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0087RU19
Series of bumps or hollows ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a series of bumps or hollows ahead. Be prepared to reduce your speed as necessary.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0088U19
Slippery road ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of the potential danger of slippery road surfaces ahead.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0089RU19
Unprotected quay, canal or river ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of an unprotected area of water ahead. You should be cautious due to the extreme danger.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0090RU19
Traffic signals ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a traffic light controlled junction ahead. This sign is generally found in areas where the lights may not be visible to drivers in good time – for example, following a bend in the road.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0091RU19
School ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a school ahead. You should adjust your speed and react accordingly as there may be children in the area.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0092U19/93U19
School children crossing ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be school children crossing the road ahead, slow down if required and be prepared to stop.

What do these signs together mean? ABMW0094U19

Beware of children crossing.

These signs are usually displayed in residential areas, and they give advance warning that children might be crossing ahead. You should proceed cautiously and be prepared to stop suddenly.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0095R

Accompanied horses and ponies ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be horses on the road ahead. You should show due regard for horses and their riders.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0096U19

Possibility of cattle or farm animals ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be cattle or other farm animals on the road ahead. Slow down if required and be prepared to stop.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0097U19

Possibility of sheep ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be sheep on the road ahead. Slow down if required and be prepared to stop.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0098U19

Deer or wild animals ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be deer or other wild animals coming onto the roadway. Be prepared to slow down or stop suddenly if required.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0099RU19

Crosswinds ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be crosswinds ahead. Crosswinds can affect the stability of your vehicle on the road. Be prepared to slow down if necessary.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0100R

Pedestrian crossing ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a pedestrian crossing ahead. You should show caution and be prepared to stop.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0101RU19

Tunnel ahead.

This sign gives advance warning of a tunnel ahead. You should be aware of the procedures to follow when entering a tunnel – which include keeping a safe distance from the vehicle ahead or removing sunglasses.

ABMW0102RU19

What does this sign mean?
Danger of falling rocks ahead.

This sign gives advance warning that there is a danger of rocks and other debris falling onto the road. Drive with caution.

ABMW0103RU19

What does this sign mean?
Possibility of low flying aircraft.

This sign gives advance warning that there may be low-flying aircraft in the area. Low-flying aircraft can cause distraction due to a sudden loud noise.

ABMW0104RU19

What does this sign mean?
A driver must drive on the left-hand side.

This sign is generally in areas where tourists might be travelling and reminds motorists to drive on the left. These signs are commonly found around airports and ferry ports.

ABMW0105RU19

What does this sign mean?
Tramway crossing ahead.

This sign gives advance warning sign of a tram crossing ahead. You should be prepared to stop and yield to the tram, if required.

Motorway signs

Driving on a motorway presents a different set of challenges. In general, traffic is moving faster than on national or regional roads, and you need to plan your journey more carefully in advance.

Only drivers with a full licence may drive on a motorway.

ABMW0109RU19

What does this sign mean?
Entry to motorway.

This is a motorway information sign informing road users they are now entering the motorway and must obey motorway rules. This sign usually appears beside a motorway ahead sign.

ABMW0110U19

What does this sign mean?
Motorway ends 500 metres ahead.

This is a motorway information sign that tells you that the motorway will end in 500 metres ahead. Motorway rules will no longer apply, for example a lower speed limit may be applicable.

ABMW0111RU19

What does this sign mean?
End of motorway.

This sign indicates the end of the motorway. You are leaving the motorway and its rules will no longer apply.

ABMW0112R

What does this sign mean?
Three hundred meters to the next exit.

This is a motorway information sign that tells you that the next exit off the motorway is 300 metres ahead.

ABMW0113R

What does this sign mean?
200 metres to the next exit.

This is a motorway information sign that tells you that the next exit off the motorway is 200 metres ahead.

ABMW0114R

What does this sign mean?
100 metres to the next exit.

This is a motorway information sign that tells you that the next exit off the motorway is 100 metres ahead.

ABMW3U19

What does this sign mean when displayed on the approach to a toll plaza?
Toll collector operating lane.

This sign is used at toll plazas to direct traffic into a lane where the toll charge may be paid directly to a cashier. This lane would normally be used by motorists who have neither the exact change nor an electronic tag on their vehicle.

ABMW4U19

What does this sign mean when displayed on the approach to a toll plaza?
Coin basket in this lane.

This sign is used at toll plazas to direct traffic into a lane where the toll charge may be paid by putting the exact change into an automatic coin machine. This lane usually has a height barrier fitted to prevent large vehicles using it.

ABMW5U19

What does this sign mean when displayed on the approach to a toll plaza?
Electronic toll accepted in any lane.

This sign is used at toll plazas to direct traffic into a lane where the toll charge is collected electronically. When the vehicle passes through the plaza it is identified by means of an electronic tag fitted to the front windscreen. Payment will be collected via the users account. Only vehicles fitted with the tags are allowed to use those lanes.

Road works signs

Road works present a variety of hazards that you need to take into account when you are driving. Always drive with extra care through road works, and take note of the particular signs that are posted.

Like other warning signs, most road works signs are diamond shaped and have a black border and black symbols or text on an orange background.

ABMW0115U19

What does this sign mean?
Roadworks ahead.

This warning sign tells you that there are roadworks ahead. You should approach with caution and be alert for a change in the road surface, and for the presence of machinery and road workers.

ABMW0116

What does this sign mean?
Uneven surface ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the surface ahead is uneven and you should approach with caution.

ABMW0117RU19

What does this sign mean?
Slippery road.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the surface ahead is slippery due to mud or debris and there is an increased risk of skidding.

ABMW0118RU19

What does this sign mean?
Road narrows from left.

This warning sign tells you that there are roadworks up ahead where the road narrows from the left creating a potential hazard.

ABMW0119RU19

What does this sign mean?
Road narrows from right.

Where there are roadworks up ahead, this warning sign tells you that the road narrows from the right creating a potential hazard.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0120RU19
Road narrows on both sides.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the road narrows on both sides creating a potential hazard. Be prepared to slow down and drive with extra care.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0121RU19
Flagman ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the traffic flow ahead is controlled manually by a flagman. Be aware and follow directions given by the flagman.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0122RU19
Temporary traffic signals ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that temporary traffic signals are in use ahead. You should prepare to slow down, approach with caution and comply with the signal displayed.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0123U19
Two-way traffic.

This warning sign tells you that during roadworks there will be two-way traffic in operation ahead. Continue to drive with extra care.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0124RU19
Nearside lane of two closed.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that that the nearside (left hand) lane is closed ahead. If you are in this lane you will need to move to the offside (right hand) lane when it is safe to do so.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0125RU19
Nearside lane of three closed.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that that the nearside (left hand) lane of three is closed up ahead. If you are in this lane you will need to move to the centre (middle) lane when it is safe to do so.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0127RU19
Offside lane closed ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that that the offside (right hand) lane of three is closed ahead. Drivers in the nearside or centre lanes should be aware that traffic may merge from the right.

What does this sign mean? ABMW5
Loose chippings on road.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the road ahead has been resurfaced and there may be loose chippings. You should reduce speed while driving through this area as the loose chippings could affect your vehicles road holding and braking .

What does this sign mean? ABMW7
Traffic queues likely ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that there may be traffic queues ahead, possibly due to temporary traffic lights at the works. Proceed with caution.

What does this sign mean? ABMW5U19
Uneven surface.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the road surface may be uneven, possibly due to the resurfacing of part of a lane. Proceed with caution.

At roadworks, what does this sign mean? ABMW0132RU19
Proceed with caution.

This traffic control sign tells you that you may proceed with caution through road works.

At roadworks, what does this sign mean? ABMW0133RU19
Stop before or at the sign.

This traffic control sign at roadworks means you must stop.

What do these signs together mean? ABMW0134RU19

End of detour.

Together these two signs indicate that a detour has ended.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0135RU19

Traffic should cross back to the left-hand lane ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the course of the road will return to the left ahead. This usually appears after a stretch where traffic was diverted to a right-hand lane.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0136RU19

Traffic should cross out to the right-hand lane ahead.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that the course of the road will divert to the right ahead.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0137R

Start of central reserve or obstruction.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that two-way traffic will separate to avoid an obstruction.

What does this sign mean? ABMW0138RU19

End of central reserve or obstruction.

This roadworks warning sign tells you that traffic previously separated by the central reserve or an obstruction will revert to two-way traffic.

visits an Emergency Department

Hand signals

You need to be able to interpret correctly the hand signals that other road users make, and there are times when you might need to give clear hand signals.

You also need to know the meaning of hand signals given by a Garda.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0140RU19

The cyclist intends to move out or turn right.

This hand signal tells other road users that the cyclist intends to either move out or make a right hand turn. Drivers should be aware that cyclists could move out into the path of their vehicle without looking.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0141RU19

The cyclist intends to slow down or stop.

This hand signal informs other road users that cyclist intends to slow down or stop. This may indicate that the cyclist is aware of some hazard ahead, so drive with extra care.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0142R

The cyclist intends to go straight on.

This hand signal informs other road users that the cyclists intends to proceed straight ahead at a junction and drivers should show caution.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0143R

The cyclist intends to turn left.

This hand signal informs other road users that the cyclist intends to make a left-hand turn.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0144RU19
The cyclist intends to turn right.

This hand signal tells other road users that the cyclist intends to either move out or make a right hand turn. Drivers should be aware that cyclists could cross the path of their vehicle.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0145R
The cyclist intends to turn left.

This hand signal informs other road users that the cyclist intends to turn left.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0146R
The driver intends to turn left.

This hand signal informs other road users that the driver intends to turn left and the vehicle will change direction.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0147R
The driver intends to move out or turn right.

This hand signal informs other road users that the driver intends to move out or turn right and the vehicle will change direction.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0148R
The driver intends to slow down or stop.

This hand signal informs other road users that the driver intends to slow down or stop and following traffic should be prepared to slow down also.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0149R
The driver intends to turn left.

This hand signal informs other road users or a Garda directing traffic (facing this vehicle), that the driver intends to make a left hand turn.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0150R
The driver intends to turn right.

This hand signal informs other road users or a Garda directing traffic (facing this vehicle) that the driver intends to turn right.

What does this hand signal mean? ABMW0151RU19
The driver intends to proceed straight ahead.

This hand signal informs other road users or a Garda directing traffic that the driver intends to proceed straight ahead.

What does this Garda signal mean? ABMW0152R
Stop if approaching from the front.

When approaching a Garda giving this signal you must stop.

What does this Garda signal mean? ABMW0153R
Stop if approaching from behind.

When approaching a Garda giving this signal you must stop.

What does this Garda signal mean? ABMW0154R
Stop if approaching from either the front or behind.

When approaching a Garda giving this signal you must stop.

What does this Garda signal mean? ABMW0155R
The Garda is beckoning on traffic approaching from either side.

When approaching a Garda giving this signal you may proceed.

What does this Garda signal mean? ABMW0156R
Traffic approaching from the front may proceed.

When approaching a Garda giving this signal you may proceed.

Road markings

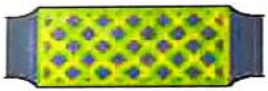
In addition to knowing what all the regulatory road signs mean, you also have to understand the meaning of road markings and act accordingly.

What does this road marking indicate? ABMW0157R/158R
Zebra crossing.

A zebra crossing is a designated area for pedestrians to cross the road. As a driver you must always yield to pedestrians on a zebra crossing.

What does this road marking mean? ABMW0159R
No parking in this area.

White zig zag lines indicate that you are approaching a pedestrian crossing. You must not park or overtake within this area.



What does this road marking mean?
Traffic must not enter unless they can clear the box junction without stopping, or when turning right. ABMW0160U19

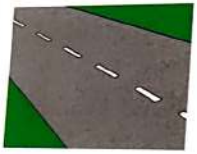
You must not enter the yellow box junction unless you can clear it without stopping or unless you are turning right and are prevented from doing so by oncoming traffic.

What does this road marking mean? ABMW0161RU19
All traffic must keep to the left of the white line.

Where there is a continuous white line in the centre of the road, you are not permitted to: 1. Straddle or cross the white line; 2. Overtake another vehicle; 3. Perform a U-turn; or 4. Park on the road.

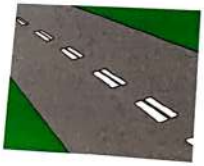
What does this road marking and information plate together mean? ABMW0163RU19/164R
Parking not allowed at the times and days shown.

A single yellow line along the edge of a road means that you must not park there during the times shown on the accompanying information plate



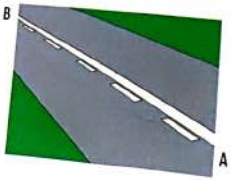
What does this road marking mean? ABMW0165R
A driver must not cross the broken white line unless it is safe to do so.

A broken white line along the centre of the road means you must not cross the line unless it is safe to do so when overtaking or passing.



What do these road markings mean? ABMW0166RU19
Continuous white lines ahead.

Double broken white lines along the centre of the road alert you to continuous white lines ahead. Do not cross them unless it is safe to do so.



If driving from A to B, what do these road markings mean? ABMW0167R
A driver may overtake if it is safe to do so.

Where there is a broken white line and a continuous white line along the centre of the road, you must obey the line that is nearest to you. In this case you may cross the lines as long as it is safe to do so.

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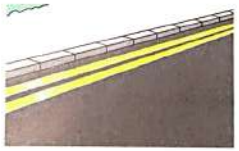
If driving from A to B, what do these road markings mean? ABMW0168R
A driver may not cross the lines to overtake.

Where there is a broken white line and a continuous white line along the centre of the road, you must obey the line that is nearest to you. In this case you may not cross the lines .

What does this road marking mean? ABMW0169RU19
No entry.

This road marking indicates a one-way street. You may not enter this street.



What does this road marking mean? ABMW0170
Parking prohibited at all times.

A double yellow line along the edge of the road means parking is not allowed at any time.

What does this road marking mean? ABMW0171R
Drivers must keep left of the continuous white line.

A single continuous white line along the centre of the road means all traffic must keep to the left of the line. You are not permitted to overtake or perform a U-turn on this section of road.

What does the broken yellow line road marking mean? ABMW0172R
The edge of the carriageway or hard shoulder.

A single broken yellow line along the side of the road marks the edge of the carriageway/hard shoulder. This is normally for the use of pedestrians and cyclists. As a driver, however, you may use it briefly to allow faster traffic to overtake, but only where it is safe to do so.

Traffic lights

You need to know the meaning of all traffic light signals, including those with filter arrows.

What does this traffic light mean? ABMW0173R

Stop, unless it is unsafe to do so.

When the traffic light is showing amber you must not go beyond the stop line unless you so close to the traffic lights that stopping would be dangerous.

What does this traffic light mean? ABMW0174R

The driver may proceed in the direction of the green arrow if the way is clear.

A green arrow (filter light) means that traffic may proceed in the direction of the arrow if it is safe to do so.

What does this traffic light mean? ABMW0175U19

Traffic turning left may proceed if the way is clear.

A green arrow (filter light) means that traffic may proceed in the direction of the arrow if it is safe to do so.

What does this traffic light mean? ABMW0176R

Traffic must stop at the traffic light.

A red light means STOP. You must not go beyond the stop line or (if there is no stop line) beyond the light.

ROAD SIGNS MARKINGS AND TRAFFIC REGULATIONS » TRAFFIC LIGHTS

What does this traffic light mean? ABMW0177R

Traffic may proceed if the way is clear.

You may proceed on a green traffic light if it is safe to do so.

What colour traffic light comes on after the green? ABMW0178

Amber only.

The normal sequence of traffic lights is red–green–amber.

When traffic lights are green, when should a driver not proceed? ABMW0179RU19

When it would be unsafe to do so.

Although a green traffic light means proceed with caution, you should not enter a junction if the way is not clear or if by doing so you would cause an obstruction to other road users.

What does a flashing amber arrow pointing left at a traffic light mean? ABMW0180RU19

A driver may turn left but yield to traffic on the other road.

A flashing left amber arrow at a junction means you may proceed left but must give way to pedestrians and traffic already coming through the junction on the other road.

What colour traffic light comes on after a non-flashing amber light? ABMW0181R

Red only.

The normal sequence of traffic lights is red–green–amber.

What do flashing amber lights at a pelican crossing mean? ABMW0182

Stop and give way to pedestrians - proceed if the way is clear.

A flashing amber light at a pelican crossing means you must yield to pedestrians. You may proceed, however, if the crossing is clear .

Speed limits

You must know the speed limits that apply to different types of road and to different types of vehicle. Always drive at a speed that is safe and appropriate to the road you are on. Never exceed the posted speed limits.

What is the maximum permissible speed for cars and motorcycles on motorways? ABMW0183U19

120 Km/h.

It is illegal to exceed 120 Km/h when driving on a motorway.

Unless otherwise indicated, what is the maximum permissible speed for cars or motorcycles on national roads? ABMW0184RU19

100km/h.

It is illegal to exceed 100 Km/h when driving on a single carriageway national road.

Unless otherwise indicated, what is the maximum permissible speed of a car towing a caravan on national roads? ABMW0185RU19

80 Km/h.

When towing a caravan on a national road, it is illegal to exceed 80 Km/h – excessive speed will make such a vehicle unstable.

Unless otherwise indicated, what is the maximum permissible speed of a car towing a caravan on a motorway? ABMW0186U19

80 Km/h.

When towing a caravan on a motorway it is illegal to exceed 80 Km/h – excessive speed will make such a vehicle unstable.

Unless otherwise indicated, what is the maximum permissible speed of a car towing a trailer on national roads? ABMW0187U19

80 Km/h.

When towing a trailer on a national road, it is illegal to exceed 80 Km/h – exceeding this speed will make the vehicle unstable,

Unless otherwise indicated, what is the maximum permissible speed of a car towing a trailer on a motorway? ABMW0188U19

80 Km/h.

When towing a trailer on a motorway it is illegal to exceed 80 Km/h – excessive speed will make such a vehicle unstable.

Regulations relating to parking

Before you park a vehicle, you need to make sure that it is safe and legal to do so in the place you have chosen. A vehicle parked in an inappropriate place may be a serious hazard to other road users. Make sure you know all of the regulations relating to parking.

Where is a driver allowed to park? ABMW0189RU19

Where the driver is not blocking other road users their view of traffic signals or the road ahead.

It is an offence to park at the side of a road that has a single or double continuous white line along its centre. Parking on such a road could create an obstruction and may cause inconvenience or danger to other road users.

What distance before a zebra crossing is parking prohibited? ABMW0190RU19

15 metres.

It is an offence to park 15 metres before or 5 metres after a pedestrian crossing. Parking in this manner may restrict the zone of vision of drivers approaching the crossing and endanger pedestrians.

Within what distance of a road junction is parking prohibited? ABMW0191RU19

5 metres, unless parking spaces are clearly marked.

It is an offence to park within 5 metres of a road junction unless parking spaces are clearly marked. Parking in that area may restrict the zone of vision of drivers approaching the junction and may cause an obstruction to large vehicles wishing to turn.

Is a driver permitted to park at an entrance to a property? ABMW0193RU19

Yes, with the property owner's consent.

You may park across the entrance to a property only with the owners consent. Parking across an entrance may cause inconvenience and danger to persons entering or leaving the property.

When is parking permitted on a footpath? ABMW0194RU19

It is never permitted to park on a footpath.

It is an offence to park on a footpath. Where a vehicle is parked on a footpath, pedestrians may have to step onto the road to go around the vehicle and so place themselves in danger.

When is double parking permitted? ABMW0195RU19

It is never permitted.

Double parking is never permitted. Parking is never permitted where it might interfere in any way with the normal flow of traffic or obstruct or endanger other road users.

When is parking permitted at a taxi rank? ABMW0196RU19

Parking at a taxi rank is prohibited unless driving a taxi.

Stopping or parking within an area marked as a taxi rank is prohibited as this may obstruct taxis entering or leaving the rank.

When is parking permitted at a sharp bend? ABMW0197RU19

Parking is never permitted at a sharp bend.

Parking is never permitted where it might interfere in any way with the normal flow of traffic or obstruct or endanger other road users – for example, by forcing other drivers into the path of oncoming traffic.

When is parking permitted on the brow of a hill? ABMW0198RU19

Parking is never permitted on the brow of a hill.

Parking on the brow of a hill or on a humpbacked bridge is prohibited. Parking in such a place may restrict the zone of vision of drivers approaching the hill and force them into the path of oncoming traffic.

Regulations relating to pedestrians

Pedestrians are the most vulnerable road users, and as a driver you need to be extra careful where there are pedestrians.

If there is no footpath, where must a pedestrian walk? ABMW0199R

Right-hand side of the road.

Where there is no footpath provided, pedestrians should walk on the right-hand side of the road facing oncoming traffic. Drivers should be aware of the Rules of the Road for pedestrians, drive with caution and be prepared to react to any changes in the traffic situation.

On a narrow busy road, what should pedestrians do when walking? ABMW0203RU19

Walk in single file.

Pedestrians should walk in single file on busy narrow roads. Drivers should be aware of the Rules of the Road for pedestrians, drive with caution and be prepared to react to any changes in the traffic situation.

When should pedestrians wear reflective clothing at night? ABMW0204RU19

At night, when walking outside built-up areas.

Outside built-up areas, pedestrians should wear reflective clothing at all times when walking at night. This is particularly important where there is no street lighting and no footpath for pedestrians.

What road users must comply with traffic lights (including pedestrian lights)? ABMW0205R

All road users.

As road users, pedestrians must comply with traffic controls. Drivers should be aware that traffic lights and pedestrian lights can be combined at junctions and should show caution and consideration to pedestrians.

Other regulatory matters

There are a number of other regulatory matters that you need to know about. Mostly these are regulations that guide our behaviour and help ensure the safety of all road users.

When should a driver use dipped headlights? ABMW0207RU19

From just after dusk to just before dawn.

Lighting up hours are defined as the period of time during which drivers should turn on dipped headlights in order to be seen. This period normally starts half an hour after sunset and ends half an hour before sunrise.

What lights should a vehicle show at dusk? ABMW0208RU19

Dipped headlights.

Drivers need to see and be seen during all periods of low light levels – for example, at dusk and dawn and in some bad weather conditions. At times of low light, you should turn on dipped headlights. The Road Safety Authority recommends that motorcyclists and drivers turn on their dipped headlights or daytime running lights during daylight hours.

What is the purpose of traffic calming measures? ABMW0210RU19

To slow down traffic in the vicinity.

The purpose of traffic calming measures is to slow down fast-moving traffic to a speed more suitable for the area they are entering. These measures are usually found in rural areas on the entry points to towns or villages.

When may a trailer be towed on a public road without a rear number plate? ABMW0211RU19

Never, a number plate must always be displayed.

The law requires all motorised vehicles to display a rear number plate that is clean and legible.

When may you pass another vehicle on the left-hand side? ABMW0212RU19

When the vehicle in front is signalling to turn right or in slow moving lanes of traffic.

Normally you must overtake on the right. There are, however, circumstances where you may overtake on the left – for example, when the vehicle has moved out and signalled to turn right.

Who can use a signed cycle track accompanied by a continuous white line on the left-hand side? ABMW0213R

Cyclists and users of motorised wheelchairs.

A cycle track is for the use of cyclists and motorised wheelchairs only. No other vehicles may cross into or over a mandatory cycle track unless this is necessary in order to leave or enter a side road or a property adjacent to the cycle track.

What traffic may use a cycle lane accompanied by a continuous white line? ABMW0214RU19

Cyclists and motorised wheelchairs.

A cycle track is for the use of cyclists and motorised wheelchairs. No other vehicles may cross into or over a mandatory cycle track unless this is necessary in order to leave a side road or a property adjacent to the cycle track.

Apart from cyclists and motorised wheelchairs, what other road users may use an unoccupied cycle lane accompanied by a broken white line?

All drivers may make temporary use. ABMW0215RU19

Drivers may make temporary use of a cycle track with a broken white line on the right hand side if it is not occupied.

When must drivers stop at an automated railway level crossing with barriers and red flashing lights? ABMW0216RU19

Stop safely when the amber light shows, or when red lights start to flash.

You must stop safely when the amber light shows. Flashing red lights have the same meaning as a steady red traffic light - stop safely when they show.

At a railway level crossing with unattended gates, what should a car driver do? ABMW0217RUS

Open both gates before proceeding to cross.

At a level crossing with unattended gates a driver must stop, look for trains and listen for the sound of a horn or approaching trains. If it is safe, open both gates, complete the crossing and then close both gates.

What lights indicate a zebra crossing? ABMW0218

Flashing amber beacons.

A zebra crossing is indicated by amber flashing beacons on poles and black and white stripes on the road. You must stop for pedestrians on the crossing and for those about to cross.

What do flashing amber arrows indicate at a junction? ABMW0219RUS

When safe, drivers should proceed in the direction indicated.

When you meet a flashing amber arrow at a junction, you should proceed in the direction indicated provided it is safe to do so.

What do temporary traffic lights at road works mean? ABMW0220

A driver must comply with the lights at all times.

You must comply with any temporary traffic lights used to control vehicle movements at or near road works. It is an offence not to obey these lights.

When do temporary speed limits apply at roadworks? ABMW0221RUS

For the duration of the roadworks.

Temporary speed limits at road works apply for the duration of the works. When road works are completed, normal speed limits apply.

Alert driving and consideration for other road users

When you are driving, the traffic situation is changing constantly, and different kinds of hazard can arise with or without warning. You need to remain alert at all times and show consideration for all other road users.

The questions in this section test your knowledge in a number of areas:

Illustrated traffic situations	These are typical of the kind of situations that you need to be alert to when driving.
Anticipation of hazards	Anticipation skills help you identify and avoid hazards on the road.
Consideration for other road users	Good drivers always display consideration for other road users.
Alertness to danger	You need to remain alert to potential danger at all times.

Illustrated traffic situations

Every time you go on the road you meet different traffic situations and potential hazards, and you need to maintain your concentration at all times so that you will make the right and safe decisions every time.

What is the correct action to take in this situation? ABMW0222RU19

Keep a close eye on the children and be prepared to brake in good time.

Because it is difficult to predict children's behaviour, you should always be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation or to stop.

An approaching driver notices that the boy on the children's bicycle has said goodbye to his friend. What is the correct action for the driver to take? ABMW0223RU19

Be prepared for the boy setting off at any moment.

Because it is difficult to predict children's behaviour, you should always be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation or to stop.

As the driver of the car, which conduct is correct? ABMW0224R

A driver may proceed with caution.

You may proceed, but you should be aware of the presence of the motorcyclist. You should always be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation – for example, the motorcyclist might not have seen your vehicle.

What should the car driver do in this situation? ABMW0225RU19

The driver must allow the cyclist to proceed.

When you are turning right from a major road to a minor road, you must yield to oncoming traffic, and you should proceed only when it is safe to do so.

What must a driver be prepared for in this situation? ABMW0226RU19

A child could turn back to collect the ball from the roadway.

Because it is difficult to predict children's behaviour, you should always be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation and be prepared to stop.

When approaching the pedestrian crossing, what should the driver do in this situation? ABMW0227R

Slow down in good time and be prepared to stop.

When there are pedestrians at or near a zebra crossing, you should slow down on approach and be prepared to stop to allow the pedestrians to cross safely.

What should the driver do in this situation? ABMW0228R

The driver must yield to the yellow car on the roundabout.

When you reach the roundabout, you must give way to traffic approaching from the right – unless signs, road markings or traffic lights tell you otherwise.

What should the car driver do in this situation? ABMW0232R

The car driver must allow the motorcycle to proceed.

When you are turning right from a major road to a minor road, you must yield to oncoming traffic. You should proceed only when it is safe to do so.

What should the driver do in this situation? ABMW0233R

The driver may turn in front of the other two cars.

When you are turning right from a major road to a minor road, you must yield to oncoming traffic and only proceed when it is safe to do so. However, the drivers on the minor roads must give way to the traffic on the major road.

What should a driver be alert to in this area? ABMW0235R

Pedestrians may cross between parked cars.

When driving in a built-up area, you should drive with caution and be prepared to react to pedestrians crossing from between parked vehicles.

What should the driver do if there are children playing at the edge of the roadway? ABMW0237R

Reduce speed, drive cautiously and remain ready to brake.

Because it is difficult to predict children's behaviour, you should always be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation and be prepared to stop.

What should the driver do in this situation? ABMW0233RU19

The driver may continue ahead with caution.

On approaching a crossroads you should check the road sign to see which traffic has priority and be prepared for emerging traffic from either side. Vehicles do not have an automatic right of way on the road. The overriding rule is to proceed with caution in all circumstances.

What should the driver do in this situation? ABMW0234RU19

The driver may turn right.

You may turn right if there no oncoming traffic but you should also be aware that there might be traffic emerging from the minor roads.

What should the driver do in this situation? ABMW0235R

The driver must allow the blue truck to proceed.

When you are turning right from a major road to a minor road, you must yield to oncoming traffic and proceed only when it is safe to do so. You should also be aware that there might be emerging from the minor road.

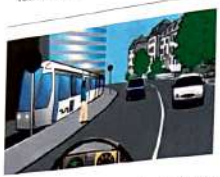
What should a driver be conscious of in this situation? ABMW0236R

People crossing the street at the rear of the bus.

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to the changing traffic situation. In particular, you should be aware that pedestrians might emerge at the rear of the bus. In this situation you should also look out for pedestrians making their way towards the waiting Bus

The silver car is overtaking the parked red car, what should the driver do in this situation?
ABMW0239RU19
Reduce speed considerably and be ready to stop.

You should read the road and be extra careful while driving through an area where children might be playing. When a ball bounces out on the road you should expect that a child might follow to retrieve the ball.



What should a driver be aware of in this situation?
ABMW0238RU19
The pedestrian may leave the traffic island without paying attention.

You should read the road ahead and expect extra pedestrian activity when the tram is at the stop.

The driver is following these two vehicles and wishes to overtake - what must the driver consider before overtaking here?
ABMW0237
The driver's field of view is not good enough to allow safe overtaking.

You should always make sure that the road ahead is clear so that there is enough distance to allow you to overtake and get back to the correct side of the road without forcing any other road user to alter speed or course. In this case, the brow of the hill is too close to allow a driver to overtake safely.

What should a driver be aware of when approaching a vehicle which is attempting to park?
ABMW0236
That the vehicle being parked may move out without warning.

When you approach a vehicle that is being parked on the roadway, you should be aware that its driver will probably be concentrating on parking the vehicle and may not be aware of moving out into the road to correct its position.

What should the driver allow for when following the bus on an icy road?
ABMW0241RU19
A longer braking distance is required.

When driving in icy conditions, you should always reduce speed and allow a bigger gap to the vehicle in front in order to be able to stop safely if necessary.

What should the driver of the silver car do before turning left?
ABMW0242R
Allow the cyclist heading straight on to pass.

Do not overtake a cyclist as you approach a junction at which you are turning left. The cyclist might be continuing ahead. Cyclists are vulnerable road users and may be unstable in slow-moving traffic and at junctions. Give them more room.

What lights should a driver use in dense fog?
ABMW0246RU19
Front and rear fog lights along with dipped headlights.

When driving in dense fog you should switch on your front and rear fog lights along with dipped headlights. You should not drive in fog with main beam headlights on.

What should the driver be most conscious of in this situation?
ABMW0248RU19
The pedestrian may suddenly cross the road in front of the vehicle.

It is often difficult to predict other road users behaviour. Where there are parked vehicles on both sides of the road you should approach with caution, and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation and to stop.

What should the driver do when approaching this situation? ABMW0249RU19

Reduce speed and remain ready to brake since the girl on the footpath could suddenly cross the road.

It is often difficult to predict other road users behaviour. You should be prepared in case the pedestrian steps onto the road and the silver car stops suddenly.

What should the driver do? ABMW0250R

The driver should allow the yellow car to proceed.

At a cross junction of equal importance the traffic approaching from the right has priority. It is important to understand that the right of way is not an absolute right. You must proceed with caution while showing regard for other road users.

Which car, if any, is parked incorrectly? ABMW0251

Both cars.

It is an offence to park within 15 metres before or 5 metres after a pedestrian crossing. Parking in this manner may restrict the zone of vision of drivers approaching the crossing and endanger pedestrians.

What should a driver be aware of in this situation? ABMW0252RU19

The cyclist may move onto the roadway without paying attention to moving traffic.

You should show extra care when approaching cyclists who are about to exit from a cycle lane and join the roadway.

A driver wants to pull out of a driveway and turn right onto the road. At the same time a cyclist is approaching from the right and a pedestrian wants to cross. Who must wait? ABMW0253R

The driver must wait.

By law you must give way to other road users, including pedestrians and cyclists, when you are entering or leaving a driveway.

What action should the driver take? ABMW0254R

Stop at the Stop line.

By law you must stop at a Stop line (or at a Stop sign if there is no Stop line), and wait for other traffic to clear before proceeding.

What should a driver do when travelling behind this vehicle? ABMW0255R

Reduce speed and prepare to stop if necessary.

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to the changing traffic situation as you approach junctions.

What does a continuous white line along the centre of the road mean? ABMW0256RU19

No U-turn allowed.

You must never do a U-turn on any stretch of road with a continuous white line along its centre. The restricted vision at such places would make doing a U-turn very unsafe.

How should a driver overtake the cyclist in this situation? ABMW0257R

By crossing the broken white line.

Where there are two lines in the centre of the road, you must obey the one closest to you. So, if the closest line is a broken white line, by law you may overtake, so long as it is safe to do so.

What does a continuous white line in the centre of the road mean? ABMW0259RU19

Vehicles may not cross or straddle the line.

You must not cross or straddle a continuous white line in the centre of the road unless you wish to enter land or premises and it is safe to do so.

The driver intends to turn left at this junction - what should the driver do? ABMW0261R

Allow the cyclist to continue before turning left.

Do not overtake a cyclist as you approach a junction at which you are turning left. The cyclist might be continuing ahead. Cyclists are vulnerable road users and may be unstable in slow-moving traffic and at junctions. Give them more room.

Why might it be dangerous to drive on a poorly-lit street? ABMW0262RU19

Pedestrians crossing in a dark area might be difficult to see.

When you are driving along a poorly-lit street, you should take extra care – vulnerable road users such as pedestrians might not be so easy to see. You should always be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

Why might it be dangerous to drive on a poorly-lit street? ABMW0263R

It may be difficult to make out poorly lit vehicles in the dark areas.

When you are driving along a poorly-lit street, you should take extra care and be prepared to react to hazards such as unlit parked vehicles.

The driver intends to turn right at this junction - what should the driver do? ABMW0264RU19

Proceed after the motorcycle and bus have passed.

When you are turning right at a junction, you should yield to traffic on the major road, and to oncoming traffic at the junction.

The driver intends to turn right at this junction - what should the driver do? ABMW0265R

Stop at the line.

You must stop at the line where a junction is controlled by a Stop sign and Stop line. Do not proceed until it is safe to do so.

What should a driver do if dazzled by the lights of an oncoming vehicle? ABMW0266RU19

Look to the left-hand edge (nearside) of the roadway and slow down if necessary.

If you are dazzled by the lights of oncoming traffic, turn your eyes to the left edge (nearside) of the road. If necessary, stop and allow your eyes to recover before driving on.

What should a driver do when approaching traffic lights that change from green to amber?

Stop, unless it is unsafe to do so. ABMW0270GB

When you are approaching a set of traffic lights showing green, you should take care and be prepared to stop if the amber light comes on.

When intending to turn right as shown, what should the car driver do?

Wait and allow the oncoming vehicle to pass. ABMW0270BUS

When you are turning right from a main road onto a side road, you must by law give way to oncoming traffic on the main road.

What danger should a driver allow for over the brow of this hill? ABMW0272R

There may be a slow moving vehicle in your lane.

On the approach to the brow of a hill you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

What danger should a driver allow for over the brow of this hill? ABMW0273R

A vehicle may be broken down.

On the approach to the brow of a hill you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

What danger should a driver allow for over the brow of this hill? ABMW0275R

There may be oncoming pedestrians.

On the approach to the brow of a hill you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

What danger should a driver allow for over the brow of this hill? ABMW0276R

There may be livestock on the road.

On approach to the brow of a hill you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

What danger should a driver allow for over the brow of this hill? ABMW0277R

There may be hedge-cutting taking place.

On the approach to the brow of a hill you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

What should a driver be aware of in this situation? ABMW0278R

There may be a car hidden from view in front of the bus.

On approach to an area with a restricted view you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

What should a driver do when continuing straight ahead in the middle lane? ABMW0285R

Slow down and allow the driver in front to change lanes.

You should always keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front especially when it is slowing down or stopping.

What should a driver do at an amber traffic light? ABMW0

Stop at the line unless it is not safe to do so.

By law you must stop at an amber traffic light if it is safe to do so.

What should a driver be aware of when following the motorcyclist, and the white car is reversing onto the road? ABMW0285RU

The driver following the motorcycle may need a longer braking distance than normal.

You should always keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front if it is slowing down or stopping. Always read the road and be prepared to react correctly to changes in the traffic ahead.

What should a driver do on the approach to this situation? ABMW0

Reduce speed and stop if necessary.

When road priority is unclear you might have to yield to oncoming vehicles. Never drive a vehicle into an area that it might not be able to clear or where it could cause an obstruction or bottleneck.

When driving on a cobblestone road why should you take extra care? ABMW0285R

The road surface is uneven and road grip varies.

Different road surfaces can affect your vehicles grip on the road and its stopping distances. You should be aware of this when driving on different surfaces.

When driving on a road with tram lines why should a driver take extra care? ABMW12

Driving on the tracks can reduce tyre grip.

Different road surfaces can affect your vehicles grip on the road and its stopping distances. You should be aware of this when driving on different surfaces.

After a heavy downpour, why should a driver keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front? ABMW0286RU19

Because wheel-spray may impair visibility.

Heavy rain can affect how well you can see and how well you can be seen by other road users. Because of that you should slow down in heavy rain and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

When driving on this one-way street with vehicles parked on both sides, what should a driver be prepared for? ABMW0287R

A vehicle door may open on either side of the street.

When driving on a one-way street, you should be extra careful and should be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

When driving on this one-way street with vehicles parked on both sides, what should a driver be prepared for? ABMW0288R

Pedestrians crossing between the vehicles.

When driving on a one-way street, you should be extra careful and be prepared to react to a change in the traffic situation.

Why must a driver be particularly careful here? ABMW0289R

Because there is an increased danger of skidding.

Where there are fallen leaves on the road surface, your tyres might have reduced grip on the road surface and your braking distances might be greater.

What should a driver do in this situation when intending to turn left? ABMW0290RU19

Yield to pedestrians already crossing.

By law you must yield to pedestrians already crossing at a junction. Pedestrians are vulnerable road users and you should be extra careful driving at places where pedestrians are attempting to cross the road.

What should a driver do when turning right at this junction? ABMW0291R

Allow the red car to proceed.

When you are turning right from a main road into a side road, you must give way to oncoming traffic on the main road even if they are turning left into the same road.

What should the car driver be aware of in this situation? ABMW0292RU19

Slowing down and being prepared to react.

When you are approaching a bend or corner with a restricted view you should slow down if necessary and be prepared to react to any changes in the traffic situation.

What should a driver be aware of when driving at night along a shopping street with many different light sources? ABMW0294R

Traffic lights may be difficult to distinguish from the other bright lights.

When driving at night in an area where there is a variety of light sources, you need to be extra careful, as potential hazards might be more difficult to see.

What should a driver be most aware of in this situation? ABMW0295RU19

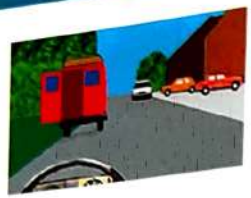
Children may unexpectedly run out from between parked cars.

When driving in a residential area you need to take account of the danger you might pose to children playing. You should always observe warning signs relating to children and drive accordingly.

What should a driver do in this situation?

Reduce speed and be prepared to stop as other children could follow. ABMW0296R

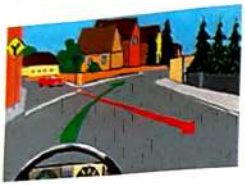
You should always be aware of other road users especially children, who can be unpredictable and show no road sense. You should drive with extra care in areas where there are children about – for example, near schools, playgrounds and in residential areas.



In this situation who should wait?
The driver behind the stopped van should wait.

ABMW0297R

When you are overtaking a parked vehicle or obstruction, you should yield to oncoming vehicles so that they don't have to slow down or take evasive action.



In this situation, who should wait?
The driver in the red car should wait.

ABMW0298R

A vehicle driving on the main road has priority over vehicles emerging from side roads. However, you must understand that the right of way is not an absolute right of way and you should be considerate of other road users at all times.

What should a driver do in this situation?
Allow the pedestrian to cross the road.

ABMW0302R

When approaching a zebra crossing, you must yield to pedestrians already on or about to cross the road.

What should a driver be aware of in this situation?
A dangerous right-hand bend ahead.

ABMW0304R

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations – in this case paying attention to the warning sign clearly indicating a right-hand bend ahead.

What should a driver who wants to turn right do in this situation?

ABMW0306RU19

Proceed straight ahead or turn left.

As you approach a junction where you want to turn right, you should read the road ahead and take up the correct position for turning in good time.

Which vehicle is in the correct position to make a right turn from the major road into the minor road?

ABMW0307R

3

The correct position from which to turn right from a major road to a minor road is just left of centre. You should take up the correct position in good time and avoid cutting the corner or swan necking – that is going beyond the turning point as car 2 is in the picture.

Which vehicle is in the correct position to make a right turn from a minor road onto a major road?

ABMW0312R

1

The correct position from which to turn right from a minor road to a major road is just left of centre of the road. You should take up the correct position in good time and complete the turn by entering the left-hand side of the major road.

Driver behaviour and anticipation

Having good anticipation skills means scanning the road ahead and always being aware of the potential for hazards.

After a heavy downpour, why should a driver keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front? ABMW0313RU19

Because the required stopping distances is greater.

On a wet road surface, your tyres do not grip the road surface as well as in dry conditions and your required stopping distance is increased. Because of that you should slow down during or after rain and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

What should the driver do when there is a sharp dip in the road ahead? ABMW0314RU19

Reduce speed, keep to the left and be alert for hazards ahead.

As you approach a sharp dip in the road, you should be aware that there might be hidden dangers ahead. For example, there might be pedestrians, cyclists or other approaching traffic, or the road could be flooded in the dip. You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations – you might need to reduce your speed and drive with extra care.

What should a driver do if they see a red warning triangle on the road? ABMW0315P

The driver should slow down and expect a hazard up ahead.

Warning triangles are used to alert approaching traffic that there is a vehicle breakdown or collision ahead. When you come across a warning triangle, you should slow down and be prepared to stop if necessary. Do not allow yourself to be distracted by the incident.

The driver is approaching traffic lights that they know have been green for some time. What should the driver do? ABMW0316RU19

The driver should be aware that the lights may change before they reach them and be prepared to stop.

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations. Where traffic lights have been green for some time, you should be prepared to stop, as the lights are probably about to change to amber.

What should a driver do when approaching a junction normally controlled by traffic lights and the traffic lights are not lighting? ABMW0317RU19

Treat it as an unmarked junction and proceed cautiously while watching out for other traffic.

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations. If the traffic lights are not working, you should approach the junction with extra care, and you should proceed only if it is safe to do so.

What should the driver do if there are cattle on the road ahead? ABMW0318RU19

The driver should reduce speed and pass them with care.

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations. If you meet cattle or other animals on the road, you should slow down and be prepared to stop . Dont use the horn or do anything that might frighten the animals. You must stop if directed to do so by the person in charge of animals.

What should a driver do if they see horse riders on the road ahead? ABMW0319RU19

The driver should reduce speed, allow extra clearance and pass with care.

You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations. If you meet horses or other animals on the road, you should slow down and be prepared to stop . Dont use the horn or do anything that might frighten the animals. You must stop if directed to do so by the person in charge of animals.

What should drivers be aware of if they meet horses with riders on the road? ABMW0320R

Drivers should be aware that loud noises from their vehicle may frighten the horses and cause them to bolt.

You must know your responsibilities towards animal traffic on the road. Horses are easily startled and any sudden noises or activity could cause them to bolt.

What should the driver do when approaching a humpbacked hill? ABMW0321RU19

The driver should reduce speed, keep to the left and be alert for hazards ahead.

As you approach a humpbacked bridge or hill, you should be aware that there might be hidden dangers ahead – for example, overtaking traffic coming towards you. You should always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to changing traffic situations such as this.

What should a driver do if there is a large oil spill on the road?
Reduce speed by gently applying the brakes and switch on the hazard warning lights.
ABMW0323R

Where oil is spilt on the road, your tyres will have reduced grip, and you might be at risk of skidding if you brake sharply. If you do come across oil on the road, brake gently and switch on your hazard warning lights for a short period to alert other traffic to the hazard.

What do flashing amber beacons on an oncoming vehicle alert a driver to?
ABMW0321RU19
That the oncoming vehicle may be slow moving or extra wide.

Flashing amber beacons are used by recovery vehicles and vehicles carrying abnormal loads. You should be aware that these vehicles may need extra room and could conceal following traffic. When you come across such vehicles, slow down and be prepared to stop if necessary.

What should a driver do if they meet a vehicle with flashing amber beacons?
ABMW0324RU19
Slow down and prepare to stop.

Flashing amber beacons are used by recovery vehicles and vehicles carrying abnormal loads. You should be aware that these vehicles may need extra room and could conceal following traffic. When you come across such vehicles, slow down and be prepared to stop if necessary.

What should a driver be aware of before crossing railway or tram lines?
There may be an uneven surface and tyre grip may be reduced when crossing the rails.
ABMW0325RU19

You should be aware of the impact of changes in the road surface. For example, at railway and tram crossings the uneven surface or oil deposits could reduce the grip of your tyres. Slow down as you approach railway or tram crossings and increase your distance from the vehicle in front.

What should the driver be aware of when crossing road markings such as lines and directional arrows in wet weather?
ABMW0326RU19
The required stopping distance is increased due to reduced tyre grip.

You should be aware of the impact of changes in the road surface. For example, road markings and directional arrows can become slippery when wet. Where possible, avoid driving on road markings, and be aware of the increased risk of skidding.

Consideration for other road users

While driving, you need to show consideration for other road users at all times.

There are pedestrians on the footpath ahead and there are pools of water on the road. What should a driver do?
ABMW0327R
Reduce speed and try to avoid the pools of water so as not to splash the pedestrians.

During wet conditions, you should be aware that surface water can affect the stability of your vehicle. This is particularly so where the water lies in pools. As you drive through surface water, you should show consideration to pedestrians and cyclists and try not to splash them as you pass.

When preparing to stop, a driver notices the vehicle behind is towing a trailer. What should the driver do?
ABMW0328R
Indicate in good time and pull in gradually to allow the vehicle behind extra stopping distance.

When you are slowing down or stopping, you should be mindful of the type of vehicle that is following you. For example, if the vehicle following you is a large vehicle or one towing a trailer, you should think of indicating a little earlier than normal to allow the following vehicle enough time to react safely.

The bus ahead is moving away from a bus stop. What should a driver do?
Slow down and allow it to move out.
ABMW0329R

A driver should allow signalling buses back into the stream of traffic when they are moving out from a stop. Be careful of pedestrians getting on and off buses, particularly of children near schools.

What should a driver do on a narrow road when another vehicle is coming in the opposite direction?
ABMW0330RU19
Reduce speed and allow reasonable clearance between their vehicle and the oncoming one before proceeding.

You should always be prepared to react to hazards ahead. When you meet a vehicle coming against you on a narrow road, you should show consideration and slow down to a appropriate speed so that the two vehicles can pass each other safely.

When wanting to stop temporarily in a congested area where should the driver park? ABMW0331RU19

Park in a safe, legal and convenient place.

You should park only where it is safe, legal and convenient to do so. Your parked vehicle must not cause a danger or an obstruction to other road users. The use of hazard warning lights does not excuse unsafe or illegal parking.

When a driver is driving behind another vehicle that they do not intend to overtake, what should the driver do? ABMW0332RU19

Keep well back to allow following traffic to overtake.

You should always allow sufficient distance between your vehicle and the vehicle in front. This will enable you to stop safely (within the distance you can see clear). It will also give overtaking vehicles enough room to pull in safely to the left lane after they have passed you.

When a driver is driving in a line of traffic and does not intend to overtake, what should the driver do? ABMW0333RU19

Stay back and leave a gap for other drivers to overtake.

You should always allow sufficient distance between your vehicle and the vehicle in front. This will enable you to stop safely (within the distance you can see clear). It will also give overtaking vehicles enough room to pull in safely to the left lane after they have passed you.

Why is tailgating (driving too close behind the vehicle in front) dangerous? ABMW0337RU19

The vehicle will not have sufficient distance to stop safely in an emergency.

If you drive too close to the vehicle in front and it brakes suddenly, you will not have enough time to react. For that reason you should always keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front. One way of calculating a safe distance in dry weather is the two-second rule: allow at least two seconds to elapse between the vehicle in front and your own vehicle passing a fixed point such as a lamp post or sign post.

Is tailgating allowed on a motorway or dual carriageway? ABMW0338RU19

No, because the vehicle in front may stop suddenly.

If you drive too close to the vehicle in front and it brakes suddenly, you will not have enough time to react. For that reason you should always keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front. One way of calculating a safe distance in dry weather is the two-second rule: allow at least two seconds to elapse between the vehicle in front and your own vehicle passing a fixed point such as a lamp post or sign post.

Alertness to danger

Dangerous situations can arise without warning, so you need to be alert at all times to changing road and traffic situations.

What danger can arise during daylight when a driver enters an area that is heavily shaded by overhanging trees? ABMW0339RU19

Visibility could suddenly be reduced.

When you enter a heavily shaded area after driving in bright sunlight, it might take a while for your eyes to adjust to the change, and you might not see a hazard immediately ahead.

What should a driver do when being overtaken by another vehicle? ABMW0340R

Continue at the same pace.

When you are being overtaken by another vehicle, you should continue at the same pace but be alert in case the overtaking vehicle suddenly pulls back in front you.

When should signals (for example, with indicators) be given to other road users? ABMW0341R

Clearly and in good time to let other road users know your intentions.

Giving signals is a way of telling other road users what you intend to do. So, you should signal properly before moving off, turning right or left, changing lanes, overtaking, slowing down or stopping. Signal clearly and in good time, and keep in mind that giving a signal does not give you the right of way.

When driving into a narrow gap between oncoming vehicles and vehicles parked on the left. What should a driver do? ABMW0342RU19

Indicate right, stopping if necessary until oncoming traffic has passed by.

When you meet approaching traffic at a narrow gap, you should show consideration and slow down to an appropriate speed so that you and the other vehicles can pass each other safely. If necessary, give way to the other vehicles.

How does giving a late signal affect other road users? ABMW0343RU19

They may not have been given sufficient time to react.

Giving signals is a way of telling other road users what you intend to do. So, you should signal properly before moving off, turning right or left, changing lanes, overtaking, slowing down or stopping. Signal clearly and in good time, and keep in mind that giving a signal does not give you the right of way. Late signals may confuse other road users.

Observation and field of view

When you are driving, you must always have a clear picture of the road ahead and the traffic conditions all around you. You should also make sure that other road users can see you, so that they are not taken by surprise and forced to take emergency evasive action.

Visibility

The questions in this section deal with situations where your ability to see the road ahead is restricted and with the effects of rain on your ability to control your vehicle.

How does rain affect driving in this situation? ABMW0344R

It increases the danger of skidding.

When it is wet, your tyres do not grip the road surface as well as when it is dry, your stopping distance is increased and you are more likely to skid. For these reasons you should slow down during or after rain and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

When a driver is at a junction where visibility is extremely limited, what should the driver do? ABMW0345R

Move out with extreme care, watching carefully to the left and right.

Where your view is obstructed at a junction, you should move carefully into a position where you can see, but without interfering with other road users. You should then assess the situation before you continue.

When should a driver use the vehicle's rear view mirror? ABMW0346R

Before changing direction.

You should use your mirrors to stay aware of traffic situations behind and around you. Always check your mirror before you change direction on a road, and before you signal or begin a manoeuvre.

How should a driver proceed if their view is obstructed at a junction? ABMW0347R

Move out slowly onto the road while watching carefully for other traffic.

At junctions where the view is obstructed, move carefully into a position where you can see without interfering with other road users. Then assess the situation before you continue.

What should a driver do when approaching traffic lights stuck on red? ABMW0348RU19

Stop and proceed with great caution.

On approach to traffic lights that are stuck on red, a driver should stop and proceed with caution when the way is clear.

What should a driver do when there are dark clouds and visibility is reduced during daylight hours? ABMW0349RU19

Drive with dipped headlights switched on.

Drivers need to see and be seen during all periods of low light levels – for example, at dusk and dawn and in some bad weather conditions. At times of low light, you should turn on dipped headlights.

Blindspots

When driving, you need to be aware of the fact that there are some parts of the road around you that you cannot see easily, either directly or with your mirrors. You need to be sure that these areas are clear of other road users before moving into them. Equally, when travelling behind a truck or other large vehicle, or when overtaking another vehicle, you should be aware that there are times when you are 'invisible' to the other driver.

When driving behind a heavy goods vehicle that is signalling to turn right, what should a driver do? ABMW0350RU19

Stay behind until there is sufficient space to overtake it on the inside or until it has completed the turn.

Heavy goods vehicles need extra space on the road, and when they are turning the overhang of the vehicle may swing out into the path of overtaking or passing traffic. For that reason, it is a good idea to stay back and let the heavy goods vehicle complete its turn unless there is sufficient space to overtake safely.

When driving behind a bus that is signalling to turn left and there is oncoming traffic, what should a driver do? ABMW0351RU19

Stay back and allow it to complete the turn.

Always allow a bus to complete a left-hand turn, because your field of view is restricted, and it could be dangerous to attempt overtaking it.

Where are the blind spots that a driver needs to be aware of when towing a loaded trailer? ABMW0354RU19

The area to the side and rear of the vehicle and the trailer that the driver cannot see.

A blind spot is an area that a driver cannot see when looking forward or when looking in the mirrors. You should check your blindspots before changing direction or changing lane. The bigger the vehicle, the bigger the blind spots, and you should keep this in mind if you are driving behind a large vehicle, such as one towing a loaded trailer. In this situation, if you cannot see the towing vehicles mirror, then the driver of that vehicle cannot see you.

What should a driver do when driving on a wide road behind a vehicle that has signalled to turn right ahead? ABMW0355RU19

Overtake on the left-hand side and carry on if safe to do so.

You may overtake on the left when the driver in front has moved out and signalled their intent to turn right and you intend to go straight ahead – provided there is enough room to do so safely and your path will not be obstructed by the swing of a large vehicle turning right.

Overtaking and U-turns

The questions that follow deal with overtaking on the left and performing U-turns. Each of these manoeuvres can be done only in limited circumstances; they each require the driver to exercise judgement and skill.

When is it permissible to overtake another vehicle on the nearside (left-hand side)? ABMW0356RU19

When the vehicle in front is signalling to turn right.

You may overtake on the left when the driver in front has moved out and signalled their intent to turn right and you intend to go straight ahead – provided there is enough room to do so safely and your path will not be obstructed by the swing of a large vehicle turning right.

What should a driver who wishes to perform a U-turn do? ABMW0357RU19

Check that the road is not one way.

If you want to do a U-turn you must first choose a place where it is safe and legal to do it. Check all around for other road users and do not impede their right of way. Complete the manoeuvre efficiently and safely.

What should a driver who wishes to perform a turnabout do? ABMW0358RU19

Check ahead and behind for oncoming traffic and turn briskly while still keeping a look out.

If you want to do a turnabout, you must first choose a place where it is safe and legal to do so. Check all around for other road users and do not impede their right of way. Complete the manoeuvre efficiently and safely.

The driver's mental state

Driving a motor vehicle requires concentration, perception, judgement and reaction. These can all be affected if your mental state is impaired by tiredness, by being under pressure, by anger or distress, by frustrating or confusing traffic conditions, or by alcohol or drugs. The questions in this section check that you understand these issues and know how to deal with them.

Tiredness

Tiredness – or fatigue – is one of the main causes of serious road collisions. When you're very tired, you are much less alert and have poorer physical coordination, and your reaction times are much slower. You will also find it more difficult to 'read the road' and take in direction signs, warning signs and other information as you drive. And you run the very grave risk of dozing off at the wheel, with potentially fatal consequences.

What should drivers do if they become drowsy while driving?
Stop, take a break including a short walk if possible.

Driving when you are tired can be very dangerous, and tiredness is one of the main causes of serious road collisions. If you become drowsy while driving, stop in a safe place and take a short nap. Then get some fresh air and stretch your legs for a few minutes before setting off again. Taking a caffeine-based drink such as coffee may also help.

What should the driver do if they are driving and feel tired?
The driver should stop and take a break.

Driving when you are tired can be very dangerous, and it may cause you to micro-sleep (or nod off momentarily). At 100km/h you travel at 28 metres a second, so if you micro-sleep for just 4 seconds you would travel over 100 metres without being in control of the vehicle. Never drive if you are fighting sleep.

Resisting pressure

There are so many things that can stress you when you are driving: heavy traffic, bad weather, road works, waiting at level crossings, other drivers' bad behaviour – all of these can build up frustration and make it difficult to stay calm and focus on arriving safely at your destination. Your own emotional state can also play a big part in how well you drive. If you are worried or upset, angry or depressed, it will probably show in your driving.

What should a driver do if they are behind schedule in reaching a destination at an appointed time?
Be patient and drive so as to arrive safely.

You should always drive at a speed that allows you to stop safely within the distance you can see to be clear. Being late for an appointment is no excuse for exceeding speed limits or for driving at an unsafe speed. Arrive alive.

What should a driver do if they are not travelling as fast as the vehicle in front?
The driver should keep to the left and allow vehicles to overtake if they wish.

Always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to any traffic situation. You should not drive so slowly that your vehicle unnecessarily blocks other road users. Keep as near to the left as is safe to allow other vehicles to pass safely if they wish.

What should a driver do if they wish to drive across a busy road and the traffic lights which normally control the junction are temporarily out of action?
Take good observation, wait for a clear break in the traffic and proceed to cross the road safely.

Always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to any traffic situation. In this case, do not proceed until it is clear and safe to do so. Do not assume that you have the right of way.

What should a driver do if they see a school bus stopped on the nearside (left side) of the road ahead?
Reduce speed and overtake with caution.

Always read the road and be prepared to react to any traffic situation – in this case, be aware of vulnerable road users such as school children boarding or alighting from school buses.

What should the driver do when driving behind a vehicle that is going from side to side on the road in an unsafe manner?
The driver should stay well back in a safe position.

You should always be prepared to react to hazards ahead. If the vehicle in front is moving from side to side, it may indicate that the driver is not paying full attention or that their driving is impaired by drink, drugs or tiredness. If you think the vehicle is a risk to the public safety, the matter should be reported to the Gardaí or to traffic watch (lo-call 1890 205 805), but not while driving.

What should a driver do if a heavy goods vehicle in front has moved out to make a left turn ahead? ABMW0368RU19

Stay behind it and allow it to complete the turn.

Always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to any traffic situation. In this case, you should be aware that the heavy goods vehicle will need extra space to complete the left-hand turn and you should remain behind the vehicle until it has completed its turn.

What should a driver do if a bus in front has moved out to make a left-hand turn and there is oncoming traffic? ABMW0369RU19

Stay back and allow the bus to complete the turn.

Always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to any traffic situation. In this case, you should be aware that the bus will need extra space to make the turn. So you should not overtake it if by doing so you would cause oncoming traffic to alter speed or course. Remember, you should never overtake when approaching a junction.

What should a driver do if they see a truck reversing into a side entrance on the left-hand side of the road ahead? ABMW0370RU19

Stop back safely and wait until the way is clear.

Always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to any traffic situation. You should be aware of the difficulties that drivers of large vehicles can have reversing into a side entrance. In this case, a large vehicle reversing could obstruct your view of the road ahead as you approach, and you should afford the truck driver adequate space to manoeuvre

What should a driver do if they are first in line to turn right at traffic lights while the green light is showing and there is oncoming traffic approaching? ABMW0371RU19

Go forward towards the centre of the junction and turn safely when a suitable gap appears.

If you wish to turn right at a set of traffic lights, drive into the junction when you see a green light, taking care not to block any oncoming traffic. Then complete the turn when it is safe to do so.

When is it permitted to force oncoming traffic onto the hard shoulder on the opposite side of the road while overtaking? ABMW0372R

It is not permitted to force oncoming traffic onto the hard shoulder while overtaking.

Overtaking in the manner described here is dangerous. You should overtake another vehicle only when it is safe to do so, both for you and for all other traffic. Before you overtake, make sure the road ahead is clear and that you have enough room to complete the overtaking manoeuvre and return to your own side of the road without forcing any other road user to alter speed or course.

When meeting oncoming traffic on a national road, is it permitted to move into the hard shoulder to allow following traffic to overtake?

Yes, temporarily when the hard shoulder is clear and it is safe to drive there. ABMW0374RU19

On national roads, the hard shoulder is normally for the use of pedestrians and cyclists only. If you want to allow a vehicle behind to overtake, you may pull into the hard shoulder briefly as long as no pedestrians or cyclists are using it and there are no junctions or entrances nearby. In the case of motorways, however, you must not drive on the hard shoulder, except in an emergency.

When driving on a national road is it permitted to drive on the hard shoulder in order to allow faster-moving traffic to overtake?

Yes, temporarily when the hard shoulder is clear and it is safe to drive there. ABMW0375RU19

On national roads, the hard shoulder is normally for the use of pedestrians and cyclists only. If you want to allow a vehicle behind to overtake, you may pull into the hard shoulder briefly as long as no pedestrians or cyclists are using it and there are no junctions or entrances nearby. In the case of motorways, however, you must not drive on the hard shoulder, except in an emergency.

What should a driver do in a queue of traffic controlled by traffic lights? ABMW0376RU19

A driver should maintain their position in the queue.

Always read the road ahead and be prepared to react to any traffic situation. From time to time you may have to queue in traffic. In this situation, you should try to remain patient and considerate of other road users. Jumping the queue is inconsiderate, it could be dangerous, and it could even provoke a road rage incident or cause a collision.

What should the driver do when driving a vehicle they are not familiar with? ABMW0377RU19

Initially drive with extra care and at a lower speed until fully familiar with the vehicle.

You should know where to find and how to operate all the controls on your vehicle, including all of its safety features and warning lamps. When you are driving, you need to be able to concentrate on what's happening around you and operating the vehicle controls should be second nature to you. When you sit into the drivers seat of a vehicle you are not familiar with, you should do a thorough cockpit drill before you move off.

What should drivers do if they approach road works and there is earth-moving machinery moving about? ABMW0378RU19

Reduce speed as there may be loose gravel or mud on the road.

Where earth-moving machinery is working, there are likely to be mud and gravel deposits on the road. Also the noise of such machines might make it hard for road workers to hear the approaching traffic. When you come across earth-moving machinery, slow down and proceed with extreme caution.

Subject to the speed limit, what is the 'safest' speed to drive at? ABMW0379RU19

The speed that will enable the driver to stop the vehicle within the distance ahead that they can see to be clear.

You should always drive at a speed that allows you to stop within the distance that you can see to be clear ahead. If you dont think you could safely bring the vehicle to a stop within the range of what you can see, then you're driving too fast – slow down.

Keeping full attention on the road

When you are driving you need to take in a great deal of information – about other traffic, road conditions, direction and warning signs, and so on. Just dealing with that amount of information is quite enough, and you don't need to add to the load by letting yourself be distracted. When you are distracted, your reactions are slower and your judgement is not as good. Remember that it is an offence to drive 'without due care and attention'.

When driving along and wishing to use a hand-held mobile phone, what should a driver do? ABMW0380RU19

Stop at a safe location before using the phone.

It is an offence and very unsafe to use a hand-held mobile phone while driving a vehicle or riding a motorbike as it prevents you from concentrating fully on your driving. While using a hands-free phone kit is not illegal, in some circumstances it could be a dangerous distraction, and you could be prosecuted for dangerous driving, careless driving or driving without due care and attention. If a driver needs to make a call they should pull in and stop in a place where it is safe to do so.

When stopped at traffic lights and the green light comes on, what should a driver do? ABMW0381RU19

Check that other road users have cleared the junction and move off with care.

When stopped at traffic lights and the green light comes on, you should check to ensure the way is clear and proceed only if it is safe to do so.

Patience and courtesy

Aggressive and impatient behaviour can very easily turn into 'road rage', where people who are normally civil and courteous lose self-control and act very irresponsibly. Don't allow yourself to be provoked by other drivers' bad behaviour. Let such drivers go ahead – you will be safer if you are not in their vicinity.

Good drivers stay patient, courteous and tolerant at all times and don't respond to provocation – they know that they'll get there just as quickly if they ignore such actions.

What should a driver do if another vehicle blocks their right of way at a junction? ABMW0382RU19

Be patient and show restraint.

You should always try to show restraint. It is important to understand that the right of way is not an absolute right of way, and you must always proceed with caution and with regard for other road users. It's safer and more socially responsible.

A driver who is about to undertake a journey is upset or angry. What should they do? ABMW0383RU19

A driver should not drive until they are calm.

If you drive when you are angry or upset, you are more likely to be involved in a collision, and more likely to react to other drivers bad behaviour. Take the time to calm down and compose yourself before you set out on a journey.

When being overtaken and there is oncoming traffic, what should a driver do? ABMW0384RU19

Allow the overtaking vehicle to pass and return safely to the left side of the road.

When you are being overtaken and there are oncoming vehicles, you should show consideration for all the other traffic and allow the overtaking vehicle to move in front of you to avoid the risk of a collision.

When another driver is in a hurry and cuts in front what should a driver do? ABMW0385RU19

Be patient and not retaliate.

If another driver behaves badly, you should not let it annoy you – show restraint and don't react. Road rage only increases the risk of a collision.

What should a driver do when they get a puncture while driving? ABMW0386RU19

Stop at a safe place and change the wheel.

If you get a puncture while driving, find a suitable and safe place to stop and change the wheel. If you cant find a suitable place immediately, drive slowly (with your hazard warning lights turned on) to avoid further damage to the tyre or rim until a safe place is found.

What should a driver do when they want to safely change to the lane on the right in which there is other traffic? ABMW0387RU19

Use the mirror, signal and move into the right-hand lane when a suitable gap appears in the traffic in that lane.

Any time you change lanes, you should use the Mirror–Signal–Mirror (blind spots)–Manoeuvre routine. Check your mirrors, signal your intention, check your mirrors again (and your blind spots), and when a suitable gap becomes available manoeuvre the vehicle into the next lane, giving way to traffic already in that lane.

Alcohol and drugs

Alcohol and many other drugs seriously impair your ability to drive safely. The questions in this section check that you fully understand this issue and know how to comply with the law in this respect.

What effect does alcohol have on driver behaviour? ABMW0388RU19
It slows down a driver's reactions.

Alcohol is a major factor in collisions that can lead to death and injury. Even small amounts of alcohol affect your judgement and ability to drive.

What effect does drinking alcohol have on a driver? ABMW0389RU19
It reduces concentration.

Alcohol is a major factor in collisions that lead to death and injury. Even small amounts of alcohol affect your judgement, your concentration and your ability to react to hazards. A driver should never ever drink and drive.

If a motorist or a motorcyclist is taking medication which may affect their driving, what should they do? ABMW0390RU19
Seek medical advice in relation to driving.

Some medication can affect a drivers ability to drive safely. If you are on medication of any kind, you should ask your doctor or pharmacist to tell you if it is safe to drive while taking it. Read the patient information leaflet supplied with the medication.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, which gender was more likely to drink and drive and be involved a fatal collision? RSA000039A
Males

As a proportion of all 867 fatal collisions analysed, 38% cited alcohol as the main contributory factor. Of this number, 29% involved at least one driver or motorcyclist with a record of alcohol consumption prior to the collision. This highlights the fact that a high level of drink driving is still evident in Ireland. **FACT:** All of these drivers were deemed culpable or part culpable for the collision through their behaviour on the road prior to the collision.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, what type of vehicle were the majority of people driving when they had consumed alcohol and caused a fatal collision? RSA000018A
Private Car

All 28 of the female drivers who had consumed alcohol were driving a private car. Table 2, See Pre Crash Report (RSA) sets out the age band of the driver who had consumed alcohol by the vehicle driven. The group of Agricultural vehicles includes tractors. **FACT:** Almost half of the drivers of a private car were aged between 16 and 24 years.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, what type of fatal collision was a person more likely to be involved in when drink driving? RSA000039A
Single-vehicle collision

178 drink drivers were killed in a single vehicle collision and 24 were seriously injured. **FACT:** Forty nine passengers were travelling in the car with someone who had consumed alcohol and were killed.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, which days of the week were people more likely to drink and drive and cause a fatal collision? RSA000040A
Saturday and Sunday

Drink driving is dangerous regardless of when it takes place. Unfortunately, some drivers will drink on any day so we must always stay alert and expect the unexpected. **FACT:** Currently the evidence shows us that Saturday and Sunday were the most frequent days of collisions. Fifty seven percent of the motorcyclists crashed on a Sunday compared to 29% of the drivers.

What is the maximum disqualification period imposed in court where the learner driver has a blood alcohol concentration (BAC) level in excess of 80 mg? RSA000049A
Six years

Where a learner driver has failed to pay a fixed penalty notice they will be summonsed to court where a judge can apply a disqualification period of between 1 - 6 yrs.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, which age group had the highest number of drivers causing fatal collisions where alcohol was a factor?
RSA00061E
16-24 years

Table 8, See Pre Crash Report (RSA) sets out the available blood alcohol concentrate (BAC) in drivers by the age group. In total 151 drivers had a record of a BAC. FACT: In total, 47% of the drivers aged between 16 and 24 years had a BAC of 201 to 251+.

A driver is automatically disqualified from driving for how long if, on a first offence, they refused to provide a member of An Garda Síochána with a sample of blood, urine or breath?
RSA00046A
4 years

It is an offence not to comply with a request from a member of An Garda Síochána to provide to provide a sample of breath, urine or blood.

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Which of the following is a possible consequence for a learner driver if they drive after drinking as little as just one unit of alcohol?
RSA00046AU19
A three month disqualification from driving

The blood alcohol concentrate limit for novice/learner drivers is much lower than that of a driver who has held their full licence for more than two years (not a novice driver). Therefore as little as one unit of alcohol would result in the driver exceeding the lower limit.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, out of 867 fatal collisions, how many had alcohol as a contributory factor?
RSA00056AU19
251-350

Alcohol was a contributory factor in fatal collisions. See Pre Crash Report (RSA).

According to the Pre-Crash Report, what age group had the highest number of passenger deaths in collisions where alcohol was a factor?
RSA00064A
17-24 years

For a variety of reasons, including the young drivers likelihood to drink, when accompanied by peers, passengers in a vehicle driven by a younger driver (17-24yrs) are more likely to be killed.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, how many passengers were killed in a collision where alcohol was a known factor?
RSA00053AU19
Between 71 - 90

The Pre-crash Report found that 83 passengers were killed in an alcohol related collision where a driver or motorcyclist had been drinking between 2008 and 2012. In addition, passengers who have been drinking may contribute to crashes, sometimes distracting the driver. Safe and socially responsible road use goes beyond the drivers themselves. If you want to stay safe, you must take responsibility for your own actions, especially as to how they might affect drivers and other road users.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, what percentage of the 169 drivers killed in an alcohol related collision had consumed alcohol?
RSA00050A
92%

FACT: During the period 2008 - 2012 a total of 169 drivers were killed of which 92% had consume alcohol prior to the crash. Other fatalities were Pedestrians, Passengers etc

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According to the Pre-Crash Report, how many pedestrians were killed where alcohol consumption by the pedestrian was a factor?
RSA00051A
Between 41 - 90

FACT: During the period 2008 - 2012 a total of 80 pedestrians were killed where either the driver, the pedestrian or both had consumed alcohol prior to the collision.

According to the Pre-Crash Report, in how many fatal collisions was alcohol a contributory factor?
RSA00053AU19
Between 31 to 45 %

According to the Pre-Crash Report 2008-2012, alcohol was cited as a contributing factor in 38% of the 867 collision on file.

During what time periods can a driver be tested for drugs at a road side checkpoint?
RSA01045U19
Anytime of day or night.

The law allows for a driver to be tested at any time.

What are the drink driving penalties for a learner driver with a blood alcohol concentrate (BAC) of 20mg to 80mg per 100 millilitres of blood?
€200 fine and 3 months driving disqualification.
RSA0200

Alcohol is a major factor in crashes that lead to death and injury. Research proves that even small amounts of alcohol affect your judgment and ability to drive. It is illegal to drive with alcohol levels above the legal limits.

What are the drink driving penalties for a professional driver holding a full car licence and found to have a blood alcohol concentrate (BAC) of 20mg to 80mg per 100 millilitres of blood?
RSA0201
€200 fine and 3 months driving disqualification.

Alcohol is a major factor in crashes that lead to death and injury. Research proves that even small amounts of alcohol affect your judgment and ability to drive. It is illegal to drive with alcohol levels above the legal limits.

What are the drink driving penalties for a driver with a blood alcohol concentrate (BAC) of 80mg to 100 mg per 100 millilitres of blood?
RSA020
€400 fine and 6 months driving disqualification.

Alcohol is a major factor in crashes that lead to death and injury. Research proves that even small amounts of alcohol affect your judgment and ability to drive. It is illegal to drive with alcohol levels above the legal limits.

What is the penalty for a driver who refuses to give breath, blood or urine samples as evidence for a second offence to An Gárda Síochána?
RSA02
Automatic disqualification for 6 years.

Alcohol is a major factor in crashes that lead to death and injury. Research proves that even small amounts of alcohol or drugs affect your judgment and ability to drive. It is illegal to drive with alcohol levels above the legal limits, or while under the influence of drugs. It is an offence to refuse to give a breath, blood or urine sample.

Can An Gárda Síochana conduct roadside testing for drugs and alcohol in the mornings?
RSA0204
Yes, they can check at any time.

It is against the law to drive a car, motor bike, truck, bus, pedal bike or an animal-drawn vehicle while 'under the influence of an intoxicant to such an extent as to be incapable of having control of the vehicle'. Intoxicants include alcohol and drugs, whether taken separately or together. The word 'drugs' here includes legal prescribed and over-the-counter (OTC) medicines.

Along with an impairment test, what may a Gárda request if they suspect a driver of driving under the influence of drugs?
RSA0205
A saliva sample.

If a driver is stopped at a roadside check, they should be aware that, along with the impairment test, Gardaí can also request a saliva sample if they suspect the driver is driving under the influence of drugs.

What is the maximum penalty on conviction for drug driving?
€5,000 fine and 6 months in prison.
RSA0206

Drivers should be aware of the severe penalties if they chose to drive having taken drugs and are detected. Drug driving is extremely dangerous due to the effect drugs have on the brain.

Do the limits for drink and drug driving differ if detected in the morning?
No, they are the same at all times.
RSA0207

The limits for drink and drug driving do not change depending on the time of the day drivers are checked. Drink and drugs remain in the body for a period of time. A driver should think carefully before driving a vehicle the morning after taking drink or drugs, and be aware that they could still be well over the limit.

Overtaking and driving when weather or road conditions are hazardous

Before overtaking a slower-moving vehicle, ask yourself whether it is necessary to do so, whether it is legal, and, above all, whether it is safe. When passing parked vehicles, leave enough room for the door of the parked vehicle to open. And when driving on icy roads, make sure that you leave enough stopping distance between your vehicle and the vehicle in front.

What effect does a wet road surface have on a vehicle's braking ability? ABMW0392RU19

Generally, it doubles the braking distance of that required on a dry surface.

When it is wet, your tyres do not grip the road surface as well as when it is dry and your stopping distance is increased. For these reasons you should slow down during or after rain and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

After overtaking another vehicle, what should a driver do? ABMW0394RU19

Gradually move back into the left when the vehicle has been passed.

After overtaking, check your mirrors, signal and return to your normal lane position as soon as it is safe. Take a smooth easy line, gradually moving back in and allowing the other vehicle plenty of space and don't cut in sharply.

What would happen if a driver cuts in too soon when overtaking another vehicle? ABMW0395AU19

It would force the other vehicle to suddenly slow or change direction causing danger.

When overtaking make sure the road ahead is clear so you have enough distance to overtake and get back to your own side of the road without forcing any other road user to adjust speed or direction. When you are well past the vehicle, check the mirrors, signal and gradually return to the original lane, making sure not to cut across the vehicle you have passed.

What should a driver do when overtaking parked vehicles in a residential area? ABMW0396RU19

Allow sufficient clearance when passing.

When you are passing parked vehicles in a residential area, move into a safe overtaking position in good time and leave plenty of clearance between your vehicle and the parked vehicles to increase visibility of small children in the area and in case someone opens their car door in front of you.

What stopping distance should a driver allow for when driving in snow or icy conditions? ABMW0397RU19

Up to ten times the normal distance.

When driving in snow or icy conditions a driver should allow a greater distance from the vehicle in front as stopping distances can be increased by up to ten times the normal.

What clearance should drivers normally allow for when passing parked vehicles? ABMW0398RU19

A door width.

When you are passing parked vehicles, you should leave at least a door's width of clearance in case somebody opens their car door unexpectedly, this will also increase visibility of pedestrians in the area.

Why does it take longer to stop the vehicle on a wet road? ABMW0399AU19

The tyres have less road grip than in dry weather.

When driving on wet road surfaces the grip of your tyres is reduced which may lead to significantly longer stopping distances. Drivers should be aware of these conditions and reduce speed as stopping quickly may result in skidding.

Roadholding

Your ability to control your vehicle and to stop it safely and effectively depends to a large extent on the quality of your tyres, the road surface and the contact between them. The tyres' grip on the road can be reduced or even eliminated by water, oil, ice, wet leaves, or loose chippings. You need to be aware of this fact, and reduce speed if you are driving in these conditions.

What is the effect on the control of the vehicle if there is a film of water between the vehicle's tyres and the road surface? ABMW0400RU19

Steering and braking will be less effective.

When driving on a road where there is a lot of surface water, a film of water can build up between the tyres and the road surface. When this occurs it is called aquaplaning, it reduces the grip of the tyres on the road and can result in the total loss of control over the vehicles steering and braking.

What should a driver do if they encounter loose chippings on a road? ABMW0401RU19

Slow down and allow extra clearance to other traffic.

Where there are loose chippings on the road, you should slow down and comply with any reduced speed limit and leave extra room (or clearance) between your vehicle and other traffic. This will also give you more time to stop if you need to, and it will help to reduce the amount of chippings your vehicle throws up against other vehicles and possible injury to pedestrians.

What effect does patches of oil or diesel have on a road surface? ABMW0402RAU19

It reduces the tyre surface grip.

A patch of oil or diesel on the road can seriously reduce the grip of your tyres on the road, which may result in a possible skid.

What should a driver do when driving in slippery road conditions? ABMW0403RU19

Drive at lower speeds and use gentle acceleration and braking.

When driving in slippery road conditions, drivers should be particularly smooth and gradual in the way they accelerate and brake. This will help to avoid skidding or slipping and helps to maintain control of the vehicle.

What should a driver do when travelling downhill on snow or ice? ABMW0404RU19

Select an appropriate gear and brake gently to control speed.

When travelling downhill in snow or ice, you should select a lower gear to take advantage of engine braking and use the brakes very gently when you need to.

Maintaining a safe distance from the vehicle in front

Never drive too close to the vehicle in front of you. The faster the traffic is moving, the greater the distance you should allow. The distance it will take you to stop in an emergency depends on many things, including how alert you are, the type and condition of the road surface, and the condition of your brakes and tyres. The questions in this section check that you understand the need to keep your distance, and that you know how to do so.

How does driving at high speed affect a vehicle's road holding? ABMW0405R

The road holding ability of the vehicle is reduced.

Driving at high speed is a factor that affects road holding. At higher speeds the airflow under a vehicle reduces tyre grip on the road and when you are approaching a bend or corner, the momentum of the vehicle makes it more difficult to change direction.

What is the recommended minimum stopping distance for a car travelling at 50Km/h on a dry road? ABMW0406RAU19

25 metres.

The total minimum stopping distance of a vehicle depends on four things; perception time, reaction time, the vehicles reaction time and the vehicle braking capability. The recommend minimum stopping distance of a car driving at 50km/h under dry conditions is 25 metres.

What is the recommended minimum stopping distance for a car travelling at 50km/h on a wet road? ABMW0407RAU19

36 metres.

The total minimum stopping distance of a vehicle depends on four things; perception time, reaction time, the vehicles reaction time and the vehicle braking capability. The recommend minimum stopping distance of a car driving at 50km/h under wet conditions is 36 metres.

What is the recommended minimum stopping distance for a car travelling at 100km/h on a dry road? ABMW0408RAU19

70 metres.

The total minimum stopping distance of a vehicle depends on four things; perception time, reaction time, the vehicles reaction time and the vehicle braking capability. The recommend minimum stopping distance of a car driving at 100km/h under dry conditions is 70 metres.

What is a likely consequence of sudden braking? ABMW0425RU19

The vehicle could be hit from behind.

As well as reading the road ahead, you should also be aware of traffic travelling behind you. This will help you react correctly in a situation where you need to brake suddenly.

Which of the following affects the braking distance of a vehicle? ABMW0426R

The speed and weight of the vehicle.

The overall stopping distance of your vehicle depends on its speed and weight – faster and heavier vehicles require greater stopping distances.

In dry weather how might a driver judge what is a safe following distance to vehicle in front? ABMW0427RU19

By using a fixed point and applying the two second rule.

A driver can judge a safe distance from the vehicle in front by using the two second rule. This is measured by picking a fixed point. As the vehicle in front passes it, begin saying "only a fool breaks the two second rule". If you pass the fixed point before you have finished the phrase, then your vehicle is too close, safely slow and increase your distance from the vehicle in front.

In wet weather how might a driver judge what is a safe following distance from the vehicle in front?

By allowing at least four seconds to elapse between the vehicle in front and the driver's own vehicle passing a fixed point.

In wet conditions you should maintain a gap of at least four seconds from the vehicle in front – at least twice as long as in dry conditions.

What phrase is recommended for drivers to help them determine a safe distance from the vehicle in front on a dry road?

ABMW0429RU19

"Only a fool breaks the two second rule."

A driver can judge a safe distance from the vehicle in front by using the two second rule. This is measured by picking a fixed point. As the vehicle in front passes it, begin saying "only a fool breaks the two second rule". If you pass the fixed point before you have finished the phrase, then your vehicle is too close, safely slow and increase your distance from the vehicle in front.

What effect does carrying a load have on a vehicle's braking ability?

It increases the distance required to stop.

ABMW0430RU19

When driving a vehicle which is carrying a load, the driver should be aware that the forces acting on the vehicle will increase the distance required to stop. The driver should allow for this by increasing the distance from the vehicle in front.

What effect does towing a loaded trailer have on stopping ability?

It increases the stopping distance.

ABMW0434RU19

If you are towing a loaded trailer, you need to be aware that your braking distance could be considerably greater, depending on the weight and size of the trailer. The driver should allow for this by increasing the distance from the vehicle in front.

Driving when visibility is reduced

When your visibility is reduced, such as in rain, snow or fog, you must modify your driving behaviour. The questions in this section check that you understand this issue and can take appropriate action when necessary.

What lights should a driver use when driving in dense fog?
Drive with dipped headlights and fog lights.

In dense fog you should use dipped headlights and fog lights (where fitted). Sidelights are not strong enough in fog, and full headlights can reflect off the fog and make it harder to see where you are going.

What should a driver do when driving in dense fog?
Reduce speed and use dipped headlights.

In dense fog you should reduce your speed and use dipped headlights and fog lights (where fitted). Sidelights are not strong enough in fog, and full headlights can reflect off the fog and make it harder to see where you are going.

Driving at night

Driving at night is considerably more challenging than driving during the day. You need to drive more slowly to take account of the reduced visibility, and you need to use your lights to make sure that you can be seen by other road users and that you can see the road ahead.

When driving at night the full headlights of a typical car should enable the driver to see for a distance of how many metres?
100 metres.

At night in good driving conditions the full headlights of a car will typically let you see 100 metres ahead. So, you should travel at a speed that allows you to stop within that distance.

When driving at night the dipped headlights of a typical car should enable the driver to see for a distance of how many metres?
30 metres.

When driving at night in good driving conditions the dipped headlights of a car will typically let you see 30 metres ahead. So, you should travel at a speed that allows you to stop in that distance.

What are the possible consequences of having incorrectly adjusted headlights? ABMW0439RU19
Oncoming road users could be dazzled.

You are responsible for making sure that your vehicle is roadworthy and that its headlights are adjusted correctly. If the headlights are out of line they are less effective and may dazzle oncoming traffic, even when dipped.

When driving at night, when must a driver dip the vehicle's full headlights? ABMW0440R
When meeting or driving behind other traffic.

When driving at night you should dip your headlights when you meet oncoming vehicles so that you do not dazzle them. And you should also dip your headlights when you are driving behind another vehicle so the driver is not dazzled by your lights in their mirror.

When driving at night and blinded by the lights of an oncoming vehicle, what should a driver do? ABMW0441RU19
Look towards the verge and slow down and stop if necessary.

If you are dazzled by the lights of an oncoming vehicle, look towards the verge until the vehicle has passed. Slow down and stop if necessary.

A driver has been driving regularly in daylight and must now undertake a journey at night. What should the driver do? ABMW0442RU19
Drive at a slower speed than in the day as visibility is reduced at night.

If you are not familiar with driving at night time, it can take quite a while to adjust to conditions. For that reason, you might need to drive slower until you get used to the reduced visibility at night.

With regard to vehicle speed, what should a driver do when driving at night? ABMW0443RU19

Drive at a speed that enables the driver to stop within the distance ahead that they can see to be clear.

When driving at night in good driving conditions the full headlights of a car will typically let you see 100 metres ahead. So, you should travel at a speed that allows you to stop in that distance.

When driving at night, what is the safest approach for a driver to adopt?

Drive at a speed that enables the driver to stop within the distance ahead that they can see to be clear. ABMW0444RU19

When driving at night in good driving conditions the dipped headlights of a car will typically let you see 30 metres ahead. So, you should travel at a speed that allows you to stop in that distance.

When meeting an oncoming vehicle at night, what should a driver do?

Avoid looking directly at the oncoming vehicle's lights. ABMW0445RU19

If you are dazzled by the lights of an oncoming vehicle, look towards the verge until the vehicle has passed and /or slow down and stop if necessary.

When is it safe for a driver to use the main beam headlights when driving at night? ABMW0446RU19

When there is no oncoming traffic.

Drivers should use the main beam headlights, to improve visibility, when driving at night in unlit rural areas – this will enable them to see as far ahead as possible. Making sure, however, that these lights are dimmed where necessary to avoid dazzling or inconveniencing other road users.

What lights should a driver have on when driving behind other traffic at night? ABMW0447RU19

Dipped headlights.

Drivers should dip their headlights when driving behind another vehicle so the driver in front is not dazzled by your lights in their mirror.

When driving at night, when must a driver use dipped headlights? ABMW0448RU19

When meeting or driving behind other traffic.

When driving at night drivers should dip their main beam headlights when meeting or following traffic to avoid dazzling or endangering other road users.

When driving late at night what should a driver be aware of? ABMW0449RU19

That there is a danger of themselves or other drivers falling asleep.

Driving when tired can be very dangerous and driver fatigue is one of the main causes of serious road collisions. If a driver becomes drowsy while driving, they should stop in a safe place take a caffeine-based drink and take a short nap. After this they should then get some fresh air and stretch their legs for a few minutes before setting off again. The only cure for fatigue is proper sleep. Never ever drive when tired.

When dazzled by the lights of an oncoming vehicle, what should a driver do? ABMW0450RU19

Do not look directly at the lights.

If dazzled by the lights of an oncoming vehicle, do not look directly at the oncoming lights. Instead glance towards the verge until the vehicle has passed and /or slow down and stop if necessary. This will avoid any temporary blindness caused by the brightness of the oncoming lights.

When should a driver use fog lights on their vehicle? ABMW0451RU19

Use foglights only in dense fog and falling snow.

A driver should use fog lights only during dense fog or falling snow. They must be switched off at all other times.

Driving on slippery roads

Driving on a road that is covered with water, oil, ice, wet leaves or loose chippings is particularly dangerous, because your vehicle's tyres have greatly reduced 'grip' on the road surface and you may skid and lose control of the vehicle. The questions in this section check that you understand this danger and know how to respond.

When can a driver expect to encounter black ice? ABMW0452RU19

When the temperature drops close to freezing.

Black ice is an almost invisible and thin coating of ice on the surface of the road. Sometimes it can look like a sheet of water or as if the road is wet.

What should a driver do if there is black ice on the road? ABMW0453RU19

Avoid harsh braking, steering and acceleration.

If a driver suspects black ice, they should avoid harsh braking, steering and acceleration. This will help reduce the risk of skidding.

Where is black ice likely to occur on the road? ABMW0454RU19

In sheltered or shaded areas.

Black ice is an almost invisible and thin coating of ice on the road surface. Because it is hard to see, it is particularly dangerous. When the temperature drops close to freezing you can expect to see black ice. - particularly in sheltered or shaded areas of the roadway under trees or beside high walls. In wintry conditions, if you notice a reduction in tyre noise or if the steering becomes lighter, you should suspect that there may be black ice on the road.

What is the safest practice when driving on icy roads? ABMW0455RU19

Drive at a slower speed than usual using gentle acceleration and braking.

When driving on icy roads you should avoid harsh braking, steering and acceleration. This will help reduce the risk of skidding.

When driving, what effect could icy roads have on the vehicle? ABMW0456RU19

The vehicle would be more likely to skid.

Icy roads can have a dramatic effect on the way a vehicle handles, and there can be an increased risk of skidding. When driving on icy roads a driver should avoid harsh braking, steering and acceleration. This will help reduce the risk of skidding.

What should a driver do when driving in slippery road conditions? ABMW0457RU19

Use gentle acceleration and braking.

Tyres have less grip on the road when it is wet or icy. Slow down in slippery conditions, and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

How should a driver negotiate a steep hill or humpbacked bridge when the road is slippery? ABMW0458RU19

Drive with extreme caution.

Be extra careful when negotiating steep hills or humpbacked bridges in slippery conditions. Slow down gently on the approach, select the appropriate gear for the speed of the vehicle and use gentle steering and acceleration.

Apart from the risk of skidding, what should the driver be aware of when driving in snow? ABMW0459RU19

Road signs and road markings may become obscured.

Road signs and road markings may become obscured by snow. If this happens you may have difficulty reading regulatory, warning and information signs. This is the main reason why these signs are different shapes. Drivers should pay particular attention when travelling in these conditions.

What should a driver do when driving in heavy rain? ABMW0460RU19

Be aware that the vehicle may slide or 'aquaplane'.

On a wet road, a film of water can build up between the tyres and the road surface. This is called aquaplaning and it has the effect of reducing the grip of the tyres on the road, and this affects the steering and braking. For these reasons the driver should slow down during and after rain and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

What is the danger in driving at high speeds on wet roads? ABMW0461RU19

Danger of 'aquaplaning' or sliding across the road surface.

The driver should moderate their speed during heavy rain or where water is building up on the road surface. This will help to avoid 'aquaplaning' which has the effect of reducing the grip of the tyres on the road, and this affects the steering and braking. For these reasons the driver should slow down during and after rain and keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.

What should a driver do when they encounter mud on the road? ABMW0462RU19

Reduce speed and be aware of farm or works vehicles on the road.

Where there is mud on the road you should slow down and be aware that there is a danger of skidding. Your stopping distance will also be greater where there is mud on the road.

What should a rider be aware of when crossing road markings such as lines or arrows? ABMW0464RU19

Tyre grip is reduced.

Riding on just 2 wheels, riders need to be on the constant lookout for irregularities and other problems with the road surface. This can include all road markings.

Driving on flooded roads

When you have driven through a large puddle or flooded area, you should test your brakes to make sure that they have not been affected by the water. If they have been affected (and if it is safe to do so), press gently on the brake pedal as you are driving until the brakes dry out and return to normal.

What should a driver do after passing through a flooded section of road? ABMW0465RU19

Apply the brake pedal lightly at slow speed for a short distance to dry the brakes.

When driving through a flooded section of road, brakes may become less effective. If this happens, test brakes to ensure that they have not been affected by the water – check mirrors before doing so. If they have been affected, press gently on the brake pedal when driving until they dry out and return to normal.

What should a driver do where a section of road ahead has a shallow flooded area? ABMW0467RU19

Drive in a low gear as slowly as possible keeping the revs high.

When approaching a stretch of road with shallow flooding, reduce speed and assess the area for any danger. When driving through surface water, drive in a low gear as slowly as possible keeping the revs high to avoid stalling.

Roadworks

The National Roads Authority and local authorities around the country are continually working to provide a safe, efficient road network and to maintain the quality of road surfaces. Roadworks include the construction of new roads, emergency repairs, routine maintenance of fences and barriers, trimming hedgerows, clearing litter, cutting grass verges, and so on.

When you come across roadworks of any kind, you need to drive with extra care, for your own safety, the safety of other road users and the safety of the road workers.

What should a driver do when approaching roadworks warning signs?
Reduce speed and be prepared to stop for works vehicles or a flagman. ABMW0468RU18

A driver should always approach roadworks with caution as there are many possible hazards to deal with – including road workers, works vehicles, uneven road surfaces and temporary traffic controls.

What should a driver be aware of when driving through a section of road where roadworks are ongoing? ABMW0469RU19
Narrower lanes than usual and restricted shoulder areas.

When travelling through a section of roadworks, a driver needs to be extra careful, as the road surface area may be considerably reduced. It may be narrower, uneven, slippery or there may be loose chippings which may pose a danger for road workers and other road users.

To whom should a driver report aggressive driving? CPC1348RU10
Local Garda Station or Traffic Watch.

Report all aggressive driving incidents to Traffic Watch or a Garda station. They are the best people to deal with aggressive driving.

Driving on different types of road

Different types of road require you to drive in different ways, impose different restrictions on what you must or must not do, and present different things that you must look out for. The questions in this section deal with a variety of road types and the challenges they present, and check that you know how to behave when driving on them.

One-way streets

Driving on a one-way street can be confusing. Your inclination may be to always adopt a position to the left of the street, as would be appropriate if it were a two-way street. However, if you wish to turn right off the street, you should take up a position to the right.

When wishing to turn right at the end of a one-way street, where should a driver position their vehicle? ABMW0470RU19

Drive as close as is possible to the right-hand side of the road.

When a driver wants to turn right on a one way street, they should check their mirrors, signal right and manoeuvre into the right-hand side when it is safe to do so. Then complete the turn into the appropriate lane of the street they are entering.

Bus lanes

There are two types of bus lane: 'with-flow' bus lanes and 'contra-flow' bus lanes, and the rules governing what vehicles may use them are different. In addition, a bus lane may be operational only at certain times of the day, as specified on the plate accompanying the bus lane sign.

When a driver wants to turn left into a property and there is a bus lane on the left, what should the driver do? ABMW0472RU19

Give way to cyclists, taxis and buses which may be using the bus lane.

If a driver needs to cross a bus lane on their left in order to enter a property, they should take extra care that there are no buses, taxis or cyclists in the bus lane. They should check mirrors, signal and turn into the property when it is safe to do so.

What traffic may use a contra-flow bus lane? ABMW0474RU19

Buses on a scheduled service.

A contra-flow bus lane is one that runs in the opposite direction to traffic beside it. Only buses on a scheduled service may use a contra-flow bus lane.

What traffic may use a with-flow bus lane during the times specified on information signs at the start of the lane? ABMW0475RU19

Buses, taxis and cyclists.

A bus lane is a special lane for the use of buses. A with-flow bus lane is one that runs in the same direction as the traffic beside it. Taxis and cyclists may also use with-flow bus lanes. Other traffic may use them outside the hours posted on the accompanying plate.

Dual carriageways

The questions in this section deal with entering, crossing and driving along dual carriageways. Traffic on these roads is generally faster that on other roads, so you need to know how to act appropriately without undue hesitation.

When driving along a dual carriageway in normal driving conditions, which lane should a driver be in? ABMW0477RU19

In the left-hand lane unless the driver wishes to overtake or turn right.

You must normally drive in the left-hand lane of a dual carriageway, except when overtaking or turning right a short distance ahead.

'2-plus-1' roads

'2-plus-1' roads provide two lanes in one direction and one lane in the opposite direction. On the two-lane side, it is generally safe to overtake. Approximately every two kilometres, the two-lane side is replaced by one lane and the one-lane side opens out into two lanes. The questions in this section check that you understand how to drive on such roads.

What does a 2-plus-1 road have? ABMW0480R

Two non-motorway lanes in one direction and one non-motorway lane in the opposite direction.

A 2-plus-1 road consists of two lanes in one direction of travel and one lane in the other direction. The two-lane section allows for safe overtaking and alternates with a one-lane section roughly every 2 kilometres.

What does a 2-plus-1 road have? ABMW0482RU19

Two lanes of traffic in one direction and one in the opposite direction.

A 2-plus-1 road consists of two lanes in one direction of travel and one lane in the other direction. The two-lane section allows for safe overtaking and alternates with a one-lane section roughly every 2 kilometres.

Where may a driver overtake on a 2-plus-1 road? ABMW0483R

In the two-lane stretch.

A 2 plus-1 road consists of two lanes in one direction of travel and one lane in the other direction. When you need to overtake, you should wait until you reach the 2-lane section which occurs approximately every 2 kilometres.

Motorways

Driving on a motorway requires concentration and discipline. You need to know exactly how to behave when entering and leaving a motorway, how to drive on it, and what to expect from other drivers while on it. Although you are not permitted to drive on a motorway while holding a learner permit, the questions in this section check that you know and understand the issues involved.

What should a driver do when travelling on a motorway or dual carriageway? ABMW0484RU19

Be alert for other drivers who may suddenly change lanes or reduce speed.

Motorways and dual carriageways are designed to help traffic travel faster and more safely between destinations. Traffic conditions can change very quickly because of the speed and increased volumes of traffic and lanes, and you need to be particularly alert to other drivers changing lanes or reducing speed.

In normal driving conditions on a motorway, which lane should the driver occupy? ABMW0485RU19

Drive in the nearside (left-hand) lane unless intending to overtake.

The normal keep left rules apply when you are driving on a motorway – a driver should stay in the nearside (left hand) lane unless they are overtaking.

Which of the following statements is true in relation to tyre pressure and driving on a motorway? ABMW0487RU19

The driver should ensure that tyre pressure is correct, in line with the manufacturer's recommendations.

The driver should ensure that the tyre pressure of their vehicle is correct at all times. Correct tyre pressure is especially important when travelling long distances, on motorways and at speed.

What should a driver do when joining a motorway from a slip road? ABMW0488RU19

Try to match the vehicle speed to that of traffic already on the motorway and merge into it in a suitable gap.

When joining a motorway a driver should try to match their speed to that of the motorway traffic and merge into it when a suitable gap appears, avoiding driving in the hard shoulder, while yielding to traffic already on the motorway.

When joining a motorway from a slip road, what should a driver do? CD0173RU19

Adjust speed to match that of the motorway traffic, and merge into a suitable gap.

When joining a motorway from a slip road, drivers should adjust their speed to that of the motorway traffic on the acceleration lane and merge into a suitable gap in Lane 1. Do not force other traffic to swerve or slow down to avoid your vehicle.

Is a driver permitted to pick up or set down a passenger on a motorway? ABMW0489RU19

A driver is never permitted to pick up or set down passengers on a motorway.

Motorways are designed so that traffic can move faster and more freely. It is illegal and dangerous to stop a vehicle on any part of a motorway except in an emergency or when signalled to do so by a Garda.

When driving on a motorway, what should a driver do if they miss their exit? ABMW0490RU19

Leave the motorway at the next exit and cross to the other side using the fly-over (or underpass).

If a driver misses their intended exit when driving on a motorway, they should proceed to the next junction exit where they can leave the motorway and then rejoin it on the opposite side of the motorway.

What should a driver do when entering a slip road after leaving a motorway? ABMW0492RU19

Comply with the speed limit on the road the driver is joining.

When a driver is leaving a motorway, they should enter the deceleration lane and reduce their speed. They should comply with the speed limit of the road they are entering.

What should a driver do if they drive past their intended exit by mistake?
Drive on and leave at the next exit.

ABMW0493RU19

If a driver misses their intended exit when driving on a motorway, they should proceed to the next junction exit where they can leave the motorway and then rejoin it in the opposite direction.

What is the main difference between driving on a motorway and driving on other types of road?
Traffic is generally permitted to travel at a higher speed on a motorway.

ABMW0494RU19

Motorways are designed so that traffic can move faster and more freely, without traffic lights, crossroads, level crossings and other road features that might slow down traffic. There are also restrictions on who may use a motorway – for example L-drivers and motorcycles under 50cc are prohibited.

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On a 2-lane motorway, what procedure should a driver adopt when wishing to overtake another vehicle safely?
Use their mirrors, signal and overtake in the right-hand lane when it is safe to do so.

ABMW0495RU19

When a driver wants to overtake on a motorway, they should generally only overtake on the right unless traffic is travelling in slow moving queues. The driver should use the Mirror-Signal-Mirror (blind spots)-Manoeuvre routine. Check mirrors, signal intention, check mirrors again (and blind spots), and complete the manoeuvre when it is safe to do so. They should pay particular attention to the speed of the traffic behind them before they move out. When they have finished overtaking, they should move back into the left-hand lane smoothly.

What may the hard shoulder of a motorway be used for?
Stopping in an emergency.

ABMW0496RU19

There are extra dangers when driving on a motorway because of the increased volume of traffic and higher speed. For safety reasons a driver should not drive or stop on the hard shoulder of a motorway except in an emergency or breakdown.

After exiting the motorway and coming towards a junction at the end of the deceleration lane (slip road) what should a driver do?
Be alert for oncoming and crossing traffic at the end of the slip road.

ABMW0497RU19

The driver should check for signs showing a lower speed; Use the speedometer to make sure that they are obeying the reduced speed limit ; remember that the slip roads and link roads between motorways may include sharp bends and that they may encounter junctions and other traffic. Remember that motorway rules no longer apply.

Junctions – roads of equal importance

A driver wishes to go straight ahead at a cross junction of equal importance. If they encounter other traffic, what is the general rule that applies?
Traffic approaching from the driver's right has right of way.

ABMW0499RU19

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If a driver is at a junction where the roads are of equal importance, traffic on the driver's right has the right of way. The driver must let that traffic pass before moving on. It is important to understand that the right of way is not an absolute right. Drivers must proceed with caution whilst showing regard for other users of the road.

Clearways

What is a clearway?
An area where stopping and parking is not permitted during certain times.

ABMW0501RU19

A clearway is an area of road that must be kept clear for moving traffic during certain times of the day (usually busy periods). The times when stopping or parking is prohibited are shown on an information plate under the sign.

Roundabouts

The questions in this section check that you know how to negotiate roundabouts, and in particular that you know which lane to choose and understand that traffic already on the roundabout has right of way over someone about to enter it.

When approaching a roundabout, to whom should a driver give way? ABMW0507RU19

The driver must give way to traffic approaching from the right or already on the roundabout.

Drivers should always approach roundabouts with caution. They should be prepared to give way to traffic on the right, traffic already on the roundabout, pedestrians already crossing and to always stop if necessary.

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In what direction should a driver turn when entering a roundabout? ABMW0508RU19

To the left.

By law you must enter a roundabout by turning to the left and giving way to traffic already on the roundabout.

In general, where two lanes are provided on the approach to a roundabout, which lane should a driver select when they intend taking an exit to the right (past the 12 o'clock position) of the roundabout? ABMW0509RU19

The right-hand lane.

When a driver approaches a roundabout where two lanes are provided, they should choose the most suitable one based on the road markings and the exit they intend to take off the roundabout. The left lane is generally used for vehicles exiting to the left (9 o'clock) or straight ahead (12 o'clock) and the right is for vehicles exiting at any exit after 12 o'clock.

What position should a driver generally adopt on approach to a roundabout when intending to take the first exit to the left? ABMW0510RU19

Approach in the left-hand lane.

When a driver intends to take any exit between the 6 O'Clock and 12 O' Clock positions they should generally approach the roundabout in the left lane unless road markings dictate otherwise.

Turning right

Making a right-hand turn can be challenging, as it involves crossing the path of traffic coming in the opposite direction. The questions in this section check that you know how to make a right turn safely.

In general, when turning right on a two-way road, where should a driver position the vehicle? ABMW0513RU19

Just left of the middle of the road.

In general, the correct position to be in before turning right is just left of the centre of the road. Where the road is wide enough, this position allows traffic coming from behind and going straight ahead to pass safely on the left.The driver should be alert for road markings which direct them to follow a certain course.

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What should a driver do before turning right from a major road into a minor road? ABMW0514RU19

Yield right of way to oncoming traffic and to pedestrians crossing at the junction.

The driver must yield to oncoming traffic and to pedestrians who are already crossing when turning right from a major road to a minor road.

Driving in tunnels

If you are driving through a tunnel, your driving behaviour can present a hazard to yourself and to other road users. The questions in this section check that you understand how to drive in tunnels and how to respond to situations that might arise in a tunnel.

In general, which of the following should a driver do before entering a tunnel? ABMW0515RU19

Ensure that dipped headlights are switched on.

In general , a driver should switch on their dipped headlights before entering a tunnel.

What should a driver do when entering a tunnel? ABMW0516RU19
Keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front.

The driver should keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front remembering that they are entering a tunnel and tailgating could create an emergency. The minimum recommended safe distance for a car or motor cycle is 50 metres and is 100 metres for all other vehicles. Always remember the 2 second rule.

What should a driver do if there is very heavy traffic congestion in a tunnel? ABMW0520RU19
Switch on hazard warning lights.

If there is traffic congestion in a tunnel, you should switch on hazard lights and remain patient. Keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front even in slow-moving traffic. Listen for traffic messages on the tunnel radio station, if available.

What should a driver do if traffic comes to a halt in a tunnel? ABMW0521R
Switch off the engine.

If traffic comes to a halt in a tunnel, switch off your engine to prevent a build up of fumes in the tunnel. Stay patient and follow the instructions of the tunnel operators.

What should a driver do if their vehicle breaks down or they are involved in a collision in a tunnel? ABMW0522R
Switch on hazard warning lights and walk to emergency station to call for help.

If your vehicle breaks down or is involved in a collision in a tunnel, switch on your hazard warning lights, switch off your engine, go to an emergency station and use the emergency phone to alert the tunnel operator.

What should a driver do if their vehicle breaks down in a tunnel? ABMW0523R
Use the emergency telephone to call for help.

If your vehicle breaks down or is involved ina collision in a tunnel, switch on your hazard warning lights, switch off your engine, go to an emergency station and use the emergency phone to alert the tunnel operator.

What should a driver do in the event of a breakdown or incident in a tunnel? ABMW0524RU19
Switch off the engine and switch on the hazard lights.

If your vehicle breaks down or is involved in a collision in a tunnel, switch on your hazard warning lights, switch off your engine, go to an emergency station and use the emergency phone to alert the tunnel operator.

What should a driver do if their vehicle goes on fire in a tunnel? ABMW0525R
Leave the vehicle and follow the emergency escape route.

If your vehicle goes on fire in a tunnel, you should stop the vehicle as soon as possible, evacuate any passengers to a safe place, go to an emergency station and use the emergency phone to alert the tunnel operator.

Vulnerable road users

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While you are driving, most of the time you will be sharing the road with other road users, including some who are particularly vulnerable, such as pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists, and some who are inexperienced, unskilled or careless. You need to be particularly considerate of vulnerable road users.

Patience

When good drivers meet vulnerable road users, they show patience and courtesy. It never takes much extra time, and it is safer for all concerned.

When stopped at traffic lights and the green light comes on but pedestrians are still crossing the road, what should a driver do? ABMW0528RU19

Wait as long as necessary to enable them to complete the crossing.

A green traffic light means you may go if the way is clear. If pedestrians are crossing, give way to them and let them safely cross before proceeding.

At traffic lights, a driver should take particular care for which road users coming up on the left? ABMW18U19

Motorcyclists.

Before moving off at traffic lights the driver should be aware of traffic, particularly cyclists and motorcyclists, coming up on the left, especially where there is an advanced stop line for cyclists ahead of that which applies to other road users.

What should a driver do when they see a slow moving vehicle up ahead being driven by a learner driver? ABMW0531RU19

Maintain a distance behind to avoid undue pressure.

Show patience and courtesy when driving behind a learner driver. Learner drivers are not as experienced as other road users and may drive erratically when put under pressure.

How is a learner driver likely to react in unusual traffic situations? ABMW0532RU19

Slower than an experienced driver.

You should be patient when driving behind a learner driver. Learners may not anticipate and react to unusual traffic situations as well as an experienced driver might.

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When negotiating junctions, which road users are particularly vulnerable? ABMW0535RU19

Motorcyclists.

Drivers should be aware that no vehicle has an automatic right of way at a junction. Drivers must pay particular attention to vulnerable road users such as motorcyclists whose presence on the road may be less visible than other vehicle types due to their smaller size or obstructions.

When stopped at traffic lights, a driver should take particular care for which road users coming up on their left? ABMW0536RU19

Cyclists.

Before moving off at traffic lights and particularly when turning left you should be aware of cyclists and motorcyclists coming up on the left in general – in particular where there is an advanced stop line for cyclists ahead of that for other road users.

What should a driver do if the traffic light changes to green while pedestrians are still crossing at a pelican crossing? ABMW0537RU19

Wait patiently until they have finished crossing.

A green traffic light means you may go if the way is clear. If pedestrians are crossing at a pelican crossing, give way to them and let them safely cross before proceeding.

When a driver intends to make a left-hand turn on a busy city street junction and there are pedestrians and cyclists around, what should the driver do? AMBW0538RU19

Watch for cyclists or pedestrians who may try to cross the road in front of the vehicle.

When making a left-hand turn on a busy city street, drivers should pay particular attention to vulnerable road users such as pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists who may appear unexpectedly and may not be aware of the vehicle's intention.

In slow-moving city traffic, a driver should occasionally check their blind spots for which road users in particular? ABMW0539RU19

Cyclists.

Drivers should be aware of and check blind spots before moving off and changing direction where appropriate. Cyclists can easily become hidden in a blind spot, and in slow-moving traffic, they might be moving faster than you are.

At traffic lights a driver should take particular care for which road users coming up on the left side (nearside)? ABMW0541U19

Motorcyclists.

Before moving off at traffic lights you should be aware of motorcyclists unexpectedly coming up on the left hand side (nearside).

What should a driver do if, while driving, they see children on the road ahead? ABMW0545RU19

Reduce speed and be prepared to stop if necessary.

Children can be unpredictable. When driving at a higher speed and children are present, drivers must expect the unexpected, slow down and be prepared to stop if necessary.

At road junctions, what type of road users are particularly vulnerable? ABMW16

Pedestrians.

Vehicles do not have an automatic right of way at junctions. As a driver you should pay particular attention to vulnerable road users such as pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists and be aware that they are entitled to use the road in safety.

When a driver intends to make a left-hand turn at a junction where there are pedestrians and cyclists present, what should a driver do? ABMW19U19

Check your mirrors and watch for cyclists or pedestrians on the left.

The vehicle does not have a greater right-of-way than any other road user. As a driver you should pay particular attention to vulnerable road users such as pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists and be aware that they are entitled to use the road in safety.

Which of the following road users are most vulnerable in slow-moving city traffic? ABMW21U19

Motorcyclists.

In slow-moving city traffic, you should be aware of and check your blind spots before any manoeuvre. Motorcyclists can easily become hidden in a blind spot, and in slow-moving traffic, they might be moving faster than you are.

Which of the following road users are most vulnerable in slow-moving city traffic?
Pedestrians.
ABMW22U19

In slow-moving city traffic, you should be aware of and check your blind spots before any manoeuvre. Pedestrians can easily become hidden in a blind spot, and in slow-moving traffic, they might be moving faster than you are.

What should a driver do when driving at night on an unlit road?
Watch out for unlit cyclists.
ABMW24U19

While driving at night and even with the best headlights, it can be very difficult to see all the hazards that you might come across – for example, stray animals or livestock on the road. At night you should drive at a speed that will enable you to stop safely within the distance you can see to be clear ahead.

Clearance

While you are driving, you should make sure that you leave room (clearance) for other road users, particularly the more vulnerable ones, such as pedestrians (especially children and elderly people), cyclists and motorcyclists.

What should a driver do when they see joggers ahead on the left?
Check the mirrors, indicate and overtake the joggers, allowing them sufficient clearance.
ABMW0549RU19

People on the road are more vulnerable than vehicles so you should treat them with care. If you see people jogging ahead, use the mirror–signal–mirror (blind spots)–manouevre routine and give sufficient clearance to the joggers when you are overtaking them.

When driving on a road that has a potholed surface and there is a cyclist ahead, what should a driver do?
ABMW0550RU19
Allow extra clearance in case the cyclist swerves to avoid a pothole.

You should always be aware of how vulnerable cyclists are. When you are driving on a road with potholes or bad surfaces, give plenty of clearance to the cyclists when overtaking them. Take into account that they may swerve suddenly to avoid potholes.

What is a courtesy pedestrian crossing?
RSA0214
An uncontrolled pedestrian crossing place.

Pedestrians should only enter uncontrolled crossing places (courtesy crossing) ensuring that all traffic is aware of their presence if crossing the road. Motorists entering uncontrolled crossing places (courtesy crossing) should react by driving very slowly, and be aware of the potential dangers of pedestrians using the area.

How can a pedestrian walking along a poorly lit road reduce the risk of an accident occuring?
RSA0213
Wear high visibility clothing.

Even with the best headlights, drivers can see less at night than during the day. Pedestrians and unlit bicycles are extremely difficult to see in the dark, particularly if they have to deal with the glare of oncoming lights. Pedestrians should always wear bright and hi-viz clothing during the day and reflective clothing at night when walking outside built-up areas.

If it is safe to overtake a cyclist in speed zones over 50kmh, what is the recommended minimum passing distance?
RSA0212
Allow a minimum of 1.5 metres.

A driver should drive their vehicle far enough to the left to allow traffic to safely pass or overtake on the right, but not so far to the left that you are driving on a cycle lane or blocking or endangering cyclists or pedestrians. Where a driver wishes to overtake a cyclist and it is safe to do so, they should, if it is possible, give the recommended clearance depending on the speed limit area they are in.

If it is safe to overtake a cyclist in speed zones up to 50kmh, what is the recommended minimum passing distance?
RSA0211
Allow a minimum of 1 metre.

A driver should drive their vehicle far enough to the left to allow traffic to safely pass or overtake on the right, but not so far to the left that you are driving on a cycle lane or blocking or endangering cyclists or pedestrians. Where a driver wishes to overtake a cyclist and it is safe to do so, they should, if it is possible, give the recommended clearance depending on the speed limit area they are in.

A driver approaches a pelican crossing with a flashing amber light showing. There is a pedestrian still on the road. What should the driver do?
CD0178RU19
Wait and let the pedestrian cross at their own pace.

You must yield to pedestrians at a pelican crossing when the amber light is flashing.

Anticipation

It is sometimes hard to predict what another road user is going to do, and some categories of road user are particularly unpredictable. You should be prepared for pedestrians crossing the road unexpectedly, for children chasing a ball, for dogs or other animals running onto the roadway, for cyclists swerving to avoid a pothole, and for people in parked cars opening the door without warning. The questions in this section check that you understand the importance of anticipating such events and that you know how to take appropriate action.

What should a driver be aware of when making a left turn into a side road? ABMW0552RU19

Cyclists may come up on the left (nearside).

When turning left, drivers should be aware that cyclists and pedestrians may come up on the left (nearside) . Always check to your left (nearside) before you make a left turn.

When driving on a country road without footpaths, what should a driver expect coming towards them on their side of the road? ABMW0556RU19

Pedestrians.

Where there is no footpath, pedestrians are required to walk on the side of the on-coming traffic and drivers should be aware of this. Pedestrians are vulnerable road users so drivers should always be aware of their presence, especially on country roads.

What should a driver do when driving at night on an unlit road? ABMW0557RU19

Watch out for pedestrians wearing dark clothing.

While driving at night and even with the best headlights, it can be very difficult to see all the hazards that you might come across – for example, pedestrians wearing dark clothing. As always drivers should drive at a speed that will enable them to stop safely within the distance they can see to be clear ahead.

What could happen if a driver parks on a footpath? ABMW0558RU19

Pedestrians could be impeded.

You should never park on a footpath. Pedestrians (including people with young children in pushchairs, prams and also wheelchair users) might have to go onto the road to get around your car, and this could put them in danger.

Signalling

If you drive in such a way that other road users have to brake suddenly or change their course dramatically, you can cause a collision. For that reason, it is important to give other road users adequate warning of your intention to slow down, stop, or change direction. Use your indicators.

What procedure should a driver follow when intending to overtake a cyclist travelling in the same direction up ahead? ABMW0559RU19

Mirror check, indicate and move out if it is safe to do so.

The sequence drivers should follow the mirror - signal - manoeuvre routine when overtaking. Drivers should overtake only when it is safe to do so. Give extra space to cyclists when overtaking them, as they may need to move out to avoid a pothole, or they could be blown into your path on windy days.

If a driver suspects that their vehicle indicators have not been seen, what should the driver do? ABMW0560RU19

Use a clear, decisive hand signal as well.

If the driver is concerned that for whatever reason the indicators are not giving an adequate signal, they should use clear decisive hand signals as well to advise other road users of their intention.

What should a driver do when travelling on a country road with following traffic, and they meet pedestrians? ABMW0561RU19

Signal their intention to overtake the pedestrians.

When you are driving on a road without footpaths, drivers should take extra care when they come upon pedestrians on the road. When they intend to move out and overtake, they should check the mirrors and signal to following traffic in good time to alert drivers behind that they are changing direction because of the hazard ahead.

Driving when the lighting is poor

At night, around dawn and dusk, and in bad weather, visibility can be significantly reduced. You need to keep a sharp look-out for other road users – particularly those that are more vulnerable, such as pedestrians and cyclists.

When driving on dark winter mornings and evenings on unlit country roads, what should a driver be aware of? ABMW0562RU19

Cyclists are much more vulnerable in poor lighting conditions.

Drivers should take extra care when driving on dark winter mornings and evenings – vulnerable road users such as cyclists and pedestrians (particularly schoolchildren) might not be so easy to see in low light conditions.

When driving on dark winter mornings and evenings on unlit country roads, what should a driver be aware of? ABMW0564RU19

That there could be vulnerable pedestrians walking on the road.

Drivers should take extra care when driving on dark winter mornings and evenings – vulnerable road users such as cyclists and pedestrians (particularly schoolchildren) might not be so easy to see in low light conditions.

When driving on dark winter mornings and evenings on unlit country roads, what should a driver be aware of? ABMW0565RU19

Schoolchildren are more vulnerable on unlit country roads on dark winter mornings and evenings.

Drivers should take extra care when driving on dark winter mornings and evenings – vulnerable road users such as cyclists and pedestrians (particularly schoolchildren) might not be so easy to see in low light conditions.

Necessary Documents

Before you drive any vehicle, you must hold a valid driving licence or learner permit for that category of vehicle, the vehicle must be properly taxed and insured, and you must be insured to drive it. You must carry your driving licence or learner permit with you while driving, and you must display up-to-date tax and insurance discs on the front windscreen of the vehicle.

Driving licences and learner permits

Your learner permit or driving licence imposes some restrictions on what you may and may not do when driving. The questions in this section check that you know the rules.

What restriction applies to a driver's full licence if they have passed their test on a vehicle with automatic transmission? ABMW0567RU19

They may not drive vehicles with manual transmission.

If you pass your driving test in a vehicle fitted with automatic transmission, a code 78 will be noted on the full licence in the restrictions / information column.

What roads are learner permit holders allowed to drive on? ABMW0568RU19

All roads except motorways.

A learner permit holder must not drive on a motorway. It is a serious offence to do so.

How should an L-plate be composed? ABMW0569R

A red L on a white background.

L-plates should be displayed front and rear. The plates should be a red L on a white background and should be not less than 15cm high with a border of at least 2cm. A learner motorcyclist must wear a yellow tabard displaying L-plates front and rear. The L-plates must be not less than 15cm high on a white background.

Which roads are learner permit holders not allowed to drive on? ABMW0570RU19

They may not drive on motorways.

A learner permit holder must not drive on a motorway. It is a serious offence to do so.

Where can drivers locate the Maximum Authorised Mass (MAM) of their vehicle? ABMW0781RU19

On a metal plate on the vehicle.

The plate displaying the maximum Authorised Mass (MAM) of a vehicle is normally located under the bonnet or in the passenger compartment. If you are not sure where it is located on your vehicle, check the drivers handbook supplied with the vehicle.

Vehicle registration and motor tax

Vehicles are registered when they are first sold or imported. The registration details are recorded in the vehicle registration document or vehicle licensing certificate – these details include the engine number and the vehicle registration number (which is shown on the registration plate at the front and back of the vehicle).

Vehicles that are used on public roads must be taxed at all times, and they must display a current tax disc at all times.

Is it permitted to use a vehicle in a public place without a current tax disc displayed? ABMW0586RU19

No, all motor vehicles must display a current tax disc.

A motor vehicle must be taxed and must display the up-to-date tax disk before it may be taken on the road.

If a driver wishes to drive a vehicle but the tax disc is expired, what should they do? ABMW0588RU19

They should tax it immediately.

A motor vehicle must be taxed and must display the up-to-date tax disc before it may be taken on the road.

If a driver wishes to drive another vehicle which is not currently taxed, would they be allowed to transfer the current tax disc from their own vehicle onto it? ABMW0589RU19

Under no circumstances should a tax disc be transferred to another vehicle.

A motor vehicle must be taxed and must display its own current tax disc before it may be taken on the road. The tax disc includes information about the vehicle, including its make and model, colour and registration number.

When a vehicle is being driven by a person who is not the owner, who is responsible for ensuring that the vehicle is taxed and that a current tax disc is displayed? ABMW0590RU19

The driver and/or the owner of the vehicle are responsible.

If you are the owner or the driver of a vehicle, you must ensure that it is taxed and that it displays an up-to-date tax disc before you take it on the road.

When must a current tax disc be displayed on a new vehicle on a public road? ABMW0591RU19

At all times when the vehicle is on a public road.

A motor vehicle must be taxed before it may be taken on the road, and it must always display an up-to-date tax disc.

Who is entitled to see a driver's vehicle registration document?

A Garda may ask you to produce the vehicles registration document at a named Garda station. ABMW0592RU19

A Garda may demand to see your driving licence at any time, and you should always carry this with you when driving. A Garda may also examine your insurance disc, tax disc and NCT disc (if applicable). A Garda may ask you to produce other documents (including the vehicles registration document) at a named Garda station within 10 days.

Insurance

Before you drive any vehicle, you must make sure that the vehicle is insured and that you are insured to drive it. It is a serious offence to drive without proper insurance. The questions in this section check that you fully understand this issue.

If a vehicle is being driven by someone who is not the owner but has the owner's consent, who should ensure that the driver is properly insured? ABMW0593RU19

The driver and the vehicle owner.

All drivers must have insurance covering them to drive a vehicle on a public road. It is a serious offence to drive a vehicle that is not insured. It is also an offence to allow a vehicle that you own to be driven by an uninsured driver.

Is a driver still insured to drive their vehicle after their insurance policy has expired? ABMW0594RU19

The driver is not insured after the expiry of the policy.

All drivers must have insurance covering them to drive a vehicle on a public road. The vehicle must display an up-to-date insurance disc.

If a driver wishes to drive another privately-owned vehicle but they are uncertain if they are insured to drive that vehicle, what should they do? ABMW0595RU19

A driver should contact their own insurer to confirm whether or not their insurance policy covers the driving of other vehicles.

If you are in any doubt about your insurance cover, you should discuss the matter with your insurance company. It is a serious offence to drive without insurance.

When a driver wishes to drive a vehicle and they are not sure if they are covered by insurance, what should they do? ABMW0596RU19

They should not drive until their insurance company confirms that they are insured.

If you are in any doubt about your insurance cover, you should discuss the matter with your insurance company. It is a serious offence to drive without insurance.

What is the minimum insurance cover a driver needs to drive on a public road? ABMW0597RUS9
Third Party.

As a motorist, you must have a minimum of third party insurance.

If a driver passes their test using a vehicle with automatic transmission, which vehicles are they licensed to drive? ABMW0601RUS9
Only automatic vehicles in the licence category.

If you pass your driving test in an automatic or adapted vehicle, your full licence will apply to that type of vehicle only. A licence restricted to automatic vehicles will have a code 78 indicated in the restrictions / information column of the licence.

Taking action

If you are involved in a collision, or if you arrive at the scene of a collision, you can help by calling the emergency services and by making sure that the situation does not get any worse. Do not take any action that might endanger yourself or anyone else, and administer first-aid only if you have been trained to do so.

What should a driver do when involved in an incident where nobody is injured but the vehicles are causing a danger or obstruction on the road? ABMW0611RUS9
Take care when moving damaged vehicles and make every effort to warn other traffic.

In a collision where nobody is injured and there is only minor damage to vehicles, the vehicles should be moved to the side of the road to ensure that they do not cause an obstruction or endanger other road users.

Collisions

At the scene of a collision, whether or not you were involved in it, your first concern should be to make sure that any injured persons are properly attended to by contacting the emergency services. Your second concern should be to make sure that the situation does not get any worse – this means making sure that oncoming traffic is given adequate warning of the hazard and that bystanders are not exposed to danger.

If the vehicle you are driving is involved in a collision, you must exchange information with the other driver, and you should report the incident to the Gardaí and to your insurance company.

Collision – no injury

If you are involved in a collision in which nobody is injured and the damage to property is minor, you do not have to involve the Gardaí. You should, however, exchange your contact details and insurance information with the other driver, and make a note of when, where and how the collision happened, in case the incident becomes the subject of an insurance claim later.

What should a driver do if involved in an incident where there is damage to property only? ABMW0615RU19

It is not necessary to report it to the Gardai provided it has been reported to the property owner.

If the incident causes damage to property only and there is a Garda present, it must be reported to the Garda. If there is no Garda present, the owner or the person in charge of the property must be informed. If neither are present then the relevant information must be provided at a Garda Station as soon as possible.

Collision – person injured

If you are involved in a collision and somebody is injured you must immediately contact the emergency services by dialling 112 or 999. You must stay at the scene of the collision and make a report to the Gardaí. You should if possible exchange your contact details and insurance information with the other driver. It is advisable to make a note of when, where and how the collision happened, so that you can provide these details to your insurance company.

What should a driver do where a person has been injured in a collision? ABMW0616RU19

Move the victim only if there is a risk of fire or further injury.

Never move an injured person at the scene of a collision unless there is a risk of fire or further injury. Moving an injured person could add to their injuries. Trained personnel know best how to attend to injured persons. Call the emergency services (on 999 or 112) or make sure that someone else has called them.

What type of drink should be given to a person who has been injured in a collision? ABMW0617RU19

No drink should be given.

A person who has been injured in a collision should not be given anything to drink, as this could cause them to choke.Ideally trained personnel should be consulted before attending to an injured person. Call the emergency services (on 999 or 112) or make sure that someone else has called them.

What should a driver do to assist a person who is unconscious following a collision? ABMW0618RU19

Try to keep the person warm with a blanket or overcoat.

If a person is unconscious following a collision, a driver should try to keep them warm with a blanket or overcoat until the emergency services arrive. Call the emergency services (on 999 or 112) or make sure that someone else has called them.

Who should first be contacted where a person has been injured in a collision? ABMW0621R

The emergency services.

Where somebody has been injured in a collision, it is important to call the emergency services immediately on 999 or 112. Trained emergency services personnel know best how to attend to injured persons.

What is good basic first aid for a person who has been burned? CPC1329U19

Apply cold water to the burn.

When a person has been burned firstly check the person for shock, then try to cool the burn if you can. Try to find water or other liquid that is clean, cold and non-toxic to pour on it. The cool liquid may cool the affected area down and reduce damage. The person should be advised to seek medical advice as soon as possible.

When dealing with crash victims, remember A B C. What does C stand for? CPC1326U19

Circulation.

In assessing a crash victims vital signs, the following basic procedure should be used: First check the victims Airway is clear, then check they are Breathing and then check their Circulation (ABC)

When dealing with crash victims, remember A B C. What does A stand for? CPC1324U19

Airway.

In assessing a crash victims vital signs the following basic procedure should be used First check the victims Airway is clear, then check they are Breathing and then check their Circulation (ABC)

Where an injured person is discovered lying in the road, when should they be moved? CPC1322U19

If the person needs CPR.

If a person discovered lying in the road is not breathing, it may be essential to move them in order to safely carry out emergency CPR. It may also be necessary to move them under other circumstances but an urgent assessment of the situation should be carried out first.

When calling for help on an emergency telephone on the motorway, who does the call go to? CPC1317U19

The Gardaí.

The emergency telephones at the side of a motorway are linked directly to An Garda Siochána in order for them to respond appropriately as soon as possible. The Gardaí know precisely the location of each call using these phones.

In order to inform the emergency services of a crash what telephone number should be called? CPC1316U19

112

If a driver arrives at or is involved in a crash it may be essential to obtain the assistance of the emergency services as a matter of urgency. The common European emergency number is 112 however in Ireland you may also use 999.

What is the quickest way to warn other traffic of a crash? CPC1307U19

Use hazard lights.

If you arrive at the scene of a crash, find a safe place to stop so that you don't endanger yourself or others, warn other road users of the incident by using hazard lights.

If a vehicle breaks down, where should the driver stop? CPC1297U19

As far to the left as possible.

When a vehicle breaks down it is important to move as far in to the left as possible for the convenience of other road users and the safety of the vehicles occupants.

Exchange of information

If you are involved in a collision with another vehicle, you should ask the driver of the other vehicle for their contact details (name, address, telephone number) and the details of their insurance cover (insurance company and policy number). You should also note the registration number, make and model of their vehicle. At the same time, you should provide the other driver with your own details and those of your vehicle. You will need all these details to report the incident to the Gardaí or to your insurance company.

If a driver is involved in a serious collision with an uninsured motorist, where nobody is injured, who should it be reported to? ABMW0623RU19

The driver's insurance company and the Gardai.

If you are involved in a serious collision, you should always report it to the Gardai and to your insurance company.

What should a driver do if involved in a collision with another vehicle where nobody is injured? ABMW0624RU19

Exchange all relevant details with the other driver.

If a you are involved in a collision with another vehicle where nobody is injured, you should exchange all the relevant details with the other driver – including name, address, vehicle registration, make and model and all insurance details.

Hazardous materials

If you are involved in a collision with a vehicle carrying hazardous materials, or if you arrive at the scene of such a collision, you should take steps to make sure that the situation does not deteriorate. Do not take any action that might endanger yourself or others. Call the emergency services and try to warn other road users of the danger.

What should a driver do if they arrive at the scene of a collision involving a vehicle carrying hazardous materials? ABMW0625RU19

Keep well clear and call the emergency services.

If a driver arrives at the scene of a collision involving a vehicle carrying hazardous materials, they should keep well clear of the scene. Call the emergency services on 999 or 112 and give them as much information as you can about the marking labels on the vehicle. You should also warn other road users about the danger. Allow the emergency services to do any rescuing.

Safety considerations relating to loads and passengers

The questions in this section are designed to check that you understand the effects of severe braking on the people and goods in your vehicle, and that you know the importance of keeping the loads you carry in the vehicle within the limits set by the manufacturer.

Severe braking

By planning your journey, reading the road ahead, developing an awareness of the traffic conditions around you, and driving at an appropriate speed, you can generally avoid the need for sudden or harsh braking. On the occasions when you do have to apply the brakes severely, you need to be aware of the effects on yourself, your passengers and any goods in the vehicle.

What should a driver do to avoid the need for harsh braking? ABMW0627R

Look ahead and anticipate what others may do.

You should know what speed youre travelling at and you should always drive at a speed that is appropriate to the conditions you are driving in, and you should be able to stop smoothly and safely within the distance you can see to be clear ahead.

Vehicle carrying capacity and load distribution

Every vehicle is certified by its manufacturer to have a maximum safe load-carrying capacity, and a maximum towing capacity. You must not exceed these limits: it is illegal to do so, and can be extremely dangerous. The questions in this section check that you understand this important issue.

How does the driver know the vehicle's total load-carrying capacity?

By referring to the vehicle manufacturer's specification. ABMW0628RU19

Design Gross Vehicle Weight is the term used by manufacturers for the weight of the vehicle together with the maximum load it is designed to carry. Drivers must understand the carrying capacity of their vehicle. Overloading your vehicle will make it more difficult to control, and its an offence.

What determines the maximum allowed towing capacity of a vehicle?
The manufacturer's specifications.

ABMW06290[illegible]

The maximum weight that your vehicle can safely tow is specified by the manufacturer, and is usually set out in the drivers handbook for the vehicle, and in some cases on a plate attached to the vehicle. This is the safe towing limit for the vehicle and you should not exceed it.

What effect can overloading a vehicle have on its road-holding?
The load can make the vehicle more difficult to control.

ABMW06302[illegible]

Overloading your vehicle will make it more difficult to control. Remember: its an offence to overload a vehicle.

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1 **What would be the effect of overloading a vehicle with passengers or goods?**

ABMW0631[illegible]

2 It would reduce the driver's ability to control the vehicle.

3 Overloading your vehicle will make it more difficult to control, and will increase the risk of a collision.

What effect could an unevenly distributed load have on a vehicle?

ABMW0632[illegible]

It could make the vehicle unstable while turning.

When loading a vehicle you should ensure that the load is distributed evenly. An unevenly distributed load may change the vehicles centre of gravity and this could affect the braking and steering.

Technical matters with a bearing on road safety

The questions in this section check that you know how to keep your vehicle in good condition, that you recognise signs that it needs to be repaired or serviced, and that you understand the implications for your own safety and that of others of a vehicle in poor condition.

Headlights

When you are driving at night or in poor visibility, the headlights on your vehicle are essential for two reasons: they enable you to see the road ahead, and they enable other drivers and road users to see your vehicle. For these reasons, the headlights on the vehicle must be working properly at all times.

Why is it important to ensure that the vehicle headlights are correctly aligned? ABMW0633RU19
To enable the driver to see properly.

A driver should ensure their headlights are properly aligned so as not to dazzle oncoming drivers and also to see properly themselves.

What effect could incorrectly aligned headlights have? ABMW0634
They could dazzle oncoming drivers.

A driver should ensure their headlights are properly aligned so as not to dazzle oncoming drivers and also to see properly themselves.

In general, how frequently should a vehicle's lights be checked? ABMW0636RU19
Daily before driving.

A driver is responsible for their vehicles roadworthiness and they should check it daily before driving. Among the checks they should make are that all the lights are clean and in working order.

What effect can a broken lens have on headlights? ABMW0637RU19
It can reduce and distort the beam.

A driver is responsible for their vehicles roadworthiness and they should check it at regular intervals. Among the checks they should make are that all the lights are in working order. If they find defects in the lights, such as a broken lens, they should have them repaired or replaced as soon as possible.

A driver wishes to drive at night, but the off-side (right-hand side) headlight bulb is blown. What should the driver do? ABMW0638RU19
Not drive until the bulb is replaced.

A driver is responsible for their vehicles roadworthiness and they should check it at regular intervals. Drivers must not drive on the road unless their vehicles headlights are in good working order, adjusted properly and clean.

Brake lights

The brake lights on your vehicle provide a visible warning to traffic coming behind you that you are slowing and may be stopping. They must be kept in working order.

How would a driver know that a brake-light bulb is not working? ABMW0640RU19
By standing at the rear of the vehicle and checking as another person presses the brake pedal.

In order for a driver to know that the rear brake lights are working correctly, they should stand at the rear of the vehicle and check that the brake lights come on while another person presses the brakes.

Is it permissible to drive a vehicle on a public road when the brake lights are not working? ABMW0642RU19
No, it is never permitted to be driven.

A driver must always ensure that their vehicles brake-lights are clean and working correctly before driving on a public road. Never drive a vehicle when the brake lights are not working properly.

Dashboard lights

Modern engines are equipped with sophisticated systems for monitoring the condition of the engine and other parts of the vehicle, and for warning the driver if something goes wrong. These warnings are generally in the form of a warning light on the dashboard.

What does this light mean? ABMW0643RU19
The battery is not charging.

If the battery warning light comes on whilst driving, it means there is some kind of problem with the electrical charging system of the vehicle and the battery is not being charged properly. The driver should get this checked by a professional as soon as possible. It is important to understand the meaning of your vehicles warning lights, information on which can be found in the vehicles handbook.

What does this light mean? ABMW0644RU19
The high-beam headlights are switched on.

All vehicles are fitted with warning lights to alert the driver to different things. This light comes on when the full beam headlights are turned on. It is important to understand the meaning of your vehicles warning lights, information on which can be found in the vehicles handbook.

What does this light mean? ABMW0645U19
Low engine oil level.

If the engine oil warning light comes on, it means that the engine oil level/ pressure has dropped. You should not drive the vehicle until the problem is fixed. If the light comes on while driving, pull over and stop in a safe place as soon as possible. It is important to understand the meaning of your vehicles warning lights, information on which can be found in the vehicles handbook.

What does this light mean? ABMW0646RU19
Directional indicator on.

All vehicles are fitted with warning lights to alert you to different things. This light tells you that the directional indicator is on. If this light is still on after you have completd your manoeuvre, cancel it to avoid misleading other road users. It is important to understand the meaning of your vehicles warning lights, information on which can be found in the vehicles handbook.

What should a driver do if a system warning light lights up on the dashboard of their vehicle whilst driving? ABMW0650RU19
Stop and check the problem.

If a system warning light lights up while you are driving, you should stop in a safe place as soon as possible and investigate the problem before deciding what action to take. It is important to understand the meaning of your vehicles warning lights, information on which can be found in the vehicles handbook.

What should a driver do if a red system warning light lights up on the dashboard of their vehicle? ABMW0651RU19
Stop and investigate the cause.

If a red system warning light comes on while you are driving, you should stop in a safe place as soon as possible and investigate the problem before deciding what action to take. It is important to understand the meaning of your vehicles warning lights, information on which can be found in the vehicles handbook.

Reflectors

What is the purpose of the red reflectors at the rear of a vehicle? ABMW0652RU19
They reflect light at night to make other road users aware of the vehicle.

Motor vehicles are fitted with red reflectors to make it easier to be seen by other road users. Drivers should keep reflectors clean, intact and check them by shining a light on them to make sure that they are working effectively. Whilst driving, drivers should be cautious as red reflectors may be an indication of both parked/stationery or moving vehicles ahead.

Indicators

When a driver operates the indicator switch and hears a more rapid clicking noise than normal, what could this mean? ABMW0653RU19
An indicator bulb may have blown.

A rapid clicking noise when you turn on an indicator is usually a sign that one of the indicator bulbs has failed. Drivers are responsible for making sure that their vehicle is roadworthy. This should include a regular check that all lights, reflectors and indicators, are working properly.

Brakes

What does Anti-lock braking system (ABS) do? ABMW0654U19

ABS prevents the wheels from locking under harsh braking conditions.

Anti-lock braking system (ABS) is a type of braking system found in most modern cars. It comes into play automatically when the driver brakes harshly. In the wet it can help prevent the wheels from skidding so that, if necessary, the driver can continue to steer while braking. Be aware that ABS does not reduce the braking distance.

If the brake pedal of a vehicle feels soft or spongy when applied, what does this mean? ABMW0655RU19

A fault in the brake fluid system.

If the brake pedal feels soft or spongy when pressed, it could indicate that the brake fluid level is low and there is a fault in the system. Each time a driver sets out on a journey, they should test the brakes. If a fault is detected, have it checked by a competent person. Drivers should check brake fluid levels regularly.

Whilst driving, why might a driver suspect that the brake fluid level in their vehicle is low? ABMW0656RU19

The brakes feel spongy and soft.

If the brake pedal feels soft or spongy when pressed, it could indicate that the brake fluid level is low and there is a fault in the system. Each time a driver sets out on a journey, they should test the brakes. If a fault is detected, have it checked by a competent person. Drivers should check brake fluid levels regularly.

If a driver applies the foot brake and hears a scraping noise, what is the most likely cause? ABMW0658RU19

The brake linings or pads are worn.

Drivers should test their brakes regularly and particularly before setting out on a journey. However, if when driving they hear a scraping noise when they press the brake, the most likely reason is that the brake linings or pads are worn. In this case, brakes wont work as well as they should and the driver should have them replaced by a competent person immediately.

What may indicate a problem with the vehicle's braking system? ABMW0659RU19

The vehicle's stopping ability is affected.

Drivers should test their brakes before setting out on a journey. If when driving they notice that it is taking longer than usual to bring the vehicle to a stop, they should have the brakes checked immediatelyby a competent person.

After changing a wheel on a vehicle, which of the following should be checked after a short distance? ABMW26U19

The wheel nut tightness.

After changing a wheel on a vehicle, check the tightness of the wheel nuts or studs on the replacement wheel after driving a short distance to ensure they are securely fitted. If in doubt seek assistance from a competent person.

Automatic transmission

A vehicle with automatic transmission has some obvious differences from one with manual transmission (such as no clutch), and some differences that are not so obvious. You need to be aware of these differences, particularly if you sometimes drive a manual vehicle and sometimes an automatic.

If driving a vehicle with automatic transmission, what in particular should a driver be aware of? ABMW0660RU19

That engine braking power is reduced.

When driving an automatic vehicle, it may not slow at the same rate as a vehicle with a manual gearbox when the driver releases the accelerator. Drivers should be aware of this, as they may need to apply the brake earlier in order to stop where required.

What effect does automatic transmission have on engine braking power? ABMW0661U19

It reduces it.

When driving an automatic vehicle, it may not slow at the same rate as a vehicle with a manual gearbox when the driver releases the accelerator. Drivers should be aware of this, as they may need to apply the brake earlier in order to stop where required.

Vehicle condition (engine)

For your comfort and safety, and those of your passengers and other road users, you should make sure that the engine in your vehicle is operating properly. Have it serviced regularly, in line with the manufacturer's recommendations.

What does this dial provide information on?
Engine revolution.

ABMW0662RU19

The rev counter measures the speed of the engine, in revolutions per minute. Generally, the higher the revs, the more fuel the engine is using, so drivers should keep an eye on the rev counter to help drive in a more eco-friendly manner.

What does a rev counter provide information on?
Engine revolutions.

ABMW0663RU19

The rev counter measures the speed of the engine, in revolutions per minute. Generally, the higher the revs, the more fuel the engine is using, so drivers should keep an eye on the rev counter to help drive in a more eco-friendly manner.

If, when driving along, the driver notices that the engine power is lower than normal, what should they do?
Have the vehicle checked by a competent person.

ABMW0664RU19

If the driver notices that the vehicle seems underpowered when driving, this could present a number of problems, e.g. lack of power when overtaking. The driver should have it checked by a competent person as soon as possible as there may be a number of causes, some of which may deteriorate further.

Which of the following is a driver required to keep in good condition?
Seatbelts.

ABMW0665RU19

Drivers are responsible for their vehicles roadworthiness and should check them at regular intervals. Among the checks they should make are that all the seatbelts (drivers and passengers) are clean, untangled and in good working order.

Oil and fuel

The oil in your engine lubricates and cools the moving parts of the engine. If there is too little oil in the engine, or if it is not reaching the parts that need it, the engine can be permanently damaged.

You should, of course, make sure that you have sufficient fuel (petrol or diesel, depending on the type of engine) in the tank to take you safely to your destination.

What is the purpose of engine oil?
It lubricates the engine.

ABMW0670RU19

The purpose of engine oil is to lubricate and cool the moving parts of the engine. Refer to the vehicle handbook for further information and guidance.

If the oil pressure gauge shows little or no pressure, or the warning light comes on, what could the problem be?
The oil level is too low.

ABMW0665RU19

Drivers should check the oil level in their vehicle regularly, and if it is low, top it up. If it needs to be topped up very often, have the vehicle checked by a competent person to see if there is a problem.

What may happen if the vehicle's engine oil is not changed as required?
Parts of the engine may suffer increased wear.

ABMW0666RU19

Engine oil becomes inefficient over time, losing its viscosity and lubricating qualities, and therefore must be changed as required in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations. Failure to do so may result in costly and extensive engine damage. The oil change is usually done when the vehicle is being serviced.

If a vehicle is driven with low oil pressure, what effect does this have on its engine?
It increases wear and tear on the engine.

ABMW0667RU19

Low oil pressure is usually related to low oil level or to a faulty oil pump. Low engine oil level should be topped up in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations. Failure to do so may result in costly and extensive engine damage.

If the vehicle's oil-pressure gauge is reading low or the red oil-pressure warning light comes on, what should a driver do? ABMW0668RU19

Drive to a safe place, stop the vehicle and check the oil level.

Oil circulation is essential for the safe running of the vehicles engine. If the warning lights or gauges indicate that the oil or the oil-pressure is low, the driver should stop as soon as they can in safe place, check the oil level, and top up if necessary. Continuing to drive may damage the engine. If the problem is not just related to the oil level, have the vehicle checked by a competent person.

What should a driver do before checking the engine oil level on a vehicle? ABMW0669RU19

Make sure that the engine is switched off and cold.

Drivers need a basic knowledge of the regular checks that should be carried out on their vehicle. Checking the engine oil level is important – do this with the vehicle parked on level ground with the engine switched off and cold for a more accurate reading. Refer to the vehicle handbook for further information and guidance.

While driving, a driver notices a strong smell of fuel. What should they do? ABMW0672RU19

Stop where safe and investigate.

A strong smell of fuel is usually an indication that something is wrong, and drivers should stop and investigate as soon as possible. Leaking or spilling petrol can be dangerous because it is so combustible, and leaking diesel fuel can make the road very slippery.

What does the warning light and/or red zone on a fuel gauge mean? ABMW0671RU19

The level of fuel in the tank is low.

Many vehicles are fitted with various warning lights and gauges. A red zone or a warning light on a fuel gauge means the vehicle is low in fuel and should be refuelled as soon as possible.

Coolant temperature

While it is running, the engine in your vehicle heats up, but if it overheats, it may be permanently damaged. To prevent this, the main parts of the engine are kept at the correct temperature by the circulation of cooling fluid. You must make sure that there is sufficient coolant in the reservoir, and that you do not drive if the temperature gauge or warning light indicates that the engine is overheating.

When is it recommended to use coolant? ABMW0673RU19

All year round.

The purpose of coolant is to keep the engine cool during operation. Coolant is usually a mixture of water and anti-freeze – this ensures that the engine is kept cool and that the coolant does not freeze in very cold weather.

While driving, the driver notices the vehicle temperature gauge showing red. What should they do? ABMW0677RU19

Stop in a safe place and have the problem investigated.

Many vehicles are fitted with various warning lights and gauges. A warning light or a red zone on a temperature gauge means the engine is starting to overheat and the vehicle should not be driven until the problem is rectified. Refer to the vehicle handbook for further information and guidance or seek advice from a competent person.

What should a driver do if they notice steam rising from the engine compartment? ABMW0678RU19

Stop where safe and investigate the cause.

If a driver notices steam rising from the engine compartment of their vehicle, they should stop where safe and only investigate the cause once it has cooled down. Do not remove a radiator or header tank cap when the engine is hot. Steam rising from the engine is an indication that the engine is overheating and it should not continue to be driven. Refer to the vehicle handbook for further information and guidance or seek advice from a competent person.

Body condition

If the body of your vehicle is damaged or rusted, it can be more dangerous. For example, if there are sharp or jagged edges, these can cause serious injury if the vehicle is involved in a collision – even a minor one. You should also ensure that the shock absorbers are functioning correctly, or the vehicle may become unstable and difficult to control.

If a driver notices that structural parts of their vehicle's body have been affected by rust, what should they do? ABMW0680RU19

Have it repaired by a competent repair shop.

Over time vehicles may become affected by rust to various degrees. Drivers should inspect their vehicles periodically and if they find signs of rust they should have it assessed and repaired if necessary to prevent further deterioration. A weakened vehicle structure may have serious consequences in the event of a collision.

What effect can a worn shock absorber have on a vehicle? ABMW0682RU19

It can cause the vehicle to 'bounce' in an unstable manner.

A worn shock absorber can seriously affect the control of the vehicle especially on uneven surfaces or when cornering and can cause unnecessary wear and tear on tyres. It may increase stopping distance by not keeping the tyres in proper contact with the road under harsh braking.

Battery

In a petrol- or diesel-powered vehicle, the engine is started by a small electric motor, which is powered by a 12-volt battery. This battery also supplies power to the lights and other electrical appliances, but only when the engine is not running. When the engine is running, it drives an alternator to produce electricity, and this both recharges the battery and supplies power to the lights and other electrical appliances.

What happens if the vehicle has a flat battery? ABMW0679RU19

The engine will not start.

All motor vehicles have a battery to supply power, primarily to start the engine. If the battery is flat, the driver will not be able to start the engine in the normal way. When the engine is running, it produces its own electricity to recharge the battery and run the various electrical components, including lights, heating, the radio and so on. If the battery is completely dead it will have to be replaced.

What is the primary purpose of the battery fitted to a petrol - or diesel - powered motor vehicle? ABMW0676RU19

To start the engine.

The primary purpose of the battery is to start the engine. When the engine is running, it produces its own electricity to charge the battery and run the various electrical components, including lights, heating, radio and so on.

What effect would a weak battery have on a vehicle's driving performance? ABMW0681RU19

It would have no effect.

It might be difficult to start a car with a weak battery, but once the engine is running, it makes no difference. If the battery fails to charge or maintain its full charge seek advice from a competent person.

Mirrors

The exterior mirrors on each side of the vehicle and the interior rear-view mirror are important pieces of safety equipment. While you are driving, they enable you to see behind and to the side of your vehicle without turning your head, so that you can maintain your view of the road ahead. Before starting a journey, you should make sure that they are in good condition and properly adjusted.

What should the driver be able to see in the vehicle mirrors when they are properly adjusted? ABMW0683RU19

The area behind and to each side of the vehicle.

Properly adjusted vehicle mirrors enable drivers to see the road behind and to the sides. This helps drivers to take into account what's happening behind them, so that they can make informed, correct and safer decisions.

What should the driver be able to see in the exterior mirrors of a vehicle when they are properly adjusted? ABMW0684RU19
The area to each side of the vehicle.

Exterior mirrors enable drivers to see the area on each side of the vehicle. Drivers must take into account all visible hazards in order to make informed, correct and safer decisions.

The vehicle's exterior mirrors are covered by a film of mud and dust. What should the driver do? ABMW0685RU19
Clean them with a cloth or tissue before starting their journey.

The purpose of mirrors is to increase the drivers view to the rear and sides of the vehicle and to enable them to take into account all visible hazards. Proper use will enable drivers to make informed, correct and safer decisions. Drivers should ensure that all mirrors, including the exterior ones, are clean and properly adjusted at all times to ensure optimum view.

When a driver is making a left-hand turn, what mirrors should they particularly concentrate on? ABMW0686RU19
The interior and left exterior mirror.

When turning left, drivers should in particular be aware that cyclists and other vehicles may come up on their near side (left hand side). For that reason, when checking mirrors, it is particularly important to check both the left exterior and the interior mirror before turning. Drivers must always use the mirrors–signal–mirror–manouevre routine when turning. They should be particularly careful if crossing the path of a bus and/or cycle lane.

What effect can wet weather have on a vehicle's exterior mirrors? ABMW0687U19
Water droplets can obscure the reflected image.

When driving in wet weather conditions, small water droplets can form on the glass of the exterior mirrors. This could make it more difficult to see the road behind and to the sides. Switch on the mirror demisters, if they are fitted. If necessary, stop and clear them.

Exhaust

The exhaust system on a vehicle takes away the gases and other by-products of the engine's combustion process. In doing so, it filters them to make them less damaging to the environment, and it reduces the noise created by the engine. It is important to make sure that the exhaust system is in good condition – if it is not working correctly, poisonous fumes may enter the vehicle, with lethal consequences.

What does blue smoke coming from the vehicle's exhaust generally mean? ABMW0688RU19
The engine is burning oil.

A vehicle can give off blue smoke from the exhaust when it is burning oil. Poor maintenance and worn engines are typical causes. This blue smoke is harmful to the environment and may be costly. Drivers should have the vehicle checked by a competent person.

What is the effect of a worn exhaust? ABMW0689RU19
The filtering of fumes is reduced and engine noise is louder.

A worn exhaust system can have a number of effects, including increased noise from the engine and more environmentally damaging fumes (as as they are not filtered properly). There are requirements to ensure vehicles are compliant with EU and Irish legislation. Vehicles are tested for compliance during road worthiness testing.

What affect can a faulty exhaust system have? ABMW0690RU19
It can increase the vehicle's noise and pollution levels.

A worn exhaust system can have a number of negative effects, including increased noise from the engine and more environmentally damaging fumes (as they are not filtered properly). There are requirements to ensure vehicles are compliant with EU and Irish legislation. Vehicles are tested for compliance during road worthiness testing.

What is the purpose of a catalytic converter? ABMW0691U19
It filters exhaust gases and reduces air pollution.

The purpose of a catalytic converter (CAT) is to remove toxic or polluting gases such as carbon monoxide, nitrogen oxide and unburned hydrocarbons from the exhaust emissions. When the CAT is faulty, an engine management warning light illuminates on the dashboard and drivers should seek advice from a competent person.

Tyres and wheels

Your ability to control your vehicle, to steer it in the direction you want and to stop it when and where you want depends critically on the few square centimetres of rubber that are in contact with the road at any time. You must make sure that your tyres are in good condition and correctly inflated. The questions in this section check that you know how to do this.

What does the speed rating of a tyre indicate? ABMW0692R
The maximum speed for which the tyre is designed.

The speed rating of a tyre is the maximum speed for which the tyre is designed. This relates to the speed capability of the tyre. It does not relate to the speed at which the tyre should or could legally be driven.

Why should the valve be replaced when having a tubeless tyre fitted? ABMW0693RU19
To ensure the tyre will remain inflated.

When fitting a new tubeless tyre to a vehicle it is recommended to change the valve. This is because the old valve has been on the wheel since the old tyre was fitted. The old valve may break down, leak or cause air to escape.

After changing a wheel on a vehicle, which of the following should be checked soon afterwards? ABMW0694RU19
The wheel nuts.

After changing a wheel on a vehicle it is recommended to check the wheel nuts after a short period of driving to ensure they are still properly secured.

In general, how often should a driver check the tyre pressure of a vehicle? ABMW0695RU19
Regularly.

Drivers have a legal responsibility to make sure that their vehicle is roadworthy. To do this, they should carry out regular, weekly and periodic checks, including a weekly tyre pressure check. Incorrectly inflated tyres may cause vehicle instability, uneven tyre wear and longer stopping distances.

What is the main reason for maintaining the correct tyre pressures? ABMW0697RU19
To help provide optimum road holding.

The vehicle manufacturer specifies the pressure to which tyres on a vehicle should be inflated. This is the pressure that gives the best performance in road holding, efficient braking and fuel consumption. Some manufacturers specify different pressures for front and rear tyres.

A fault in which component may lead to uneven or excessive tyre wear? ABMW0698RU19
Suspension.

If a vehicle has a worn suspension it may lead to uneven or excessive tyre wear. If drivers notice that their tyres are unevenly worn, they should investigate the reason and have it repaired by a competent person.

What can be affected by driving on under-inflated tyres? ABMW0699RU19
Fuel consumption.

Incorrect tyre pressure adversely affects many of a vehicles systems, including brakes, suspension and steering. In particular, under-inflated tyres can increase the vehicles fuel consumption. Check tyre pressures regularly and ensure they are inflated as per manufacturer's recommendations.

When should tyre pressure be checked? ABMW0700RU19
When the tyres are cold.

Drivers should check the tyre pressure in their vehicle at least once a week and before commencing a long journey. For accuracy, do this when the tyres are cold and using a reliable gauge. Tyres should always be inflated according to the vehicle manufacturers guidelines, information on which can be found in the vehicle handbook.

What effect does low tyre-pressure have on a vehicle? ABMW0701RU19
Braking and cornering are impaired.

Incorrect tyre pressure adversely affects many of a vehicles systems, including suspension, steering and fuel consumption. In particular, under-inflated tyres can affect the vehicles braking ability and its effectiveness when cornering. Tyres should always be inflated according to the vehicle manufacturers guidelines, information on which can be found in the vehicle handbook.

During a weekly check, a driver notices a badly worn front tyre. What should the driver do? ABMW0702RU19

Have the worn tyre replaced.

The tyres are the vehicles only contact with the road, the area of contact is small and, if worn, will not grip properly and safely. The quality of the tyres on a vehicle is an important factor in the vehicles road holding and braking ability. Drivers should check their tyres regularly and if they notice that a tyre is badly worn, they should replace it immediately. Whilst the minimum legal tread depth for tyres on most vehicles is 1.6mm (1mm for motorcycles), drivers should replace a tyre before it becomes this worn.

What effect could hitting or mounting the kerb have on a vehicle's tyres? ABMW0703RU19

It could damage the sidewalls.

Drivers should avoid hitting or mounting the kerb as it causes damage to the sidewalls of the tyre. The damage caused could cause the tyre to blow-out later. If this happens at high speed the driver may lose control of the vehicle with dangerous consequences.

What does worn tread along the edge of the inside of a tyre suggest? ABMW0704RU19

Steering alignment may be faulty.

If a driver notices the inside edge of the tyre is worn, this may indicate a problem with the steering alignment. This is a potentially dangerous problem, and should be fixed by a competent person as soon as possible. Failure to do so may result in a blow-out and loss of control of the vehicle.

With regard to tyres, what should a driver do before starting a long journey? ABMW0706RU19

Check the tyres are inflated to normal air pressure.

It is important to check the tyre pressure before starting a long journey as incorrect air pressure can adversely affect many of the vehicles systems, including brakes, steering, suspension and fuel consumption. Tyres should always be inflated according to the vehicle manufacturers guidelines, information on which can be found in the vehicle handbook.

Under what circumstances would a driver increase the air pressure in the tyres? ABMW0707RU19

When taking a journey with additional passengers.

Before starting a journey with extra passengers or loads, drivers should check the air pressure and when they inflate the tyres, they should increase the vehicles tyre pressures in accordance with the vehicle manufacturers recommended tyre pressure. This information can be found in the vehicle manufacturers handbook.

What is an effect of under-inflated tyres on a vehicle? ABMW0708RU19

Impaired braking and steering.

Drivers should check their vehicle's tyre pressures (including the spare) regularly at least once a week. Under-inflated tyres adversely affect many of a vehicle's systems, including braking ability, suspension, steering, fuel consumption and premature tyre wear. Tyres should always be inflated according to the vehicle manufacturers guidelines, information on which can be found in the vehicle handbook.

What can be affected by driving on under-inflated tyres? ABMW27U19

Braking ability.

Under-inflated tyres may adversely affect many of the vehicle's systems, including its braking ability, suspension, steering and fuel consumption. In particular, under-inflated tyres can affect the vehicle's braking ability and can result in premature tyre wear. Tyres should always be inflated according to the vehicle manufacturers guidelines, information on which can be found in the vehicle handbook.

What should the driver do to secure the vehicle when changing a front nearside (left-hand side) wheel? ABMW0710RU19

Ensure that the vehicle cannot roll when jacked up.

If a driver has to change a front nearside (left-hand side) wheel, make sure to do it in a safe place on level ground. Take care, wear high visibility vest/jacket, use a warning triangle and hazard warning lights as appropriate. The vehicle should be secured by applying the parking brake (hand brake), switching off the engine, engaging a low gear and using a wheel chock if necessary. If unfamiliar with how to change a wheel seek assistance from a competent person.

While driving at higher speeds, what does a continuous vibration in the steering indicate?

The wheel balance is uneven.

ABMW0713RU19

If a driver feels a continuous vibration in the steering, particularly at higher speeds, this could typically indicate that the balance of the vehicle wheels is uneven. This can lead to instability in the handling of the vehicle. If this is the case, have it investigated by a competent person.

What is the most common cause of heavy steering?

Under-inflated tyres.

ABMW0714RU19

Heavy steering is when a driver needs to use more effort than usual to turn the steering wheel, this may be as a direct result of under-inflated tyres. Check your tyre pressures but be aware there may be other causes of heavy steering such as low power steering fluid level. Seek advice from a competent person and have this investigated immediately.

Clutch

In vehicles with manual transmission, the clutch enables the driver to disengage the engine from the transmission. This allows the engine to continue running while the vehicle is stopped, and makes it easy for the driver to change gears. In a car, the clutch is generally operated by the left-most pedal; on a motorcycle it is operated by a lever on the left handlebar.

Between the extremes of fully engaged and fully disengaged, the clutch transmits a varying proportion of the engine's force to the transmission, but it becomes very hot, and if you over-use the clutch it can become damaged ('burnt out'). For this reason you should avoid driving for long periods with the clutch partially engaged.

When driving, where should a driver rest their left foot?

On the floor or foot rest.

ABMW0721RU19

When driving a driver should rest their left foot on the floor or foot rest but not under the pedals. To do so may cause delayed response time in an emergency. Resting the foot on the pedal may result in coasting, which may inadvertently increase the speed of the vehicle, or clutch mechanism damage.

Environmental matters

Motor vehicles are a significant cause of pollution. All drivers should be aware of this, and should modify their driving habits to minimise their negative impact on the environment.

Minimising environmental impact

The questions in this section check that you understand environmental issues about driving, and you know how to drive in an environmentally responsible manner.

In what way do motor vehicles harm the environment?
By increasing carbon monoxide levels.

ABMW0725R

Carbon monoxide is a poisonous gas emitted by vehicle exhausts into the atmosphere. Driving economically and keeping a vehicle well maintained can reduce the level of carbon monoxide emissions.

What can be achieved by the driving style known as 'Eco-Driving'?
Reduced fuel consumption.

ABMW0730R

The advantages of eco-driving include improved road safety, improved fuel consumption and reduced emissions. The eco-conscious driver becomes a more efficient driver because they learn to read the road further ahead and display better anticipation skills. This reduces the need for harsh acceleration and braking which results in a more economical style of driving and a smoother drive.

What can be achieved by the driving style known as 'Eco-Driving'?
Improved road safety.

ABMW279U19

The advantages of eco-driving include improved road safety, improved fuel consumption and reduced emissions. The eco-conscious driver becomes a more efficient driver because they learn to read the road further ahead and display better anticipation skills. This reduces the need for harsh acceleration and braking which results in a more economical style of driving and a smoother drive.

What can be achieved by the driving style known as 'Eco-Driving'?
Increased fuel efficiency.

ABMW28U19

One of the many advantages of an eco-driving style, includes; increased fuel efficiency, reduced emissions and improved driver safety. The eco-conscious driver becomes a more efficient driver because they learn to read the road further ahead and display better anticipation skills. This reduces the need for harsh acceleration and braking which results in a more economical style of driving and a smoother journey.

Which action contributes to Eco-Driving?
Maintaining a steady speed.

ABMW29U19

One of the many advantages of maintaining a steady speed, includes: increased fuel efficiency, reduced emissions and improved driver safety. The eco-conscious driver becomes a more efficient driver because they learn to read the road further ahead and display better anticipation skills. This reduces the need for harsh acceleration and braking which results in a more economical style of driving and a smoother journey.

Which action contributes to Eco-Driving?
Selecting a high gear as soon as possible.

ABMW0731R

Eco-driving contributes to road safety and also reduces fuel consumption and harmful emissions. Eco-conscious drivers will read the road well in advance and avoid harsh acceleration and braking. Fuel consumption can be reduced by using the highest gear possible without causing the engine to labour.

Which action contributes to Eco-Driving?
Looking ahead and anticipating.

ABMW30U19

One of the many advantages of an eco-driving style, includes; increased fuel efficiency, reduced emissions and improved driver safety. The eco-conscious driver becomes a more efficient driver because they learn to read the road further ahead and display better anticipation skills. This reduces the need for harsh acceleration and braking which results in a more economical style of driving and a smoother journey.

How can a driver help the environment?
By reducing speed.

ABMW0732R

As a driver you can do less damage to the environment if you drive smoothly and avoid harsh acceleration and braking. Vehicles travelling at 110 km/h use up to 30% more fuel than those travelling at 80km/h. However, you should not drive so slow as to inconvenience other road users.

Fuel consumption

Driving in such a way that you minimise your consumption of fuel is good for you and it's good for the planet. It saves you money, it uses less of a scarce resource, and it produces less pollution. It is also safer. These questions check that you know how to maximise your fuel efficiency.

What can a driver do to maximise fuel efficiency while driving?

Avoid carrying unnecessary weight.

ABMW0727RU19

The more extra weight is in your vehicle, the more fuel you use. Using a roof rack or a roof box increases wind resistance and this also increases fuel consumption – by as much as 15%. Remove roof racks and roof boxes when not in use.

Which action is likely to cause an increase in fuel consumption?

Harsh acceleration.

ABMW0728RU19

Harsh acceleration increases fuel consumption. Driving smoothly reduces wear and tear and also improves fuel consumption. Use the highest gear possible without causing the engine to labour.

What alternatives can drivers take to help protect the environment?

Use public transport.

ABMW0729RU19

Using public transport helps to protect the environment. Buses, trams and trains are a more environmentally friendly way to move large numbers of people especially in urban areas. Consider using public transport where possible – not only is it more environmentally friendly, but it can also be more cost-effective when you take the cost of fuel and parking charges into account.

What should a driver do to minimise fuel consumption in their vehicle?

Use gentle acceleration and braking.

ABMW0716RU19

Driving smoothly will help reduce fuel consumption. Read the road ahead and adjust speed in good time, and avoid harsh acceleration and late braking.

How does harsh acceleration affect fuel consumption?

Fuel consumption increases.

ABMW0715U19

Harsh acceleration increases fuel consumption.Smooth acceleration helps to reduce fuel consumption and the emissions from vehicles. Try not to over-rev the engine and use the appropriate gear for the speed of the vehicle. When slowing down, take your foot off the accelerator and allow the vehicle to slow progressively before you brake.

How does continuous high-speed driving affect fuel consumption?

It increases fuel consumption.

ABMW0717RU19

Driving at continuous high speeds increases your fuel consumption. Vehicles driving at 112km/h consumes approximately 30% more fuel than a vehicle travelling at 80km/h

What should a driver do to ensure better fuel efficiency from their vehicle?

Ensure that the vehicle is regularly serviced.

ABMW0718R

One of the keys to good fuel efficiency is making sure that your vehicle is well maintained. Servicing should be carried out as recommended by the manufacturer. Checking the tyre pressure regularly can also help ensure good fuel efficiency.

How can fuel efficiency be improved?

By using gentle acceleration and making gear changes appropriate to speed.

ABMW0719RU19

A driver can contribute to their vehicles fuel efficiency by reading the road ahead and driving smoothly. This is achieved by accelerating gently, using the most appropriate gear for the speed they are travelling at and avoiding harsh braking.

Noise

Motor vehicles make a lot of noise. You should try to make sure that your vehicle and your style of driving do not create so much noise that they cause a nuisance to others.

What effect does a worn exhaust have on a vehicle? ABMW0720RU19

It causes noise and gas pollution levels to increase.

A vehicle with a worn exhaust will probably be noisier and will produce more polluting emissions. There are strict regulations governing the noise and emission levels of vehicles, and these are rigorously checked during a vehicles NCT.

Is a driver allowed to sound the horn while driving in a built-up area at night? ABMW0721RU19

Yes, but between 11:30pm and 7:00am the horn may be sounded only in an emergency.

Drivers are not allowed to use the horn in a built-up area between 11:30pm and 7:00am unless there is a traffic emergency. Only use a horn to warn other road users of danger or if needed to make them aware of your vehicles presence for safety reasons. Using the horn does not give drivers an automatic right of way. Never use the horn to provoke a reaction from or to rebuke another motorist.

When is the use of the horn prohibited? ABMW0723RU19

Between 11:30pm and 7:00am in a built-up area.

Drivers are not permitted to sound the horn in a built-up area between 11:30pm and 7:00am unless there is a traffic emergency. Only sound the horn to warn other road users of oncoming danger or if they need to be made aware of your presence for safety reasons. Sounding the horn does not give the driver an automatic right of way. Never sound the horn to provoke a reaction from or to rebuke another motorist.

Taking corrective or emergency action

When you are driving, you need to always expect the unexpected. You literally don't know what's around the next bend, but you can avoid some dangerous situations by developing your observation skills and learning to anticipate danger. Even the best and safest drivers, however, will have to take corrective or emergency actions from time to time.

Skidding

You should always drive in a way that is suited to the weather conditions and the state of the road. If you do, you will generally avoid skidding. However, if you do find yourself in a skid, you must know how to react in order to get the vehicle back into control as soon as possible. These questions check that you understand the causes of skidding and how to avoid them.

What can cause a vehicle to skid? ABMW31U19

Excessive heavy braking.

Heavy braking can cause a vehicle to skid, particularly if the road surface is wet or uneven, or if the tyres are worn or incorrectly inflated. Read the road well ahead and try to avoid heavy braking, particularly in wet or slippery conditions.

Punctures

A puncture is always an inconvenience, but it is also sometimes dangerous. If you get a sudden puncture while driving, you must know what to do in order to keep control of the vehicle and not endanger yourself or others.

What should a driver do if a front tyre bursts while driving? ABMW0605RU13

Grip the steering wheel firmly.

If a front tyre bursts on a vehicle, the steering on the vehicle will become unstable. Dont panic – slow down gradually while keeping a firm hold on the steering wheel. Stop in a safe place to change the wheel, and alert other road users by switching on your hazard warning lights.

What should a driver do if their vehicle gets a puncture on a motorway? ABMW0606R

Pull in where safe on the hard shoulder and call for assistance.

Don't try to change a wheel on a motorway, as this could be very dangerous. Drive the car on to the hard shoulder, and when it is safe to do so, get out of the vehicle and move behind the barrier. Call for assistance from a motorway emergency phone or using a mobile phone (call the Gardaí).

Fire

Fire in a vehicle is rare, but if it does occur it can be very dangerous, both for the people in the vehicle and for others in the vicinity. You should know the precautions to take against fire, and know what to do if fire does break out in your vehicle.

What precautions could a driver take against the risk of fire in their vehicle? ABMW0607RU19

Carry a suitable fire extinguisher in the vehicle.

A strong smell of fuel is usually an indication that something is wrong, and you should stop and investigate as soon as possible. Leaking or spilling petrol can be dangerous because it is so combustible. It is good practice to carry a fire extinguisher in your vehicle, so that you can deal with any small fires

Breakdowns

If your vehicle breaks down, you should make sure that it does not cause a hazard to other road users, and that any action you take does not put you or others in danger.

When should a driver use hazard warning lights on a motorway? ABMW0609R

When the vehicle has broken down.

If your vehicle breaks down on a motorway, drive it to the hard shoulder and switch on the hazard warning lights to warn following traffic. When it is safe to do so, get out of the vehicle and move behind the barrier. Call for assistance from a motorway emergency phone or using a mobile phone (call the Gardaí).

What should a driver do if their vehicle is broken down on a motorway and they are awaiting assistance? ABMW0610U19

Switch on the vehicle hazard warning lights, get out of the vehicle and stand safely to the side.

If your vehicle breaks down on the road, always switch on the hazard warning lights and stand clear of the vehicle while awaiting assistance – this will warn other traffic that there is a vehicle stopped on the road.

Meeting emergency or extra-large vehicles

It is important that you know how to react and respond when you meet emergency vehicles, such as fire brigades, ambulances and Garda cars, either coming towards you or coming up behind you. These vehicles are sometimes moving very fast, and you must get out of their way as quickly as you can, provided it is safe to do so.

What should a driver do when they see road works machinery with amber flashing lights up ahead? ABMW0739M

Slow down and prepare to stop if necessary.

When you notice works vehicles ahead, slow down and be prepared to stop for the road works. Be extra careful driving through road works as the road surface could be uneven or slippery.

What action should a driver take when they meet a vehicle with flashing blue lights. ABMW0735R

Move to the left, reduce speed and stop if necessary.

When a driver notices an emergency vehicle approaching in the distance, they should check their mirror and move to the left to allow the vehicle to pass. On some occasions it may be necessary to stop.

What should a driver do if an ambulance is stopped up ahead with its flashing blue lights on? ABMW0737

Reduce speed and prepare to stop if necessary.

When you come upon an emergency vehicle stopped on the road, you should slow down and be prepared to stop. Do not stop to see what is happening as this could be dangerous and you might cause an obstruction to the flow of traffic.

How are emergency vehicles identified? ABMW0738RU19

By flashing red or blue lights.

If you hear or see an emergency vehicle approaching sounding its siren or flashing lights, be extra careful and give way if it is safe to do so.

Which vehicle is exempt from speed limits when being used in an emergency? ABMW0739R

Fire brigade.

In the course of their duty Gardai, Fire Brigade and ambulance personnel are exempt from some traffic laws including speed limits, as long as they do not put other road users in danger. If you hear or see a Garda or emergency vehicle approaching under emergency conditions, be extra careful and give way, if it is safe to do so.

Which vehicle is exempt from speed limits when being used in an emergency? ABMW33

Ambulance.

In the course of their duty Gardai, Fire Brigade and ambulance personnel are exempt from some traffic laws including speed limits, as long as they do not put other road users in danger. If you hear or see a Garda or emergency vehicle approaching under emergency conditions, be extra careful and give way, if it is safe to do so.

Which vehicle is exempt from speed limits when being used in an emergency? ABMW34

Garda.

In the course of their duty Gardai, Fire Brigade and ambulance personnel are exempt from some traffic laws including speed limits, as long as they do not put other road users in danger. If you hear or see a Garda or emergency vehicle approaching under emergency conditions, be extra careful and give way, if it is safe to do so.

How should a driver react to emergency services vehicles with flashing blue lights and/or sirens on? RSA0216

Check their mirrors before looking for space to move aside.

If you see any emergency vehicle approaching with lights and/or sirens activated, check your rear view mirrors to gauge the speed of the emergency vehicle/s and also look out for pedestrians, cyclists, motorcyclists and other road users. Indicate your intention to pull over. Pull over only in a space that has enough space for the emergency vehicle/s to pass safely. Move off safely with appropriate observations and signals after the emergency vehicle has passed.

What should a driver do when an emergency service vehicle approaches with flashing blue lights? RSA0208

React quickly, safely and carefully to allow the emergency service vehicle to pass.

A driver needs to know what to do when they see an emergency vehicle. A driver must react quickly, safely and carefully to allow emergency service vehicles to pass. It is important to be alert and attentive at all times.

What should a driver never do when an emergency service vehicle approaches with flashing blue lights? RSA0209

Brake suddenly or block the road.

A driver needs to know what to do when they see an emergency vehicle. A driver must react quickly, safely and carefully to allow emergency service vehicles to pass. It is important to be alert and attentive at all times.

Can a driver break a red light or break the speed limit to allow an emergency service vehicle to pass? RSA0210

No, a driver should never break a red light or speed up to allow an emergency service vehicle to pass.

A driver needs to know what to do when they see an emergency vehicle. A driver must react quickly, safely and carefully to allow emergency service vehicles to pass. It is important to be alert and attentive at all times.

What is the likely effect of motorists 'rubbernecking' at the scence of a traffic incident? RSA0215

It can cause additional incidents as drivers become distracted.

When approaching or being near to the scene of an incident, motorists are often seen 'rubbernecking'. This means turning your head and stretching your neck to get a better view of what's happening. It can be the cause of traffic jams as drivers slow down to 'rubberneck'. It can also cause road incidents as drivers become distracted and change their speed and/or direction while other drivers are also distracted.

Safe and Socially Responsible Driving

What is the minimum penalty point offence for a learner driver not displaying 'L' Plates both on the front and rear of the vehicle? RSA0219
2 penalty point.

A learner driver needs to be aware of the legal requirements to display 'L' plates front and rear and the implications of not doing so.

A learner permit driver who receives 7 penalty points in a 36 month period (three years) will be banned from driving for how many months? RSA0218
6 months.

A learner driver needs to be aware that there is a lower penalty point threshold for learner or novice drivers.

What is the penalty for a vehicle owner who allows a learner driver to drive their vehicle unaccompanied? RSA0217
Their vehicle will be seized.

A learner driver needs to be aware that driving unaccompanied in a vehicle, even where the owner has given their consent to drive, may result in the vehicle being seized.

Are there any occasions when a learner driver can drive unaccompanied? RSA0231
No, learner drivers must be accompanied at all times by a qualified driver.

Learner drivers must be aware that they must be accompanied by a qualified driver at all times.

Can a person who has passed their car driving test within the last two years act as an accompanying driver? RSA0230
No, they must hold the full driving licence for a minimum of 2 years.

To be an accompanying driver for a learner driver, you must have a full driving licence for at least 2 years.

Can a learner driver drive unaccompanied if they are on their third or subsequent learner permit? RSA0229
No, they cannot drive unaccompanied on any learner permit.

A learner driver needs to be aware that they are not permitted under any circumstance to drive unaccompanied regardless of the amount of learner permits held.

When a learner driver has passed their driving test, are they permitted to drive unaccompanied as the holder of a Certificate of Competency? RSA0228
No, a learner driver is not permitted to drive unaccompanied until they have been issued with a full driving licence in that category.

A learner driver who successfully passes their driving test needs to be aware that the rules that apply to learner permit holders still apply to them until they are in possession of a full driving licence in that category. A Certificate of Competency is not a full licence.

A learner driver detected of driving unaccompanied faces a minimum of how many penalty points? RSA0227
2 penalty points.

A learner driver needs to be aware that driving unaccompanied will result in a penalty point offence.

What are the fixed charge amount and penalties incurred for a learner driver who drives unaccompanied? RSA0226
€80 fine and 2 penalty points.

A learner driver needs to know that there are penalties for driving unaccompanied.

For how long is a learner driver's accompanying driver required to have held their full licence in category B? RSA0225
2 years.

A learner driver needs to be aware that not just anyone can be an accompanying driver. An accompanying driver has to have held a full licence for at least 2 years and have built up good driving experience.

Is a learner driver permitted to drive unaccompanied if they have the consent of the vehicle owner? RSA0224

No, a learner driver is not permitted to drive unaccompanied even with the owner's consent.

A learner driver needs to be aware that, even with the consent of the owner of the vehicle, they are not permitted to drive unaccompanied.

If the owner of a vehicle allows a learner driver to drive their vehicle, what is the maximum fine the owner could face? RSA0223

€1000

A learner driver needs to be aware that driving unaccompanied in a vehicle which they do not own could see the owner facing a fine of up to €1,000 and having the vehicle seized.

A learner driver who has been stopped by a Garda for driving unaccompanied faces a minimum fine of how much? RSA0222

€80

A learner driver needs to be aware that, if they are stopped by a Garda for driving unaccompanied, it will lead to a financial penalty.

What is the fine for a learner driver for driving a vehicle unaccompanied? RSA0221

€120

A learner driver needs to be aware that driving unaccompanied increases the fine to €120 on conviction.

How many penalty points will an unaccompanied learner driver receive on conviction? RSA0220

4 penalty points.

A learner driver needs to be aware that driving unaccompanied increases the penalty points to 4 on conviction.

Section 2

Cars, light vans, tractors and works vehicles

Alert driving and showing consideration for other road users

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When you are driving, you need to always expect the unexpected. You literally don't know what's around the next bend, but you can avoid some dangerous situations by developing your observation skills and learning to anticipate danger. Even the best and safest drivers, however, will have to take corrective or emergency actions from time to time.

What should a driver do when they want to use a mobile phone? BW0001RU19

Pull in and stop in a safe place.

It is illegal to use or handle a mobile phone while driving. Driving requires all of your attention, all of the time, so you should never use or handle a mobile phone while driving. If you want to use a mobile phone, the only safe thing to do is to find a safe place to stop.

Before exiting the vehicle on a busy road, what should the driver ensure? BW0002RU19

Before opening the door the driver should check it is safe to do so.

When exiting from a parked vehicle on a busy road, the driver should check it is safe to do so before opening the door, as there could be cyclists or other traffic passing closely by.

In this situation, what should the driver in the right-hand lane of the dual carriageway be aware of? BW0004RU19

Crosswinds may blow the rider into their path.

When driving in wet and windy conditions, a driver should be aware that these conditions can affect the stability of vulnerable road users such as motorcyclists or cyclists. These road users may be blown into the driver's path particularly in open and exposed areas.

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Seeing where you are going

As a driver, you must be able to see where you are going, and you must adjust the way you are driving to suit the road, weather and traffic conditions all around you. When you are going forward, you will mainly use your windscreen and mirrors for this; when you are reversing you will mainly be looking over your shoulder, while glancing around frequently.

Making sure that you can see properly

While you are driving any motor vehicle, you must have a clear view of the road ahead, and you must also be constantly aware of the road and traffic conditions around you to the sides and rear. The questions in this section check that you understand the importance of this, and that you know how to react if your view is obstructed in any way.

What should a driver do before towing a caravan? BW0005RU19

Have extended mirrors fitted to the towing vehicle.

If a driver intends towing a caravan, they should fit extended mirrors to both sides of the towing vehicle. This will allow the driver to better observe the traffic situation behind and to the sides.

When towing a high and wide-bodied trailer what should a driver do? BW0006RU19

Make use of extended mirrors to check for following traffic.

When towing a high and wide-bodied trailer, a driver should use extended mirrors on both sides of the towing vehicle. This will allow the driver to better observe the traffic situation behind and to the sides.

If the vehicle's windows are covered with ice, what should the driver do? BW0008RU19

Fully clear ice from all windows.

Make sure all the windows are completely clear of ice so that the driver can safely observe road and traffic conditions all around. This is especially important when driving in slippery conditions. It is good practice to carry a can of de-icer in the vehicle and if possible to fill the washer reservoir with a de-icing agent.

What should a driver do if the vehicle's windows and mirrors are covered in ice? BW0009RU19

Switch on the heating system and use a scraper to clear the ice before driving.

Make sure all the windows and mirrors are completely clear of ice so that the driver can safely observe road and traffic conditions all around. This is especially important when driving in slippery conditions. It is good practice to carry a can of de-icer in the vehicle and if possible to fill the washer reservoir with a de-icing agent.

What should a driver do if condensation is affecting the vehicle's windows? BW0010RU19

Dry the windows with a cloth and then use the demister system.

Make sure the windows are clear and clean at all times so that the driver can see the road and traffic conditions all around. Condensation on the window can seriously impair your ability to make proper observations. Drivers should familiarise themselves with how to correctly set the vehicle's ventilation system in order to keep the windows clear.

How can sunlight affect visibility in a car with grimy windows? BW0011RU19

It can seriously reduce visibility.

It is essential that all vehicle windows are clear and clean at all times so that drivers can see road and traffic conditions all around. Dirty windows are a particular hazard when the sun is low in the sky. Dirty windows also decrease visibility during hours of twilight and darkness.

Reversing

When you are reversing a vehicle, your ability to see where you are going and to see around the vehicle is restricted. For this reason, you must check carefully before you start, and execute the manoeuvre slowly and carefully, checking all around you as you go. The questions in this section check your understanding of this issue.

What specific observations should a driver make before reversing their vehicle? BW0012RU19

Look over both shoulders and behind.

Before reversing, look over both shoulders and to the rear to check all around that there are no children or other road users around the vehicle and that it is safe to reverse.

What specific observations should a driver make before reversing a vehicle fitted with an external audible warning device? BW0013U19

Observations should be made to the front, sides and rear of the vehicle, including blind spots.

Drivers should not rely solely on an external audible warning device to warn others that their vehicle is reversing. Before reversing, drivers must make sure it is safe to do so by taking all appropriate observations to the front, sides and rear of the vehicle, including the blind spots. Never assume it is safe to reverse just because the vehicle has an external audible warning device.

What should a driver do when they intend to reverse into a side road? BW0014RU19

Check carefully all around before and during the reverse.

Before and while reversing into a side road, check all around to make sure it is safe and clear to carry out the manoeuvre, paying particular attention to pedestrians crossing behind the vehicle and any other road users.

What should a driver do if they intend to reverse their vehicle into an area which they cannot see? BW0016RU19

Ask someone to guide you when reversing.

Do not attempt to reverse into an area that you cannot see into properly. You should get assistance from somebody who can guide you safely into the area.

Remaining alert

Every driver has a responsibility to remain alert, and not to do anything that might impair their ability to react and respond to changes in the road or traffic conditions, or to the actions of other road users. Drivers should also be aware of the capabilities and limitations of the vehicle they are driving, and not drive in such a way that they endanger themselves or others.

What should a driver do in order to keep alert during a long journey? BW0018RU19
Increase the air circulation and stop if necessary.

While on a long journey, a driver should take regular rest breaks. A short walk and a caffeinated drink (tea or coffee) can help to revive them. The vehicle should be kept cool and well ventilated with a steady flow of fresh air.

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What can a driver do to stay alert on a long journey? CD0032U19
Stop, park in a safe place and have a cup of coffee.

If a driver continues to drive fighting sleep it can be the same as being over the drink driving limit. Stopping the vehicle in a safe place, drinking caffeine and taking a nap for 15 minutes will revive the driver allowing them to continue for a short period.

Using the handbrake

Before you drive any vehicle, you must be familiar with its features and controls, and you must know how and when to use them. One of the most important features of any vehicle is its braking systems, and you must know when it is appropriate to use the foot brake and when to use the handbrake.

When should the handbrake be used to bring a vehicle to a halt? BW0024RU19
Normally never.

In general the handbrake should never be used to bring a vehicle to a halt. This practice is potentially dangerous, as the rear wheels could lock up and the vehicle could skid out of control. In addition, using the handbrake does not operate the rear brake lights to warn following traffic.

What is the danger associated with applying the handbrake (parking brake) when the vehicle is moving? BW0025RU19
The wheels could lock and cause the vehicle to skid.

Except in an emergency, the handbrake (parking brake) should never be used when the vehicle is moving. This practice is potentially dangerous, as the wheels could lock up and the vehicle could skid out of control. In addition there is no warning to following traffic from the brake lights.

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Driving on different road surfaces

You must modify your driving behaviour to take account of changes in the weather, the traffic conditions and the road surfaces. The questions in this section check that you know how to respond to different road surfaces.

Why should a tractor be driven more slowly on uneven road surfaces?
To avoid severe bouncing. BW0023RU19

Drivers should drive more slowly on an uneven road surface because driving a tractor at speed could cause the vehicle or the trailer to become unstable and difficult to control. During severe bouncing the tractor's wheels can lose contact with the road, negatively affecting steering and braking.

What would a lightness in the steering MOST likely indicate?
Icy surface. CPC1138AU19

Lightness in steering indicates a loss of traction. This generally happens when the road surface is icy. Ice provides a harder, smoother surface than rain, or snow so it is difficult to avoid skidding and drivers should allow up to 10 times the normal braking distance in order to stop safely.

When driving on a hill, how should a steep descent be negotiated in snow or frosty weather? CD0103U19
Engage a lower gear early and use gentle braking applications to keep the speed down.

In snow or ice, a vehicle takes longer to stop. Before starting a steep descent in a large vehicle, the driver should reduce speed and select a lower gear, brake gently and only when needed. If the vehicle is fitted with a manually selectable retarder, engage it before starting the descent.

What should a driver do before starting a journey in bad weather?
Top up the windscreen washer reservoir. CD0100RU19

Before starting a long journey in adverse weather the driver should ensure that there is sufficient fluid in the windscreen washer bottle in order to keep the windscreen clear in these conditions.

What should a driver do before starting a journey in adverse weather conditions? CD0099AAU19
Check the weather forecast for the planned route.

Driving in adverse weather conditions is more dangerous and more tiring. Drivers should check the weather forecast and weather warnings and other sources for information on the expected conditions on the intended route, and allow extra time to complete the journey.

What effect can wet weather have on the vehicle's exterior mirrors?
It can distort the rear vision of the driver. CD0083RU19

When driving in the rain, water droplets can adhere to the exterior mirrors and obscure the driver's view to the side and rear of the vehicle. If the vehicle has heated mirrors, turn them on to clear them. Alternatively, stop periodically to clear them manually.

Driving in fog

Driving in fog can be difficult, tiring and dangerous. Not only do you have difficulty in seeing the road markings and other traffic, but other road users also have difficulty in seeing you. The questions in this section check that you understand this issue and know how to respond.

When should rear fog lights be used?
In dense fog or falling snow. BW0026RU19

A driver must only use rear fog lights in dense fog or falling snow. Using fog lights in normal road and weather conditions can dazzle or blind following motorists. Also, fog lights may make brake lights harder to see.

When should rear fog lights be used?
When driving in dense fog or falling snow. BW0027RU19

A driver must only use rear fog lights in dense fog or falling snow. Using fog lights in normal road and weather conditions can dazzle or blind following motorists. Also, fog lights may make brake lights harder to see.

Driving at night

Driving at night, particularly along unlit roads or in wet weather, is challenging. You need to be sure that you can see the road ahead well enough, and that you can be seen by other road users.

What should a driver do if the right-hand headlight bulb fails when driving at night? BW0028RU19

Have the bulb replaced immediately.

Vehicles (except motorcycles) are required by law to have right and left headlights. Faulty lights should be repaired immediately. A vehicle with only one headlight can cause a hazard to other road users or be mistaken for a motorcycle.

What should a driver do if dazzled by headlights reflecting in the rear-view mirror of their car? BW0029RU19

Use the night driving mode on their rear-view mirror.

If a driver is being dazzled by the lights of following traffic, they should adjust their rear-view mirror to the night driving mode. This will allow them to concentrate on the road ahead and not be distracted by lights from following traffic.

What should a driver do if dazzled by lights at night reflecting in their interior mirror? BW0030RU19

Temporarily adjust the angle of the mirror.

If the lights of following traffic reflecting in your interior mirror are dazzling you, activate the night driving /anti dazzle mode. If the vehicle is not equipped with this feature drivers should temporarily adjust the angle of the interior mirror to relieve the glare and allow them to drive without distraction.

At night, what effect could driving with a single headlight have on oncoming drivers? BW0031RU19

They could mistake the vehicle for a motorcycle.

Motor vehicles (except motorcycles) are required by law to have two headlights. A vehicle with only one headlight could be mistaken for a motorcycle and other road users could believe that it is in a different position on the road than it actually is. Vehicle lights should be checked on a regular basis and repair faulty lighting immediately.

Generally what lighting must a car, tractor or works vehicle have when driving? BW0032U19

Headlights, front and rear side lights, rear number plate light, red rear reflectors, brake lights and indicators.

In general all cars, tractors and works vehicles are required by law to have headlights, front and rear side lights, rear number plate light, rear reflectors, brake lights and indicators. There are some exceptions to this, such as Electric cars with a maximum speed of 38km/h.

What lights should be shown on a parked car, tractor or works vehicle at night on an unlit public road? BW0033U19

At least one side lamp front and rear on the side nearest the centre of the road.

When leaving a vehicle on an unlit public road at night this creates a potential danger for other road users. Drivers should therefore leave side/parking lights on, so that the vehicle can be seen by other road users. Drivers should not leave headlights on when parked as this may cause other road users to become disoriented.

Bridges and tunnels

Before going under a bridge or entering a tunnel, you must make sure that your vehicle will fit under it. You will see a advance warning sign before you come to the bridge or tunnel specifying the maximum height of vehicle that it can accommodate.

In addition, going over some bridges – in particular humpback bridges – poses a particular hazard for vehicles pulling a trailer, as there is a danger that the trailer may become detached from the towing vehicle.

What danger could be associated with driving a tractor and trailer over a humpbacked bridge? BW0034RU19

The trailer could become detached.

Before towing a trailer, a driver should ensure that the tow hitch has sufficient ground clearance. If this hits the road, for example when travelling over a humpbacked bridge, there is a danger that the trailer will become detached. Drivers should also plan and carry out their journey with an awareness of this risk.

If a vehicle being driven through a tunnel goes on fire, what should the driver do? CD0163RU19

Leave the vehicle immediately and use the emergency phone at the nearest emergency station.

If there is smoke or fire in the vehicle, switch off the engine, leave the vehicle immediately, go to the emergency station and use the emergency phone to alert the tunnel operator and leave the tunnel by the nearest available exit.

What should a driver do if their vehicle breaks down in a tunnel? CD0162RU19

Switch on the hazard warning lights.

If a driver's vehicle stops in a tunnel due to a breakdown, switch off the engine, switch on the hazard warning lights, check the radio for instructions and use the emergency phone at the emergency station to call for help, check all electronic signs in the tunnel for information.

What should a driver do if their vehicle breaks down in a tunnel? CD0161RU19

Use the emergency telephone to call for help.

If a driver's vehicle stops in a tunnel due to a breakdown, switch off the engine, switch on the hazard warning lights, check the radio for instructions and use the emergency phone at the emergency station to call for help, check all electronic signs in the tunnel for information.

What should a driver do if their vehicle is forced to stop in a tunnel due to a breakdown or a crash? CD0160RU19

Call for help from an emergency station.

If there is a breakdown or crash in a tunnel, stop, switch off the engine, switch on the hazard warning lights, check the radio for instructions and use the emergency phone at the emergency station to call for help, check all electronic signs in the tunnel for information.

When a vehicle is stopped in a tunnel due to congestion what should a driver do? CD0159RU19

Switch off the engine.

If, when driving a vehicle through a tunnel, you are halted in stationary traffic for any length of time, you should switch off the engine to reduce fumes in the tunnel and conserve fuel.

When a vehicle is stopped in a tunnel due to congestion what should a driver do? CD0158RU19

Switch on hazard warning lights.

If, when driving a vehicle through a tunnel, you meet traffic congestion, leave a safe distance between you and the vehicle in front and switch on your hazard warning lights when stationary.

Before entering a tunnel, what should a driver do in order to improve vision? CD0156RU19

Take off sunglasses.

Be aware that there is considerably less light available in a tunnel, even with the tunnel lights on. To improve your vision remove your sunglasses before entering the tunnel.

Before driving through a tunnel, what should a driver do? CD0154RAU19
Check that you have sufficient fuel.

If your route takes you through a tunnel, you must ensure that your vehicle has sufficient fuel to safely pass through.

Driving licences and learner permits

The questions in this section test that you know what the holder of each category of driving licence and learner permit is allowed and not allowed to do.

Where should L-plates be displayed on cars? BW0037R
Both front and rear.

The holder of a learner permit must display L-plates on the front and rear of their car at all times when driving on public roads.

When must the holder of a learner permit display L-plates on their car? BW0038RU19
At all times when driving.

The holder of a learner permit must display L-plates on the front and rear of their car at all times when driving on public roads.

How would a driver calculate the maximum overall permitted weight of their vehicle? BW0039RU19
By adding the unladen weight of the vehicle to the load permitted to be carried.

The maximum permitted weight of a vehicle is the sum of the unladen weight of the vehicle plus the maximum load that may be carried in it. It is an offence to overload a vehicle, as it reduces your ability to control it effectively.

What is the maximum gross weight of a vehicle that may be driven by the holder of a category B driving licence? BW0582R
3,500 kilograms

The holder of a category B driving licence is not permitted to drive a vehicle with a design gross vehicle weight of more than 3,500kgs. This restriction is noted on the licence.

What is the maximum authorised mass (MAM) of a car that may be driven by the holder of a category B driving licence? BW0040RU19
3,500 kilograms.

The holder of a category B driving licence is not permitted to drive a vehicle with a MAM of more than 3,500kgs. This restriction is noted on the licence.

What is the maximum number of passengers that may be carried in a vehicle driven by the holder of a category B driving licence? BW0044RU19
8 passengers.

The holder of a category B driving licence is not permitted to drive a vehicle that has seating for more than 8 passengers excluding the driver.

When can the holder of a Category W learner permit carry a passenger? BW0045RU19
Only when the passenger also holds a Category W driving licence and the vehicle is designed to carry a passenger.

The holder of a category W learner permit may carry a passenger in the vehicle only if: the vehicle is designed to take a passenger, and the passenger has held a full driving licence in category W for two or more years.

Collisions and breakdowns

At the scene of a collision or breakdown, do not do anything that might make the situation worse. Make sure that any injured persons are properly attended to by contacting the emergency services. Make sure that oncoming traffic is given adequate warning of any hazard and that bystanders are not exposed to danger.

A driver has stalled in the middle of an unguarded level crossing and cannot restart the engine. The warning bell is ringing. What should the driver do? BW0046RU19

Walk clear of the crossing and phone the signal operator so that trains can be stopped.

In this situation, the driver and all passengers should get out of the vehicle and immediately use the emergency phone at the crossing to contact the signal operator so that trains can be stopped. If necessary, warn other motorists. Do not return to the vehicle until instructed by the signal operator or emergency services.

What should a driver do if their vehicle breaks down on an automatic railway level crossing? BW0051RU19

Get passengers clear of the crossing and phone the signal operator so that trains can be stopped.

In this situation, you and all passengers should get out of the vehicle and immediately use the emergency phone at the crossing to contact the signal operator so that trains can be stopped. If necessary, warn other motorists. Do not return to the vehicle until instructed by the signal operator or emergency services.

What is the immediate effect of a head-on collision between two cars at speed? BW0053U19

All persons in each vehicle are thrown violently forward.

In a head-on collision passengers in both vehicles are propelled forwards, and if they are not wearing seatbelts they may go through the windscreen. It is the drivers responsibility to ensure that all passengers under the age of 17 wear seatbelts. Older passengers are themselves responsible for wearing seatbelts.

When changing a wheel on a public road, what should a person do to ensure their own safety? BW0055R

Wear reflective clothing and switch on the vehicle hazard warning lights.

When changing a wheel at the side of the road, switch on the vehicle hazard warning lights, and wear reflective or light-coloured clothing. This will help other motorists to react and slow down when passing.

Carrying passengers

The questions in this section check that you know the regulations relating to carrying passengers, and that you know how to drive and operate your vehicle in a way that ensures the comfort and safety of the passengers.

Why is it dangerous to allow children to stand in the space between the front seats of a car? BW0047RU19

They could be thrown forward if the brakes are applied suddenly.

When carrying children in a car or goods vehicle, it is the drivers responsibility to make sure that they are suitably restrained.

When are children allowed to stand with their heads up through an open sun roof? BW0048R

Children are never allowed to do so.

When carrying children in a car or goods vehicle, it is the driver's responsibility to make sure that they are suitably restrained.

When may the holder of a Category W learner permit carry a passenger on a tractor or works vehicle? BW0049

When there is proper passenger seating and the passenger holds a full category W licence.

The holder of a category W licence may carry a passenger in the vehicle only if: 1.the vehicle is designed to take a passenger, and 2. the passenger has held a full driving licence in category W for two or more years.

Are children allowed to be left unattended in a vehicle? BW0050R
Children should never be left unattended in a vehicle.

Children must not be left unattended in a vehicle, even for a short period of time. Children might interfere with the vehicle's controls, and would not be able to deal with an emergency situation, such as a fire or electrical malfunction which could result in serious injury or death.

When is a driver allowed to carry more passengers in a car than there are seat belts available? BW0056R
It is never allowed.

A driver must make sure that each passenger in the vehicle has a seatbelt. Failure to wear a seatbelt is an offence. It is the driver's responsibility to ensure that passengers under the age of 17 wear seatbelts. Older passengers are themselves responsible for wearing seatbelts.

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Safety on tractors

The questions in this section check that you understand the dangers of working in or around tractors.

When should children be allowed to drive a tractor? BW0052R
Children should never be allowed to drive a tractor.

Persons under 16 years of age are not permitted to drive a tractor in a public place.

What danger can arise from the power take-off shaft of a tractor? BW0054
If it is not covered, clothing can get caught in it.

If you are working at the rear of a tractor, you should bear in mind that if the power take-off shaft is not covered, loose clothing might get caught in it and lead to injury or death.

Carrying loads

The questions in this section check that you know the dangers associated with carrying a load in your vehicle, and that you know how to do so safely.

What should a driver do when requested to drive a vehicle that they feel is overloaded? BW0057R
Refuse to drive the vehicle.

You should not take a vehicle that you believe to be overloaded onto a public road. Overloading is dangerous, as it affects the stability and braking capabilities of the vehicle.

How could towing an overloaded trailer affect a vehicle? BW0058R
It could impair the vehicle's steering and braking.

You should not take an overloaded trailer onto a public road. An overloaded trailer impairs the stability, steering and braking of the towing vehicle.

When is a red flag a sufficient marker for a rear load overhang that exceeds one metre? BW0129R
Only during the day.

During daylight hours, you must use a red flag to mark any load that is protruding more than one metre. At night, you must use a red light.

At what point is a vehicle load more likely to shift? BW0130R
When cornering.

It is the driver's responsibility to ensure that the load is properly secured and evenly distributed, so that the vehicle can be properly controlled when changing direction and when braking.

How should a driver negotiate a bend when driving a fully loaded vehicle? BW0131R
At a slower speed than when empty.

Driving too fast on the approach to a bend and while driving through it with a fully loaded vehicle can lead to a loss of control. This can be prevented by driving in a safe and sensible manner and by reading the road ahead.

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Towing a trailer

The questions in this section check that you know how to tow a trailer safely.

When attaching a trailer to their vehicle, what must a driver check?
That the load is evenly spread.

BW0060RU19

Proper weight distribution helps to ensure the stability of both the towing vehicle and the trailer. In the trailer, the bulk of the load should be over the axles. If a heavy load is positioned at the front of the trailer, this will result in too much nose weight on the hitch of the towing vehicle and make it difficult to steer. If a heavy load is positioned at the rear of the trailer, this will result in reduced weight on the rear axle of the towing vehicle, which will make it more unstable.

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When attaching a trailer to their vehicle, what must a driver check?
That the trailer coupling is attached securely.

BW0061RU19

Before towing a trailer or a caravan, check that the tow bar is securely attached to the towing vehicle, that the trailer coupling is properly attached to the tow bar and locked in place, and that the breakaway cable is properly connected.

What should a driver do to secure the towing vehicle before unhitching a trailer?

BW0062R

Apply the handbrake, switch off the ignition and engage a low gear.

Before unhitching a trailer, apply the handbrake, switch off the ignition and engage a lower gear, so that the towing vehicle does not move while you are unhitching the trailer.

When is a tractor most likely to overturn?

BW0064RU19

When turning sharply.

When you are driving a tractor, you should be aware that tractors are less stable than other vehicles and take extra care when manoeuvring.

When driving a tractor and trailer, what should the driver do on entering a roundabout to avoid possible roll-over?

BW0065R

Reduce speed.

When you are driving a tractor with a trailer, you need to take extra care because of the vehicle's instability. Always drive at a safe speed, in particular when changing direction, such as on a roundabout.

What is meant by the term jack-knifing?

BW0066RU19

When the trailer is travelling faster than the drawing vehicle.

Towing a trailer or caravan dramatically reduces the stability of the towing vehicle. If a driver brakes sharply or slows down quickly, the trailer may pivot around the tow hitch coupling, causing both vehicles to go off course, and possibly overturn.

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When is jack-knifing most likely to occur?

BW0067

When trying to reduce speed sharply while travelling downhill.

Towing a trailer or caravan dramatically reduces the stability of the towing vehicle. If a driver brakes sharply or slows down quickly, the trailer may pivot around the tow hitch coupling, causing both vehicles to go off course, and possibly overturn.

Technical matters with a bearing on road safety

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The questions in this section check that you know how to keep your vehicle in good condition, that you recognise signs that it needs to be repaired or serviced, and that you understand the implications for your own safety and that of others of driving a vehicle in poor condition.

Side lights

The primary purpose of side lights is to make the vehicle more visible when it is parked. Don't use them when driving at night – use dipped headlights instead.

When should a driver use the vehicle side lights? BW0069RU19

When parking on an unlit road.

When leaving a vehicle on an unlit public road at night this creates a potential danger for other road users. Drivers should therefore leave side/parking lights on, so that the vehicle can be seen by other road users. Drivers should not leave headlights on when parked as this may cause other road users to become disoriented.

Lights on trailers

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If you are towing a trailer, it must have a rear number plate. The lighting requirements are similar to those for the towing vehicle. These questions check that you know these requirements.

What lighting must be on a two-axle car-trailer? BW0077RU19

Indicators, brake lights, rear number plate light, red reflectors and rear tail lights.

All vehicles, including trailers, must have rear indicators, brake lights, a rear number plate light, red reflectors and rear tail lights.

What lighting must be on a tractors trailer during lighting-up hours? BW0078U19

Indicators, brake lights, rear number plate light, red reflectors and rear tail lights.

A trailer being towed by a tractor must have rear indicators, brake lights, a rear number plate light, red reflectors and rear tail lights whilst being towed on a public road.

Hazard warning lights

Your hazard warning lights are an important way of communicating to other road users that there is a danger on the road ahead. You should know when and how to use them.

On a motorway, when should a driver use the hazard warning lights?
When slowing down quickly because of danger ahead.

BW0071R

Use the hazard warning lights to warn other road users of a danger ahead. For example, if you have to slow down sharply because of a build-up of traffic ahead, you can use the hazard warning lights to warn following vehicles that they need to slow down.

What effect do the hazard warning lights have on the brake lights?
They have no effect.

BW0072RU19

The hazard lights work independently of the other lights on the vehicle (except the direction indicators), and have no effect on the brake lights. Use the hazard warning lights to warn other road users of a danger ahead, when your vehicle is broken down and causing an obstruction, or when you needs to slow down sharply on a motorway.

When should a driver use their hazard warning lights?
When the vehicle has broken down.

BW0073RU19

Use the hazard warning lights to warn other road users of a danger ahead. For example, if a drivers vehicle has broken down and is stopped on the hard shoulder, they should use the vehicles hazard warning lights to warn other road users of their presence.

When should a driver use their vehicle's hazard warning lights?
When causing an unavoidable obstruction.

BW0075RU19

Use the hazard warning lights to warn other road users of a danger ahead. For example, if a drivers vehicle is causing an unavoidable obstruction such as being broken down, they should use the vehicles hazard warning lights to warn other road users of their presence.

When should a driver use their vehicle's hazard warning lights?
When broken down and causing an obstruction.

BW0076RU19

Use the hazard warning lights to warn other road users of a danger ahead. For example, if a drivers vehicle is causing an unavoidable obstruction such as being broken down, they should use the vehicles hazard warning lights to warn other road users of their presence.

On a motorway, when should a driver use the hazard warning lights?
When the vehicle has broken down.

BW1U19

Use the hazard warning lights to warn other road users of a danger ahead. For example, if your vehicle has broken down and is stopped on the hard shoulder, you can use the hazard warning lights to warn following vehicles of your presence.

Brakes

Before you drive any vehicle, you must be familiar with its features and controls, and you must know how and when to use them. One of the most important features of any vehicle is its braking systems, and you must know when it is appropriate to use the foot brake and when to use the handbrake.

The parking brake (hand brake) generally works on which wheels?
The rear wheels.

BW0079RU19

In most vehicles, the parking brake operates on the rear wheels only. The function of the parking brake (handbrake) is to stop the vehicle from moving when it is parked or when it is stopped on a hill. Drivers normally use the parking brake when the vehicle is already stationary and should generally not use it to stop the vehicle. It is even more important to use the parking brake when parked on a hill or when stationary in a vehicle with automatic transmission to prevent creep.

In general, above what gross vehicle weight must a trailer have brakes fitted?
750 kg

BW0080RU19

Brakes must be fitted to a trailer if its gross vehicle weight exceeds either 750kg or half the weight of the towing vehicle.

Driving a vehicle with automatic transmission

A vehicle with automatic transmission has some obvious differences from one with manual transmission (such as no clutch), and some differences that are not so obvious. You need to be aware of these differences, particularly if you sometimes drive a manual vehicle and sometimes an automatic.

What is the recommended method of driving a car with automatic transmission? BW0081RU19

Operate the accelerator and brake with the right foot.

When driving a car with automatic transmission, drivers should use the right foot to operate both the accelerator and the brake, just as in vehicles with a manual gear box. In general it is important to avoid using the accelerator and the brake at the same time.

Fuel and oil

The oil in your engine lubricates and cools the moving parts of the engine. If there is too little oil in the engine, or if it is not reaching the parts that need it, the engine can be permanently damaged. Over-filling the engine with oil also causes problems.

If you are driving a diesel engined car, you must always use unrebated (white) diesel in it, rather than green diesel.

What is a possible effect of over-filling the engine with oil? BW0083RU19

It could damage the catalytic converter.

It is essential that the vehicles engine is not over filled with oil as this can permanently damage the Catalytic converter which is part of most vehicles exhaust systems and removes up to 75% of the carbon monoxide, nitrogen oxide and hydrocarbons from the vehicles exhaust. Damaging this increase exhaust emissions.

What should a driver do if the fuel system becomes air-locked? BW0084RU19

Bleed the air out of the fuel system.

The fuel system can become air-locked if you let the fuel get too low or if there is a leak in the system. You should have the problem corrected before driving. The solution may be as simple as bleeding the fuel system to release the air.

Is a driver allowed to use rebated (green) diesel fuel in a car on a public road? BW0085RU19

Green diesel may never be used in a car.

If, in its normal use, a vehicle is used on a public road, it must use unmarked (white) diesel, as the appropriate excise duties are included in the purchase price. Drivers can be prosecuted for using green diesel in a vehicle on a public road.

Head restraints

What should a driver do to reduce the risk of neck injury in the event of a rear-end collision? BW0086RU19

Use a properly adjusted head restraint.

It is essential that head restraints be properly adjusted for both the driver and the passengers. Head restraints are designed to protect the neck and spine in a collision and thus prevent or reduce whiplash. If head restraints are not properly adjusted there is an increased risk to the vehicles occupants.

Rear-view mirror on tractors

When must a tractor or works vehicle be fitted with a rear-view mirror? BW0087RU19

A rear-view mirror must always be fitted.

All vehicles used on a public road must have a rear-view mirror. The mirror should be used to enable the driver to see the traffic and road conditions behind and to each side.

Tyres

Your ability to control your vehicle, to steer it in the direction you want and to stop it when and where you want depends critically on the few square centimetres of rubber that are in contact with the road at any time. You must make sure that your tyres are in good condition and correctly inflated.

What is the minimum legal tread depth for tyres on cars?
1.6 millimetres

BW0088R

All road vehicles, except motorcycles and vintage vehicles, must have a minimum tyre tread depth of 1.6mm over the main tread. However, for safety reasons, you should replace the vehicle's tyres before they become this worn.

What does the load index of a tyre indicate?
The maximum load a tyre can carry.

BW0091

The load index indicates the maximum weight that a tyre can support safely. When replacing a tyre on your vehicle, you should make sure that the new tyre maintains the proper load index for the vehicle.

Under what circumstances could both cross-ply and radial tyres be fitted to a vehicle?
When each type is fitted on a different axle.

BW0092R

In general, you should fit the same type of tyres all round the vehicle. However if you need to fit a mix of cross-ply and radials, the tyres on any axle should be of the same type.

Seats

What is the effect of an incorrectly adjusted driver's seat?
It can delay the driver from operating a control.

BW0096R

Before starting a journey, you should adopt a suitable and comfortable driving position by adjusting the driver's seat to a position where all the vehicle controls can be operated efficiently.

Windscreen wipers and washer

You have to keep your windscreen clean and clear in order to see the road ahead and the traffic conditions around you, Your windscreen wipers and washer are essential pieces of equipment for this purpose, and you must know how to keep them in good condition.

A driver notices that the wiper blades are worn. What should they do?
Have the blades replaced as soon as possible.

BW0097RU19

Use the windscreen wipers to keep the windscreen clear of rain, spray, snow or fog. Check them regularly to ensure that they are in good working order, and replace them when they become worn, before they become ineffective.

When a wiper blade fails to clear the windscreen what should the driver do?
Have the wiper blades replaced as soon as possible.

BW0099RU19

Use the windscreen wipers to keep the windscreen clear of rain, spray, snow or fog. Check them regularly to ensure that they are in good working order, and replace them when they become worn, before they become ineffective.

Changing a wheel

The questions in this section check that you know how to change a wheel on a car safely.

If a vehicle breaks down on a motorway, what should a person do? BW0112

Use a roadside phone to contact Gardai and never try to carry out repairs yourself.

When a vehicle breaks down on a motorway, a driver should move the vehicle to the hard shoulder, use the roadside phone to contact the Gardai, and do not place a warning device on the motorway. The driver should never try to do repairs themselves in the hard shoulder.

Environmental matters

Motor vehicles are a significant cause of pollution. In particular, they generate large amounts of the gases that are causing climate change. Other environmental effects include the amount of noise generated by engines and tyres.

All drivers should be aware of these effects, and modify their driving habits to minimise their negative impact on the environment. The questions in this section check that you understand the issues involved and that you know how to drive responsibly.

What could a driver do in order to avoid excessive exhaust pollution from their vehicle? BW0107RU33

Have the vehicle's air filters changed regularly.

Drivers should have their vehicle serviced regularly in accordance with the manufacturers guidelines. A vehicle with a dirty air filter uses more fuel and creates more exhaust pollution. Air filters should be changed as part of normal servicing. If a vehicle is used in dusty conditions, the air filter may need to be changed more often. More information is available in the vehicle owners handbook.

In general how regularly should a vehicle be serviced? BW0113RU33

As per the manufacturer's recommendation.

Drivers should have their vehicle serviced regularly in accordance with the manufacturers guidelines. This helps the vehicle to perform properly, and as a result saves fuel and reduces emissions. In addition, drivers should also carry out their own daily and weekly checks on fluid levels and tyres.

What is the purpose of a catalytic converter? BW0109RU19

To reduce harmful exhaust emissions.

Catalytic converters are part of a vehicles exhaust system. They help to protect the environment by removing up to 75% of the carbon monoxide, nitrogen oxide and hydrocarbons from the vehicles exhaust.

What type of noise might fast cornering create? BW0110

Tyre squeal.

If you drive around a corner too fast, the tyres begin to lose contact with the surface of the road, and this causes a squealing sound. If you continue driving in this way, you can lose control of the vehicle.

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Getting out of the vehicle

Before you get out of your vehicle, check that opening the door will not interfere with other road users, and that you can get out safely. Similarly, when you are letting passengers out, you must make sure that they can do so safely.

What should a driver do before getting out of the vehicle? BW0113RU19

Check their side mirror and look behind before opening the door.

Before opening any door, check for other road users passing, and in particular look out for pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists. Exit the vehicle only when it is safe to do so, and close the door as soon as possible. Where ever possible, passengers should exit on the side nearest the kerb wherever possible.

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How should a driver secure their vehicle before getting out of it? BW0114R

Apply the parking brake, stop the engine and engage a low gear.

Before leaving your vehicle, apply the handbrake, switch off the engine and engage a low gear. If the vehicle is fitted with automatic transmission, select 'P' (park).

What safety precaution should a driver take when getting out of their vehicle? BW0115U19

Check all around for approaching traffic and pedestrians before opening the door.

Before opening any door, check for other road users passing, and in particular look out for pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists. Exit the vehicle only when it is safe to do so, and close the door as soon as possible. Passengers should exit on the side nearest the kerb wherever possible.

On a busy road, how should a driver allow passengers out of a vehicle? BW0116RU19

Stop and allow them to get out on the side nearest the kerb.

Before allowing any door to be opened, check for other road users passing, and in particular look out for pedestrians, cyclists and motorcyclists. Passengers should exit on the side nearest the kerb, without getting in the way of pedestrians.

What should a driver do to secure the vehicle before leaving it? CD0150RU19

Apply the parking brake and switch off the engine.

Before you leave your vehicle, apply the parking brake and switch off the ignition. Check to make sure that you can open the door safely without endangering others, and alight when it is safe to do so.

What advice should a driver give to passengers before opening doors? RSA01047

Check all around and open door with caution.

Before opening any doors, check for other road users nearby, inparticular motorcyclists and pedestrians.

How do you make sure your vehicle is parked safely? RSA01048

Don't park it where it may endanger other road users.

When parking make sure you do not interfere with normal traffic flow and that your vehicle does not disturb, block or endanger other road users.

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What should be considered when reversing out of a parking space? RSA01049

Check for pedestrians and vehicles all around.

Some car parks are designed for you to park forwards to make it easier to load shopping. In these cases take extra care as you reverse out of the parking space because pedestrians and vehicles may pass behind you.

Seatbelts and child restraint systems

Any adult aged 17 years or over travelling in a car – whether in the front or the rear seat – is required to wear a seatbelt. Persons under the age of 17 who weigh more than 36 kg, or are more than 135 cm in height, must also wear adult seatbelts. Lighter, smaller children and babies must be restrained in special seats, harnesses or restraints. The questions in this section check that you know your responsibilities in this regard.

Where safety belts are fitted to a car when must adult occupants wear them? BW0118RU19

At all times.

The driver and all passengers in a car must wear a safety belt or, in the case of a child, a suitable restraint system.

Who is responsible for ensuring that a passenger over 17 years of age is wearing a seat belt while travelling in a car? BW0121RU19

The passenger only.

Where the passenger is over the age of 17 and travelling in a car it is their legal responsibility to comply with the seat belt regulations. Below that age, it is the drivers responsibility.

Who is responsible for ensuring that a passenger under 17 years of age is wearing a seat belt while travelling in a car? BW0122RU19

The driver only.

Where the passenger is over the age of 17 and travelling in a car it is their legal responsibility to comply with the seat belt regulations. Below that age, it is the drivers responsibility.

Who is responsible for ensuring that a child wears a child restraint system in a vehicle? BW0123RU19

The driver only.

Where the passenger is over the age of 17 and travelling in a car it is their legal responsibility to comply with the child restraint regulations. Below that age, it is the drivers responsibility.

In general, how should children under 3 years of age be secured in a vehicle? BW0124U19

They should always be secured in the correct child seat.

Safety belts are designed mainly for adults and older children. Children under 3 years of age must be restrained in an appropriate child restraint system. Warning; Never use a rearward facing child car seat in a seat protected by an active frontal airbag.

Can a child under the age of 3 years be carried unrestrained in the vehicle's front passenger seat. BW0125RU19

No, an infant must always be restrained in the correct child seat.

Generally, children must never travel unrestrained in a vehicle. Children under 3 years of age must be restrained in an appropriate child restraint system. Warning; Never use a rearward facing child car seat in a seat protected by an active frontal airbag.

How should a child restraint system be fitted in a vehicle? BW0126RU19

It should be fitted in accordance with the manufacturers instructions.

It is recommended to fit the child seat correctly, according to the manufacturers instructions, it is safer to fit the seat in the back seat of the car and to buy a child car seat only from a retailer who will check that it fits both the car and the child.

Dealing with emergencies

The questions in this section deal with a number of emergency situations that you may find yourself in. They include getting a puncture while you are driving, skidding, breaking down, and avoiding a collision.

Punctures

A puncture is always an inconvenience, but it is also sometimes dangerous. If you get a sudden puncture while driving, you must know what to do in order to keep control of the vehicle and not endanger yourself or others.

What should a driver do if a tyre bursts on the vehicle they are driving? BW0132R

Hold the steering wheel firmly and pull in on the side of the road.

If a tyre bursts on your vehicle, keep a firm hold of the steering, slow down gradually and stop where it is safe to do so. Switch on the hazard warning lights.

What should a driver do if they get a tyre blow-out on the road? BW0140R

Apply the footbrake gently and bring the vehicle to a halt.

If a tyre on the vehicle you are driving blows out, slow down gradually and find a safe and suitable place to stop. Switch on your hazard warning lights and change the wheel or call for assistance.

What effect could a front-tyre blow-out have on a vehicle? BW0141RU19

The steering wheel will pull to one side.

If a front tyre on the vehicle you are driving blows out, you will feel the effect of it through the steering wheel. The wheel will generally pull to the side of the blown-out tyre.

What effect could a rear-tyre blow-out have on a vehicle? BW0142RU19

It could cause the vehicle to sway from side to side.

If a rear tyre on the vehicle you are driving blows out, the vehicle may sway from side to side, and this will affect its stability. Slow down, pull in where it is safe to do so, and switch on the hazard warning lights. Change the wheel or call for assistance.

Skidding

You should always drive in a way that is suited to the weather conditions and the state of the road. If you do, you will generally avoid skidding. However, if you do find yourself in a skid, you must know how to react in order to get the vehicle back into control as soon as possible. These questions check that you understand the causes of skidding and how to avoid them.

How should a driver apply the brakes in an emergency if the vehicle is fitted with anti-lock brakes (ABS)? BW0135RU19

Press the brake pedal firmly and hold.

If your vehicle is fitted with ABS, brake firmly. ABS will not stop the vehicle more quickly, it will only prevent the wheels from locking. This helps you to maintain control of the vehicle.

What should a driver do if their vehicle gets into a four-wheel sideways skid? BW0136RU19

Turn the steering wheel in the same direction as the skid and ease off the accelerator.

If your vehicle goes into a four-wheel skid, turn the steering wheel in the same direction as the skid and ease off the accelerator. This should help to bring the wheels back into line and allow you to regain control.

What should a driver do if their vehicle gets into a front-wheel sideways skid? BW0137R

Release the accelerator.

If your vehicle goes into a front-wheel sideways skid, release the accelerator and do not try to steer until the tyres regain some grip on the road.

What should a driver do if their vehicle gets into a rear-wheel sideways skid? BW0138R

Turn the steering wheel in the same direction as the rear wheels are heading.

If your vehicle goes into a rear-wheel sideways skid, turn the steering in the direction the rear wheels are heading. This should be done very gradually, as too much steering could cause the vehicle to skid in the opposite direction.

How should a driver in a vehicle without anti-lock brakes (ABS) deal with a front-wheel straight-line skid? BW0139RU19

Press and release the footbrake at rapid intervals.

If your vehicle does not have ABS and it goes into a straight-line front-wheel skid due to braking, press and release the brake pedal repeatedly and rapidly. This will help to restore tyre grip and enable you to regain control.

Breakdowns and emergencies

If your vehicle breaks down, you should make sure that it does not cause a hazard to other road users, and that any action you take does not put you or others in danger. You must also know how to react and respond to emergency situations, and how to bring your vehicle to a stop quickly and safely.

What action should a driver take if the engine in their vehicle cuts out suddenly when they are driving along? BW0143R

Signal and steer the vehicle to the side of the road.

If the engine in the vehicle you are driving cuts out, signal and steer to the side of the road. Switch on the hazard warning lights and contact the relevant breakdown service to get assistance.

How would hydraulic power steering be affected if an engine stalled in slow-moving traffic? BW0144R

The steering would become heavy and difficult to operate.

Hydraulic power steering is operated by a pump which is driven by the engine. If the engine stalls, the pump stops working, and the steering becomes heavy and requires much more effort to turn.

When driving along, a driver feels that the oncoming car may crash into their vehicle. What should they do? BW0148RU19

Sound the horn to attract the attention of the other driver and take evasive action.

If there is an oncoming vehicle in your path, take evasive action and sound your horn to alert the other driver. Bring your vehicle to a halt immediately.

What should a driver do when suddenly confronted by a hazard on the road? BW0149RU19

Decelerate and apply the footbrake firmly.

To stop your vehicle in an emergency, apply the footbrake firmly, and maintain the pressure until the vehicle stops. Depress the clutch pedal just before stopping.

When driving along and required to stop suddenly, what should a driver do? BW0150RU19

Apply the footbrake firmly.

To stop your vehicle in an emergency, apply the footbrake firmly, and maintain the pressure until the vehicle stops. Depress the clutch pedal just before stopping.

When required to stop in an emergency, what should a driver do? BW0151RU19

Apply firm pressure on the footbrake.

To stop your vehicle in an emergency, apply the footbrake firmly, and maintain the pressure until the vehicle stops. Depress the clutch pedal just before stopping.

When required to stop in an emergency, what should a driver do? BW0152RU19

Apply the footbrake firmly.

To stop your vehicle in an emergency, apply the footbrake firmly, and maintain the pressure until the vehicle stops. Depress the clutch pedal just before stopping.

What should a driver do to avoid having to make an emergency stop?
Keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front.

BWX153

When driving in traffic, read the road ahead and keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front. Use the two-second rule to determine your safe distance from the vehicle in front.

If a vehicle breaks down on a motorway, what should a person do?
Move the vehicle to the hard shoulder.

BW3U59

Move the vehicle to the hard shoulder. Park as near to the left as possible. If this is not possible, take steps to warn other drivers, such as switching on the hazard warning lights.

If a vehicle breaks down on a motorway, what should a person do?
Wear a high visibility vest.

BW4U19

Move the vehicle to the hard shoulder. Park as near to the left as possible. If this is not possible, take steps to warn other drivers, such as switching on the hazard warning lights. Wear a high visibility vest. Always carry at least two in the vehicle.

What should a driver do to avoid having to make an emergency stop?
Scan the road well ahead.

BW5

When driving in traffic, read the road ahead and keep a safe distance from the vehicle in front. Use the two-second rule to determine your safe distance from the vehicle in front.

Part 3 - Motorcycles and mopeds

Safety issues of particular importance for motorcyclists

Before you ride a motorcycle, you must be well prepared. You must equip yourself with the appropriate protective clothing, and you must be thoroughly familiar with the features and controls on the bike you are riding.

Protection and clothing

The questions in this section relate to the ways in which you can protect yourself from injury in the event of a fall or other incident. Some of them relate to legal requirements and some to recommended good practice.

What standard should a motorcyclist ensure that their protective equipment meets?

AM0002RU19

A European Standard CE Mark.

A motorcyclist should always wear appropriate clothing and a secured helmet when riding a motorcycle. Personal protective clothing should be designed to protect them from impact and abrasion as well as from adverse weather conditions. Ensure that your motorcycle clothing/equipment that claims to give protection is marked with a European Standard CE Mark or equivalent. Motorcyclists should always wear a fluorescent and reflective jacket to make them more visible to other road users.

When should a motorcyclist wear high visibility protective clothing?

AM0003RU19

In all situations.

Motorcyclists should always wear appropriate high visibility protective clothing as well as their secured helmet when riding a motorcycle. High visibility protective clothing is designed to make motorcyclists more visible to other road users and to protect them from adverse weather conditions. In addition protective clothing can help protect from injury in the event of a crash or fall. Further advice is available from section 16 of the Rules of the Road.

What should a motorcyclist do to protect their feet and lower limbs while riding?

AM0004RU19

Wear protective boots.

Motorcyclists should wear secure and reinforced boots on every journey. Shoes, sandals or runners do not offer sufficient protection from the weather or support in the event of a crash or fall. Boots should be high enough to protect your shins and support your ankles. Further advice is available from section 16 of the Rules of the Road.

What is the main purpose of wearing motorcycle gloves when riding a motorcycle?

AM0005RU19

To protect the motorcyclist's hands in the event of a fall.

Motorcyclists should wear proper motorcycle gloves on every journey. These will help protect hands from injury in the event of a collision or fall and during adverse weather conditions. Choose gloves that offer maximum protection without hindering the motorcyclists ability to operate the controls easily. More information on protective clothing is available from section 16 of the Rules of the Road.

How should a motorcyclist protect their eyes when riding a motorcycle?

AM0007RU19

By wearing a helmet with a visor or goggles.

Motorcyclists should always wear appropriate eye protection. Most helmets have an adjustable visor to protect the eyes from wind, rain, stone chippings, flies and insects. If the helmet does not have a visor, motorcyclists should wear goggles.

When is it permitted to ride a motorcycle or moped on a public road, without wearing a helmet?

AM0008RU19

It is never permitted.

Motorcyclists are legally required to wear an approved motorcycle helmet while riding a moped or motorcycle in a public place. The helmet should meet EU standards and be securely fastened. Be aware it is illegal to wear an unsecured helmet when riding a motorcycle. An unsecured helmet is not fully effective in the event of a crash, and indeed may have a more adverse effect.

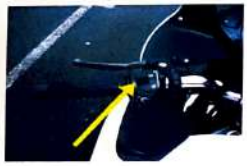
Motorcycle features, taking care of the machine, safety

Modern motorcycles are complex machines. Before you take one onto the public road, you need to be totally familiar with all its features and controls, and know how to use them.

What does this light mean when displayed on the instrument panel? AM0009RU19

The motorcycle is not in gear.

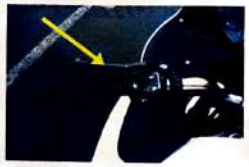
It is essential for motorcyclists to know and understand the various warning lights on the instrument panel. This green light indicates that the transmission is in neutral. It is important to check this before starting the engine.



What does this switch operate? AM0010RU19

Headlight.

This switch selects between the dipped and main beam headlights. Motorcyclists should switch to dipped headlights when faced with oncoming traffic, when following behind other traffic, during adverse weather conditions and to avoid causing inconvenience to other road users. Motorcyclists should drive with dipped headlights at all times.



On a motorcycle with manual transmission, what does this lever operate? AM0011R

The clutch.

On a modern motorcycle with manual transmission, this lever is used to operate the clutch. It is used to disengage the drive between the engine and the driven wheel when moving away, stopping and changing gears.

What does this switch operate? AM0012R

The emergency engine stop.

This switch operates the emergency engine stop or 'kill' switch. It should not normally be used to stop the engine except in emergency situations, such as after a crash or fall. However you should check it periodically to make sure that it is operating properly.

What does this lever operate? AM0013RU19

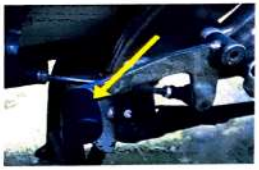
Brakes.

On a modern motorcycle, this lever is used to operate the front brake or combined braking system. To apply the brake, squeeze the lever. The harder the squeeze, the more pronounced the braking effect. It is essential that motorcyclists know how to operate the braking system, if in doubt consult the manufacturers handbook on the safe and appropriate use of the brakes.

Which fluid is contained in this reservoir? AM0014RU19

Brake fluid.

Modern motorcycles fitted with hydraulic brakes normally have the front brake fluid reservoir mounted on the right-side handlebar. The reservoir can be either a clear container or one with a sight-glass to enable the fluid level to be checked. Motorcyclists should check this regularly with the motorcycle in an upright position on a level surface. A low brake fluid level will have a significant effect on the safe operation of the braking system.



What does this foot lever, located on the nearside (left-hand side) of a modern motorcycle, operate? AM0015RU19

The gears.

On most modern manual transmission motorcycles, the gear lever is located on the nearside (left hand side) just in front of the footrest. Motorcyclists select gears by lifting or pushing down the lever with their left foot. Motorcyclists should familiarise themselves with their own motorcycle, as the number of gears varies with make and model.

What does this foot lever, located on the offside (right-hand side) of a modern motorcycle, operate? AM0016RU19

The footbrake.

On a modern motorcycle fitted with manual transmission, the rear brake lever is located on the offside (right hand side) in front of the footrest. The motorcyclist applies the rear brake by pressing the pedal with their right foot. The rear brake is not as effective as the front, so motorcyclists should use it in conjunction with the front brake for optimum stopping power. Many modern motorcycles have a combined braking system, consult the vehicle handbook for further information.

What does this light mean when displayed on the instrument panel? AM0017RU19

A gear is not engaged.

It is essential for motorcyclists to know and understand the various warning lights on the instrument panel. This green light indicates that the transmission is in neutral. It is important to check this before starting the engine.

What action should a motorcyclist take in the event of a front-wheel sideways skid? AM0018RU19

Steer in the same direction that the motorcycle is heading and release the throttle.

In the event of a front-wheel sideways skid, motorcyclists should steer the motorcycle in the direction of the skid and release the throttle. Skids happen when speed or direction suddenly change and tyres cannot maintain their grip on the road. Reduce the risk of skidding by adjusting the speed to the conditions and avoiding harsh operation of the controls.

What should a motorcyclist check before starting the engine? AM0021RU19

That neutral gear is selected.

It is essential for motorcyclists to know and understand the various warning lights on the instrument panel. This green light indicates that the transmission is in neutral. It is important to check this before starting the engine.

What is likely to happen if a motorcyclist fails to lubricate the drive chain on their motorcycle? AM0022RU19

The rate of chain wear will increase.

Motorcyclists should inspect, lubricate and adjust their drive chain in accordance with the owners manual. Failure to lubricate the chain properly will increase the rate of wear to the chain and sprockets prematurely. Special lubricants are available specifically for this purpose.

What could happen if the drive chain on a motorcycle is loose? AM0023RU19

The rear wheel could lock.

If a motorcycle chain is worn or loose, it could come off its sprockets and cause the rear wheel to lock, with a resultant loss of control. Always keep the drive chain properly adjusted and lubricated in accordance with the owners manual.

What might happen if a motorcycle is ridden while the drive chain is slack? AM0024RU19

The rear wheel might lock.

If a motorcycle chain is worn or slack, it could come off its sprockets and cause the rear wheel to lock, with a resultant loss of control. Always keep the drive chain properly adjusted and lubricated in accordance with the owners manual.

What might happen if the drive chain of a motorcycle is incorrectly adjusted? AM0025RU19

It could cause a rattling noise.

If a motorcyclist becomes aware of a rattling noise it is important to check the cause as it may commonly be as a result of an incorrectly adjusted drive chain, which may have serious consequences. Immediately seek assistance from a competent person.

What is the likely consequence of riding a motorcycle with a worn drive chain? AM0026RU19

The chain may stretch or snap.

If a motorcycle chain is worn or loose, it could stretch, snap or come off its sprockets and lock, causing a serious loss of control. A worn chain will generally create a rattling noise, and this should alert the motorcyclist to investigate and address the problem.

What should be checked when the drive chain is being adjusted? AM0027RU19

Wheel alignment.

When the drive chain is being adjusted, make sure that the rear wheel is properly aligned. Failure to do so may cause the tyre to wear prematurely and the handling of the bike will be affected, especially during cornering.

What is the effect of applying the choke for a long period? AM0028RU19

Increased fuel consumption and pollution.

The engine runs on a mixture of fuel and air. When the engine is cold, apply the choke to increase the amount of fuel in the mix. However, if the choke is left on for a period longer than necessary, it will lead to an increase in fuel consumption and pollution.

What could happen if the choke is left on? AM0029RU19

Engine wear and fuel consumption could increase.

The engine runs on a mixture of fuel and air. When the engine is cold, apply the choke to increase the amount of fuel in the mix. However, if the choke is left on for a period longer than necessary, it may lead to excessive engine wear as well as an increase in fuel consumption and pollution.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of concerning cable-operated brakes? AM0030RU19

That they stretch in use.

Cable-operated brakes should be inspected regularly to check that they are operating effectively. If the cable is frayed or over-stretched, it should be replaced, and if the brakes are not effective enough due to brake pad or shoe wear, the cable may need to be adjusted in accordance with the owners manual.

In the interest of road safety, what should be kept clean on a motorcycle? AM0031RU19

Headlight.

Motorcyclists are responsible for keeping their motorcycles in good condition. Keeping the lights (front and rear), reflectors and number plate clean will increase their vision and their visibility to other road users.

In the interest of road safety, what should be kept clean on a motorcycle? AM0032RU19

Rear lights.

Motorcyclists are responsible for keeping their motorcycles in good condition. Keeping the lights (front and rear), reflectors and number plate clean will increase their visibility to other road users.

What is a possible effect of incorrect wheel alignment on a motorcycle? AM0033RU19

Reduced stability.

If the wheels are incorrectly aligned, the motorcycle may run out of line. This will affect the handling and stability of the motorcycle, especially when cornering. In addition it can cause increased tyre wear.

What is a possible cause of a badly aligned rear wheel? AM0034RU19

Incorrect refitting the rear wheel.

When fitting or refitting a rear wheel to a motorcycle, make sure that it is aligned precisely behind the front wheel. Failure to do so could result in uneven tyre wear and/or instability when cornering.

What could happen if the steering head bearings are worn on a motorcycle? AM0035RU19

The motorcycle could be difficult to control.

The steering head bearings provide for smooth steering on a motorcycle. If they are worn, the steering becomes loose or wobbly, and the motorcycle becomes unstable and difficult to control. Immediately seek assistance from a competent person.

What would cause the steering to feel wobbly? AM0036RU19

Worn steering head bearings.

The steering head bearings provide for smooth steering on a motorcycle. If they are worn, the steering becomes loose or wobbly, and the motorcycle becomes unstable. Immediately seek assistance from a competent person.

Under what circumstances should the engine cut-out switch be used? AM0037RU19

In an emergency only.

Motorcyclists should only use the engine cut-off switch in an emergency, such as after a collision or a fall. It is important to check it periodically and make sure that it is operating properly.

Why should a motorcyclist ensure the side stand is fully raised before moving away? AM0038RU19

To avoid destabilising the motorcycle when cornering.

Use the side stand only for parking the motorcycle. Raise it fully before moving away. Riding with the side stand down is dangerous, as it may dig into the ground when cornering and cause loss of control.

When should tyre pressures be increased? AM0040RU19

When carrying a pillion passenger.

Motorcyclists may need to increase the tyre pressures on a motorcycle when carrying extra weight, such as a pillion passenger and / or luggage. Consult your owners manual for the relevant tyre pressures.

What is the minimum legal tyre tread depth for motorcycles? AM0041RU19

1.0 millimetres.

The minimum tyre tread depth for motorcycles is 1mm. However, it is advisable to replace the tyre before it wears that low to improve road holding, especially in wet weather. Some tyres have a wear indicator in the groove to show that the tyre is getting near to the minimum legal requirement.

What does the traction control system help to prevent? AM0043RU19

Wheelspin when accelerating.

A traction control system on a motorcycle helps to prevent wheelspin when accelerating. This helps the driver to maximise the grip of the rear tyre when accelerating in slippery conditions, both when moving away and on bends and corners. Be aware, that many motorcycles may not have traction controls, therefore check the vehicle handbook for further information.

In the interest of road safety, what should be kept clean on a motorcycle? AM2U19

Number plate.

Motorcyclists are responsible for keeping their motorcycles in good condition. Keeping the lights (front and rear), reflectors and number plate clean will increase your visibility to other road users. Legally, number plates need to be visible at all times.

What is a possible effect of incorrect rear wheel alignment on a motorcycle? AM3U19

Excessive tyre wear.

If the wheels are incorrectly aligned, this is where the rear wheel does not follow the same line as the front wheel . This may cause the tyre to wear excessively resulting in reduced stopping ability, motorcycle instability and more difficult handling.

Riding your motorcycle

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The questions in this section relate to the basic skills that you need to ride a motorcycle – starting and stopping the bike, moving off, adopting the appropriate position on the road, overtaking safely, taking emergency and corrective action and dealing with hazards.

Moving off

Moving off requires very fine control of the clutch lever, throttle and rear brake. Avoid jerky or sudden movements of the controls so that you don't jerk forward or cut out (stall). You also need to let each of your feet take your weight at different times. The questions below check that you understand these matters.

What should a motorcyclist check before starting the engine? AM0044R

That the gear selector is in neutral.

Before starting the engine, you should ensure that the gear selector is in neutral. This can be verified by checking that the green neutral light is showing on the instrument panel.

A motorcyclist in busy moving traffic wishes to change lanes. Why is a 'lifesaver look' required? AM0045R

The mirror may not cover blind spots.

A 'lifesaver look' is a last look to the left, right or the rear into the blind spot areas not covered by the mirrors. You should give a lifesaver look before moving off and before changing direction.

What should a motorcyclist do just before moving off from a parked position? AM0046R

Look over their shoulder for a final glance.

The final glance before moving away from the kerb is known as a 'lifesaver look'. A lifesaver look is a final look to the left, right or rear into the blind spot areas not covered by the mirrors. You should give a lifesaver look before moving off and before changing direction.

What is a 'lifesaver look'? AM0047RU19

A look over the shoulder just before moving off, turning or changing lanes.

A lifesaver look is a last look to the left, right or the rear into the blind spot area not covered by the mirrors. You should give a lifesaver look before moving off and before changing lanes or direction.

Road position

For your own safety and the safety of other road users, it is important that you adopt the correct position on the road. Where lanes are not marked, you should keep to left, but not too close to the verge or to parked cars or the pavement. If the road is wet, you should avoid splashing pedestrians and cyclists. Where lanes are marked, you should adopt a position centrally between the lane markers. If you are going to turn off to the left or right, plan ahead, so that you are in the correct lane when you arrive at the junction.

In what position should a motorcyclist have their feet when stopped at traffic lights, Stop signs or in traffic? AM0054R

The left foot down.

When stopped in traffic, you should have your left foot down to balance and your right foot on the rear brake to secure the motorcycle.

In what position should a motorcyclist have their feet when driving along in traffic? AM0055R

Both feet up.

In order to maintain proper balance and control, you should always keep your feet on the foot rests while the motorcycle is in motion.

In this traffic situation, what is the position of the motorcyclist? AM0059R

In the correct position.

The motorcyclist is in the correct position for the traffic situation. When travelling on a single carriageway road with two-way traffic, the correct position is halfway between the centre of the road and the left-hand side. However you should also consider the width of the road, the road surface, and any obstructions when riding.

When should a motorcyclist take a 'life saver' look? AM24U19

Before changing lane.

A 'life saver' look is a look over the left or right shoulder to observe the blind spot area which is not covered by the mirrors. This should be done before the motorcyclist moves off, before changing position on the road, and before making a U-turn.

On a single-lane country road, what should a motorcyclist do? AM0060RU19

Avoid the grass in the centre of the road.

When you are riding on a single-track country road, you should avoid the grass and debris that collects down the centre of the road, as this may cause instability and result in a fall.

In normal riding, what is the correct position on the road in marked lanes? AM0070RU19

Mid-way between the near side and the centre of the road.

The normal position is in the centre of the lane. On a single carriageway road with two-way traffic, the correct position is half-way between the centre of the road and the left-hand side. However, you should also take the width of the road, the condition of the road surface and any obstructions into consideration when riding.

What position should a motorcyclist take up behind a vehicle they are about to overtake? AM0072RU19

The off side of the vehicle in front.

When you intend to overtake the vehicle in front, you should position your bike to the off-side rear of the vehicle in front, leaving enough room to get a good view of the road ahead. You can then take the opportunity to overtake smoothly and safely.

When is it appropriate for a motorcyclist to take up a near-side position? AM0073RU19

When approaching a right-hand bend, to get an early view of the road ahead.

When approaching a right-hand bend, you may take up a position towards the left of the lane, so as to gain a better view of the road ahead. This generally would apply outside of special speed limit areas.

When should a motorcyclist take up a near-side position? AM0074S
In good time before turning left.

Before turning left, you should take up the near-side (left-hand side) position. This prevents other traffic from passing on your inside and enables following traffic to continue ahead or to turn right in safety.

What is the main advantage of riding in the central position, midway between the near-side edge and the centre line of the road? AM0076RU19
It gives the rider a good margin of safety on each side.

The normal position when riding on a single carriageway road with two-way traffic is half-way between the centre of the road and the left-hand side. The advantage of riding in this position is that you are more visible to other traffic, and you are in a better position to avoid potholes and road debris. It also reduces the potential for conflict with oncoming traffic.

Under what circumstances should a motorcyclist take up an off-side position? AM0078R
In good time before turning right.

Before turning right, you should take up an off-side (right-side) position. This makes you more visible to other road users and allows following traffic to pass on your inside.

When a motorcyclist is cornering, what should they do? AM0079R
Lean in the direction of the turn.

When you are cornering, you should lean towards the inside of the bend or curve. In this position, the force of gravity works to keep the bike stable. If you do not lean the bike into the curve or bend, its tendency is to continue in a straight line.

What effect does cornering at excessive speed have on a motorcycle? AM0080RU19
The motorcycle is less stable.

Cornering at speed reduces the stability of the bike and places extra demands on tyre grip. These effects increase with the severity of the bend, and the speed and weight of the bike.

How should a motorcyclist safely approach a bend? AM0082RU19
At the correct speed.

When approaching a bend, you should take up the correct position on the road, adjust your speed and select the appropriate gear for that speed. Going through the bend, you should maintain your line and a constant speed, in order to ensure stability and maximum tyre grip. This is especially important on a road that is uneven or wet.

What should a motorcyclist ensure during cornering? AM0083RU19
That the speed is correct.

When cornering, you should maintain a correct and constant speed to ensure stability and maximum tyre grip. This is especially important on a road that is uneven or wet.

What should a motorcyclist allow for when negotiating a bend? AM7
Blind junctions or exits.

When cornering, you should expect the unexpected. A change in road conditions, such as potholes or mud on the road, or the emergence of other traffic from an exit, could lead to an incident.

What is the advantage of correct positioning while cornering? AM0085RU19
It gives a better view of the road ahead.

The advantage of taking up the correct position while cornering is that it gives you an early view of the road ahead through the bend. On left-hand bends it offers increased safety margins from hazards at the side of the road, and on right-hand bends it offers increased safety margins from oncoming traffic.

What effect does cornering at speed have on a motorcycle?
Extra demands are placed on tyre grip.

AM4

Cornering at speed reduces the stability of the bike and places extra demands on tyre grip. These effects increase with the severity of the bend, and the speed and weight of the bike.

How should a motorcyclist approach a bend?
In the correct position.

AM5U19

When approaching a bend, you should take up the correct position on the road, adjust your speed and select the appropriate gear for that speed. Going through the bend, you should maintain your line and a constant speed, in order to ensure stability and maximum tyre grip. This is especially important on a road that is uneven or wet.

How should a motorcyclist approach a bend?
In the correct gear.

AM6U19

When approaching a bend, you should take up the correct position on the road, adjust your speed and select the appropriate gear for that speed. Going through the bend, you should maintain your line and a constant speed, in order to ensure stability and maximum tyre grip. This is especially important on a road that is uneven or wet.

How could a motorcyclist gauge the severity of a bend?
By noting the presence of signs in advance of the bend.

AM0089RU19

Most bends and corners are marked with yellow warning signs. As you enter the bend, take note of the point at which the near-side verge and the off-side verge appear to meet, and note how this point changes as you proceed through the bend. This allows you to gauge the severity of the bend and adjust your speed as required.

Why is special care required when taking bends on a motorcycle with a sidecar attached?
The extra weight makes the sidecar outfit more difficult to manoeuvre.

AM0090RU19

Special care is needed when riding a motorcycle with a sidecar attached. This is particularly the case on bends and when turning – you cannot lean the unit in the way you can with a solo motorcycle, and the unit needs to be steered with a deliberate push or pull on the handlebars. This requires considerably more effort than leaning.

Why is care required when taking a left-hand bend on a motorcycle with a sidecar attached?
The weight being thrown outwards will tend to lift the sidecar off the road.

AM0091RU19

Special care is needed when riding a motorcycle with a sidecar attached, especially when taking a left-hand bend, as the weight being thrown outwards tends to lift the sidecar off the road.

What should a motorcyclist consider before taking up position on a left-hand bend?
Whether it is necessary to alter course if the view ahead is unrestricted.

AM8U19

When approaching a left-hand bend, you should consider whether taking up the off-side position is necessary. If there is an unrestricted view of the road ahead, it may be better to maintain your central position while going through the bend.

When overtaking a slow-moving truck, what hazard might arise? AM11U19
There may be other slow moving vehicles ahead of the truck.

When you are preparing to overtake a slow-moving truck or large vehicle, there are many things to be aware of as a motorcyclist. You need to be aware not only of the vehicle ahead but also of other situations that may develop. Other road users may do something unexpected and may not always be as aware as they should be of a riders presence.

When overtaking a slow-moving truck, what hazard might arise? AM12
The driver of a vehicle on a road to your left up ahead is turning right and is unaware of your presence.

When you are preparing to overtake a slow-moving truck or large vehicle, there are many things to be aware of as a motorcyclist. You need to be aware not only of the vehicle ahead but also of other situations that may develop. Other road users may do something unexpected and may not always be as aware as they should be of a rider's presence.

When overtaking a slow-moving truck, what hazard might arise? AM13U19
A vehicle may turn left from a junction on the right up ahead.

When you are preparing to overtake a slow-moving truck or large vehicle, there are many things to be aware of as a motorcyclist. You need to be aware not only of the vehicle ahead but also of other situations that may develop. Other road users may do something unexpected and may not always be as aware as they should be of a riders presence.

A motorcyclist has moved closer to the vehicle in front prior to overtaking it. What should they be most aware of? AM14U19
The driver in front may brake suddenly.

As you approach the vehicle in front prior to overtaking it, you should be aware that you will have less time to react if the driver in front accelerates, slows or brakes suddenly. You should therefore assess all the hazards on the road ahead before taking up this position, and if the overtaking opportunity does not arise you should fall back to a safe following distance.

A motorcyclist has moved closer to the vehicle in front prior to overtaking it. What should they be most aware of? AM15U19
The driver in front may turn right suddenly.

As you approach the vehicle in front prior to overtaking it, you should be aware that you will have less time to react if the driver in front accelerates, slows or brakes suddenly. You should therefore assess all the hazards on the road ahead before taking up this position, and if the overtaking opportunity does not arise you should fall back to a safe following distance.

Taking emergency/corrective action

When riding a bike, you need to always expect the unexpected. You literally don't know what's around the next bend, but you can avoid some dangerous situations by developing your observation skills and learning to anticipate danger. Even the best and safest motorcyclists, however, will have to make emergency stops from time to time. The quicker you respond to a potential emergency, the more likely you are to avert it. So, keep alert and be ready.

What should a motorcyclist do if they get a sudden and severe puncture while riding? AM0101R
Close the throttle and ease to a stop.

If you get a sudden and severe puncture while riding along, you should not brake suddenly as this would cause the bike to become more unstable. You should hold the handlebars firmly, ease off the throttle, and gradually bring the bike to a safe stop at the side of the road.

How should a motorcyclist normally stop their engine? AM0102R
Turn off the ignition.

The normal sequence in stopping a motorcycle engine is as follows: Close the throttle. Engage neutral. Switch off the engine using the ignition key. Switch off the fuel tap (if fitted). If you use the ignition key to stop the engine, you are less likely to leave the key in the ignition when leaving the motorcycle. The emergency engine stop switch should be used only in an emergency.

How should a motorcyclist apply the brakes to stop quickly in an emergency? AM0103R
Use the front brake followed by the rear brake.

When braking in an emergency, you should close the throttle and apply the front brake just before the rear, and increase the brake pressure steadily. You should consider the road and weather conditions, and apply the right amount of braking to each wheel to achieve maximum effort without causing the wheels to lock up and skid.

What should a motorcyclist do if their motorcycle engine cuts out while they are riding along? AM0104R
Signal and steer the motorcycle to the side of the road.

If you are riding along and your motorcycle engine cuts out, you should check behind, signal and steer to the side of the road as soon as possible.

Dealing with hazards

A hazard is anything that means you might have to change the position, speed, or direction of your motorcycle. For example, a road feature such as a sharp bend could be a hazard, and so could the actions of other road users.

As you become more experienced as a motorcyclist and build up experience of road and traffic conditions, you will become better at scanning the road ahead to anticipate and react to the different kinds of hazard that you meet. This will help you to further develop the essential skills of observation, judgement, planning and reaction.

What should a motorcyclist do when meeting a large vehicle on a narrow road? AM0107R

Slow down and proceed with caution.

If you meet a large vehicle on a narrow road, you should slow down and move to the left, provided it is safe to do so. You should also be prepared for other vehicles that may be hidden behind the approaching vehicle.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of when meeting a large vehicle on a narrow road? AM0108RU19

Forward visibility is reduced.

If you meet a large vehicle on a narrow road, you should slow down and move to the left, provided it is safe to do so. You should also be prepared for other vehicles that may be hidden behind the approaching vehicle.

What hazard should a motorcyclist be aware of in this situation? AM0110R

Wet road surface.

You should exercise caution when travelling on wet roads. Allow extra time for slowing or stopping, as tyre grip will be reduced. Take extra care when braking or cornering on wet surfaces.

In this situation, what does the motorcyclist need to consider? AM0114RU19

Being blown off course by wind turbulence from the oncoming truck.

When riding in the off-side position, you should be aware of any oncoming vehicles, especially those travelling near or over the centre of the road. You should also be prepared for wind turbulence created by large vehicles coming towards you at high speed.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of on approaching an automated railway crossing? AM16U19

The barrier may come down.

Approach railway crossings with caution. Reduce speed and be prepared to stop if necessary. Be prepared for changes in the road surface. The tracks might not be at the same level as the road. Be aware also that the tracks and any road markings may be slippery in wet conditions.

Weather conditions

On a motorcycle, you are much more exposed to the weather than drivers of cars or trucks, and you are much more likely to be destabilised or put off course by bad weather. Any kind of weather that makes it more difficult for you to see what's happening on the road (and makes it more difficult for other road users to see you) presents particular riding challenges, especially while you are learning. Rain, fog, snow, ice, high winds, and even bright sunshine can present hazards that you must be prepared for. The questions in this section deal with your ability to meet these challenges.

What should a motorcyclist do while riding through a flood? AM0117RU19

Keep the engine revolutions high.

Approach flooded areas with caution. If the flood water appears too deep, find an alternative route. If it appears shallow enough to safely pass, ride through in a low gear and keep the engine revolutions high in order to prevent water entering the exhaust. Before continuing the journey, test the brakes two or three times to ensure they are working before proceeding.

Having gone through floods, how should a motorcyclist dry the brakes? AM0118RU19

Ride the motorcycle slowly while gently applying the brakes.

After riding the motorcycle through a flooded area and before proceeding on. When it is safe to do so, both brakes should be tested by gently applying them a few times at a slow speed until dry and normal braking is restored.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of when there is melting tar on the road? AM0119RU19

Melting tar may reduce tyre grip.

In very hot weather, tarmac road surfaces can become soft. When this happens, motorcyclists should reduce speed and take extra care when braking and cornering as tyre grip will be reduced.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of when there is melting tar on the road? AM0120RU19

Melting tar may increase stopping distances.

In very hot weather, tarmac road surfaces can become soft. When this happens, motorcyclists should reduce speed and take extra care when braking and cornering as tyre grip will be reduced.

What should motorcyclists do when riding in windy conditions? AM0121RU19

Look ahead and anticipate crosswinds.

In strong winds, motorcyclists can become more vulnerable. They should slow down and try to anticipate where crosswinds are most likely to affect the motorcylce, such as when passing gaps in roadside hedges or between tall buildings, or on exposed roads and high bridges or flyovers. Be aware that the winds might also affect other road users, such as pedestrians, cyclists and high-sided vehicles.

How would a motorcyclist know if there was black ice on the road? AM0122RU19

Tyre noise will decrease.

Black ice can be virtually invisible or look like a sheet of water, and so presents a particular hazard for motorcyclists. In wintry conditions, if a noticed reduction in tyre noise or if the steering becomes lighter, motorcyclists should suspect that there may be black ice on the road. They should adjust to the conditions by slowing down, allowing up to ten times the normal stopping distance and ensuring all controls are operated smoothly and gently. If necessary consider a safer mode of transport.

What in particular should a motorcyclist be aware of when travelling in hot weather and the tar on the road is melting and soft? AM25U19

Stopping distances are increased.

Motorcyclists should be aware that in very hot weather, tarmac road surfaces can become soft and tyre grip is reduced. When this happens, motorcyclists should take extra care cornering and allow more time when braking.

Keeping your distance

At all times, you must make sure to stay a safe distance from the vehicle in front of you, and be satisfied that you can stop within the distance that you can see to be clear.

Why should a motorcyclist stay well back from the vehicle in front while riding? AM0125RU19

It allows the rider a safer stopping distance.

In normal conditions, motorcyclists should maintain at least a two-second gap from the vehicle in front, and more in poor conditions. This gap gives them sufficient room to brake safely in the event that the vehicle in front slows or changes direction suddenly. It also allows the motorcyclist to see the road in front of the vehicle ahead.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of when following close behind a larger vehicle? AM0127RU19

The motorcyclist will be in the blind spot of the driver of the vehicle in front.

Motorcyclists should stay well back from larger vehicles in order to see and be seen more clearly. If the motorcyclist rides too close, the driver of the large vehicle may not be aware that they are there. The motorcyclist will also be hidden from the view of oncoming traffic and their view of the road ahead may be obstructed.

What should a motorcyclist do if they are following a heavy goods vehicle and an overtaking car pulls into the gap between them and the vehicle in front? AM0128RU19

Ease back to regain a safe distance.

Motorcyclists should always maintain a safe distance between themselves and any vehilces ahead. If another vehicle overtakes you and pulls into this gap, you should slow down and restore the safer gap to the vehicle in front. In normal conditions this should be a two second gap, in wet or adverse conditions motorcyclists need to allow at least a four-second gap to the vehicle in front. In snow or icy conditions this should increase to ten times the normal distance.

What should a motorcyclist be aware of when following close behind a larger vehicle? AM18U19

The motorcyclist will be less visible to oncoming traffic.

If a motorcyclist rides too close behind a large vehicle, the driver of that vehicle infront may not be aware that you are there. The motorcyclist will also be hidden from the view of oncoming traffic.

Which of these has an effect on the stopping distance of a motorcycle? AM19U19

Tyre condition.

Worn or improperly inflated tyres reduce the grip of your tyres on the road, with the result that your motorcycle may skid during an emergency stop. Routinely check the condition of your tyres and check that they are correctly inflated to ensure effective grip of the road. The minimum legal tread depth on a motorcycle tyre is 1mm however make sure you replace tyres before they become this worn.

Which of these has an effect on the stopping distance of a motorcycle? AM20U19

Road conditions.

Road surfaces that are wet, icy or loose reduce tyre grip, and extend your stopping distance considerably. At 80km/h on a good dry road, stopping distance is typically 52 metres, whereas on a wet road this increases to 81 metres.

Braking and stopping

While you are learning to ride, one of the most important skills you need to master is how to slow down, brake and bring your bike to a stop. Your bike has front and rear brakes and you need to learn how to use them individually and together.

When motorcycling, when should the rear brake of a motorcycle be used on its own? AM0129RU19

During slow manoeuvres.

Under normal circumstances, motorcyclists should apply the front brake just before the rear brake. The front brake is considerably more powerful than the rear. However when travelling at very slow speeds or performing slow manoeuvres, using the rear brake alone can result in smoother control and improved stability. Many modern motorcycles have linked braking systems which can mean that when one lever is pressed it operates both brakes. Motorcyclists should use the vehicles handbook to familiarise themselves with the safe operation of the vehicle controls.

When should a motorcyclist avoid using the front brake? AM0130RU19

When the motorcycle is banked over or when turning.

Motorcyclists should avoid using the front brake while banked over in bends, while turning at a junction, and on loose surfaces. Using the front brake in these situations can cause the motorcycle to straighten up in the road and go straight on, or cause loss of control. If at all possible avoid braking on a bend, however if the motorcyclist must brake on a bend, gently use the rear brake.

What should a motorcyclists do to help maintain stability when their motorcycle is banked over? AM0131RU19

Maintain consistent drive.

It is important for motorcyclists to maintain stability when banked over or cornering, they do this by maintaining a consistent drive. Applying either brake or pulling in the clutch whilst cornering disrupts the drive reducing stability of the motorcycle, resulting in potential loss of control.

What should a motorcyclist do when descending a long, steep hill? AM0132RU19

Engage a lower gear at an early stage.

When descending a long steep hill, motorcyclists should use engine braking to help maintain a steady speed. Changing down to a lower gear increases the effect of the engine braking. This reduces wear on the brakes, and helps ensure that they do not overheat and that they are more effective when needed.

What should a motorcyclist do when descending a long, steep and winding road? AM0133RU19

Use the brakes periodically on the straight only.

When descending a long, steep and winding road it is essential that motorcyclists maintain control over their speed by the safe use of the braking system. This includes using a combination of engine braking and the normal braking when upright and in a straight line. On approach to bends brake early and complete braking before the bend. Braking in a bend can cause the bike to straighten up and possible loss of control.

When should a motorcyclist brake firmly? AM0134RU19

When travelling in a straight line.

It is always safer to brake when travelling upright in a straight line. Motorcyclists should avoid braking on bends, and always adjust their braking to suit the road conditions. On approach to bends brake early and complete braking before the bend. Braking in a bend can cause the bike to straighten up and possible loss of control.

When riding in normal conditions how should a motorcyclist apply both brakes to come to a complete stop? AM0136RU19

Apply the front brake followed by the rear.

To stop safely in good weather and road conditions, motorcyclists should in general apply the front brake followed by the rear. More pressure should be applied to the front, as this gives the best stopping power. Many modern motorcycles have linked braking systems which can mean that when one lever is pressed it operates both brakes. Motorcyclists should use the vehicles handbook to familiarise themselves with the safe operation of the vehicle controls. In wet conditions, equal pressure should be applied to both brakes.

How should braking force be distributed when stopping a motorcycle on a straight road in dry conditions? AM0137RU19

Apply slightly more pressure to the front.

To stop safely in dry road conditions requires different operation of the brakes than in wet conditions. In dry conditions, generally more pressure should be applied to the front brake, as this gives the best stopping power and grip under braking. Many modern motorcycles have linked braking systems which can mean that when one lever is pressed it operates both brakes. Motorcyclists should use the vehicles handbook to familiarise themselves with the safe operation of the vehicle controls. In wet conditions, equal pressure should be applied to both brakes.

How should braking force be distributed when stopping a motorcycle on a straight road in wet or slippery conditions? AM0138RU19

Apply the same amount of pressure to both brakes.

To stop safely in wet conditions requires different operation of the brakes than in dry conditions. When braking in wet conditions, equal pressure should be applied to both brakes. Many modern motorcycles have linked braking systems which can mean that when one lever is pressed it operates both brakes. Motorcyclists should use the vehicles handbook to familiarise themselves with the safe operation of the vehicle controls.

Which of these has an effect on stopping distance? AM0139RU19

The speed of the motorcycle.

Speed affects the stopping distance of a motorcycle. In general the RSA recommend that at 50km/h in dry conditions, plan for a minimum stopping distance of 25 metres, whereas at 100km/h this increases to 70 metres or more.

What effect has a sidecar on the stopping distance of a motorcycle? AM0140RU19

It increases stopping distance, especially going downhill.

Motorcyclists using a side car should allow for increased stopping distance than when driving without, as the extra weight of the sidecar increases the stopping distance, especially going downhill.

What is the stopping distance of a vehicle travelling at 80km/h on a good dry road? AM0141R

53 metres.

When travelling at 80km/h in good dry conditions, stopping distance is approximately 53 metres. This is made up of 15m reaction distance and 38 metres braking distance.

Which of these has an effect on stopping distance? AM0143RU19

Reaction time.

Stopping distance is the sum of reaction distance and braking distance. Reaction time is the time it takes to perceive the hazard and perform a reaction to that hazard. For example apply the brake. Reaction time can be negatively affected by age, alcohol, drugs, fatigue, state of health and mental condition.

Stability and skidding

The most common cause of a skid is going too fast for the road conditions, or jerky braking, gear changing or steering. You can reduce the likelihood of skidding by riding smoothly at an appropriate speed, and by keeping your distance from the vehicle in front. Be particularly careful when approaching bends, especially those on a downslope. Don't rely on your ABS to prevent you from skidding – it won't always do so.

What might cause a rider to lose control of a motorcycle? AM0144RU19

Water on the road.

Motorcyclists are more likely to skid or lose control in bad weather conditions, when road surfaces tend to be more slippery. They should be on the alert for wet surfaces, mud or gravel, and wet leaves on the road. These conditions will be more hazardous near bends or at junctions where motorcyclists may need to brake, accelerate or change direction. In such conditions, motorcyclists should slow down and allow extra time to react adverse road conditions.

What effect could riding along tram tracks have on a motorcycle? AM0145RU19

it could destabilise the motorcycle.

Motorcyclists should ride along or cross train or tram tracks with caution, especially when turning. The tracks may not be at the same level as the road, and the motorcycle may lose stability while following or crossing the tracks.

What typically happens when a rider applies both brakes at the same time but with the greatest pressure on the rear? AM0149RU19

The rear wheel may lock.

When a motorcyclist applies the brakes on their motorcycle, their weight and that of the motorcycle shift forward onto the front wheel, and the weight on the rear wheel is reduced. If too much braking force is applied to the rear wheel at this stage, it may lock up, causing a skid and/or serious lack of control. Under normal conditions, the front brake should be applied first, followed by the rear, with the greater pressure on the front.

What should a motorcyclist do if the throttle sticks open while they are moving?

Operate the electric cut-out switch.

AM0150RU19

In an emergency situation, such as the throttle sticking open, a motorcyclist should use their electric cut-out switch (Kill switch / Emergency engine stop) to stop the engine and bring the motorcycle safely to a halt. This switch may also be used to stop the engine after a collision or a fall.

What is a possible effect of riding over road markings such as lines and directional arrows?

Tyre grip may be reduced, particularly in wet weather.

AM0151RU19

It is important that motorcyclists are aware that the paint used in the road markings can be slippery, especially in wet weather. Where possible, Motorcyclists should try to avoid riding over these markings.

What would be the result of excessive use of mirrors or frequently looking behind?

Ability to read the road ahead would be impaired.

AM0154RU19

Motorcyclists should read the road ahead and react accordingly. Using the mirrors excessively or looking behind excessively will distract focus from the road in front and may extend reaction times.

What can a motorcyclist do to reduce the risk of skidding?

Accelerate gently.

AM0155RU19

Excessive acceleration can cause the front wheel of the motorcycle to lift from the road or cause the rear wheel to spin. Each of these causes a loss of stability and may lead to the motorcycle going out of control or skidding. Always use gentle controlled acceleration.

What effect does spilt diesel have on a road?

It makes the road more slippery.

ABMW0402R

Diesel spilt on the road can make the road surface extremely slippery, particularly if the road is wet.

What should a motorcyclist do to avoid skidding?

AM0157RU19

Avoid using the front brake when the motorcycle is banked over.

As motorcycles have less tyre contact on the road than other vehicles, motorcyclists should always brake in a controlled manner. Avoid using the front brake when the machine is banked over in order to reduce the risk of skidding. It is always safer to brake when travelling upright in a straight line. Motorcyclists should avoid braking on bends, and always adjust their braking to suit the road conditions. On approach to bends, brake early and complete braking before the bend. Braking in a bend can cause the bike to straighten up and possible loss of control.

What action should a motorcyclist take if the rear wheel skids under acceleration on wet surfaces?

AM0159RU19

Ease off the throttle.

Motorcyclists should take care when accelerating in wet conditions. Too much acceleration can cause the rear wheel to skid, with the risk that you will lose control of the motorcycle. If the rear wheel does start to skid, ease off the throttle to reduce the power going to the rear wheel until full control has been re-established.

What might cause a rider to lose control of a motorcycle?

Wet leaves on the road.

AM21U19

Motorcyclists are more likely to skid or lose control of their motorcycle in bad weather conditions, when road surfaces tend to be more slippery. They should be on the alert for wet surfaces, mud or gravel, and wet leaves on the road. These conditions will be more hazardous near bends or at junctions where they may need to brake, accelerate or change direction.

What might cause a rider to lose control of a motorcycle?

Mud on the road.

AM22U19

Motorcyclists are more likely to skid or lose control of their motorcycle in bad weather conditions, when road surfaces tend to be more slippery. They should be on the alert for wet surfaces, mud or gravel, and wet leaves on the road. These conditions will be more hazardous near bends or at junctions where they may need to brake, accelerate or change direction.

Alert driving and consideration for other road users

You need to be fully alert when you are riding a motorcycle, so don't ride when you are very tired. Tiredness is a factor in many road collisions.

You should also behave with consideration and courtesy towards other road users, including pedestrians, cyclists, motorists and drivers of larger vehicles.

How other drivers see you

As a motorcycle rider, you must constantly bear in mind that you are not as visible to other road users as, for example, cars, trucks or buses. You must try to make sure that you avoid situations that put your own life or that of other road users in danger.

What in particular should a motorcyclist be aware of when approaching a junction from which a vehicle is emerging? AM0160RU19

The driver of the emerging vehicle may not have seen the motorcyclist.

Junctions are particularly hazardous for motorcyclists because of their narrow profile. This makes them more difficult to see and caution should therefore be taken when approaching junctions. In addition, many drivers do not take proper observations when emerging from a side road, and may fail to notice a motorcyclist. Motorcyclists should bear this in mind when approaching junctions with side roads. They should increase their own visibility by wearing full high viz clothing and have headlamp/s on at all times.

What in particular should a motorcyclist be aware of when approaching a side road? AM23U19

Drivers of emerging vehicles may not see the motorcyclist.

As a vulnerable road user a motorcyclist should pay particular attention when approaching side roads as the drivers of emerging vehicles may not have seen them. If in doubt, slow down and try to make eye contact with the driver. Motorcyclists should always ride defensively and be prepared to stop if necessary.

What in particular should a motorcyclist be aware of when travelling on a dual carriageway? AM0161RU19

Other vehicles may change lane without checking their blind spots.

When travelling on a dual carriageway, motorcyclists should read the road ahead and be prepared for the possibility that other traffic may change lane quickly without making proper observations or giving adequate warning.

What in particular should a motorcyclist be aware of when following a large truck or bus? AM0162RU19

Vehicles emerging from side roads may not see the motorcycle behind the larger vehicle.

When on a motorcycle following behind a large truck or bus, motorcyclists will not be easily visible to motorists emerging from side roads. Always read the road ahead and allow plenty of space between the motorcycle and the vehicle in front. Motorcyclists should bear this in mind and stay well back when approaching junctions with side roads. They should increase their own visibility by wearing full high viz clothing and have headlamp/s on at all times.

In general, how can a motorcyclist make other road users more aware of their presence on the road? AM0164RU19

Avoid travelling in the drivers of other vehicles' blind spots.

Motorcyclists should always try to make other road users aware of their presence on the road. Where possible, avoid travelling in other road users blind spots. Motorcyclists should bear this in mind and postition themselves for maximum visbibilty. They should increase their own visibility by wearing full high viz clothing and have headlamp/s on at all times.

In general, how can a motorcyclist make other road users more aware of their presence on the road? AM0165RU19

By riding in a position where they can be seen and keeping a good distance from other traffic.

Motorcyclists should always try to make other road users aware of their presence on the road. Where possible, avoid travelling in other road users blind spots. Motorcyclists should bear this in mind and postition themselves for maximum visbibilty. They should increase their own visibility by wearing full high viz clothing and have headlamp/s on at all times.

See and be seen

High hedges and the winding nature of country roads can impair visibility – blind corners, sharp bends and dips in the road can be particularly dangerous. You should always adjust your speed to suit the road you are driving on and you must never exceed the speed limit. In many cases, a safe speed might be much less than the stated speed limit for the road. You need to be able to stop the bike in the road space that you can see – if you can't, you're going too fast.

You should also make sure that other road users can see you.

When travelling on a national road what should a motorcyclist do to improve their ability to see in very heavy rain? AM0166RU19

Reduce speed.

In heavy rain visibility may be poor due to water build up on the outside of the visor. Motorcyclists should therefore reduce speed as this provides additional time to see and react to changes in road and traffic conditions.

What should a motorcyclist do to improve their visibility to other road users? AM0167RU19

Wear reflective and fluorescent material.

Motorcyclists should always try to make other road users aware of their presence on the road. Visibility can be increased by wearing full high viz clothing and have headlamp/s on at all times.

What should a motorcyclist do to improve their visibility to other road users? AM0168RU19

Drive with a dipped headlamp on.

Motorcyclists should always try to make other road users aware of their presence on the road. Visibility can be increased by riding with headlamp/s on at all times. In addition, wearing full high viz clothing and positioning the motorcycle correctly on the road can also improve the motorcyclists visiblity to other road users.

Under what circumstances should a motorcyclist take a 'life saver' look? AM0170RU19

Before making a U-Turn.

A 'life saver' look is the last look over the left and/or right shoulder to check the blind spot area which is not covered by the mirrors to ensure nothing unexpected is happening before carrying out a manoeuvre. As vulnerable road users, motorcyclists should carry out this check before moving off, before making a significant change to their positioning on the road, and before making a U-turn.

What final checks should a motorcyclist make just before making a U-Turn? AM0171RU19

Take a 'life saver' look and check the road is clear in both directions.

A 'life saver' look is the last look over the left and/or right shoulder to check the blind spot area which is not covered by the mirrors to ensure nothing unexpected is happening before carrying out a manoeuvre. As vulnerable road users, motorcyclists should carry out this check before moving off, before making a significant change to their positioning on the road, and before making a U-turn.

Under what circumstances should a motorcyclist take a 'life saver' look to check for other traffic? AM0172RU19

Before changing direction.

A 'life saver' look is the last look over the left and/or right shoulder to check the blind spot area which is not covered by the mirrors to ensure nothing unexpected is happening before carrying out a manoeuvre. As vulnerable road users, motorcyclists should carry out this check before moving off, before making a significant change in direction, and before making a U-turn.

When riding a motorcycle around a bend on an unlit road at night with no oncoming traffic, which light should a motorcyclist use? AM0174RU19

Full beam headlight.

On an unlit road at night, motorcyclists should use their main beam headlight to help them see and be seen. Using main beam on approach to a bend helps unseen oncoming traffic to become aware of the motorcyclists presence earlier. However they should then use dipped headlights when they become aware of approaching traffic or pedestrians on the road.

Under what circumstances should a motorcyclist use main beam headlamps? AM0175RU19

When riding on unlit roads at night.

Motorcyclists should use main-beam headlamp when riding on unlit roads at night so that they can see and be seen by other road users. When you have the full beam light on, a blue warning light is shown on the instrument panel. Remember to switch back to dipped headlamps when meeting other road users.

What lights must be shown by a motorcyclist at night? AM0180RU19

Head lamp, red rear lamp, number-plate light and red rear reflector.

On a moped or motorcycle, a rider is legally required to have a white or yellow head lamp, a red rear light, a number plate light and a red rear reflector. These should be checked regularly and kept clean. This will help to ensure that the rider can be seen at night.

What should a motorcyclist do when travelling on a main road with traffic emerging from side roads who may not see the motorcycle? AM0176RU19

Look well ahead and read the road.

When travelling along a road that has many junctions with emerging traffic, motorcyclists should read the road ahead, anticipate and be prepared to react to any vehicle which may turn into their path. Always adjust your speed to suit the road and traffic conditions.

When riding on a main road, a motorcyclist sees a vehicle emerging from a side road into their path. What actions should the rider take? AM0177RU19

Slow down and be prepared to stop.

When travelling along a road, and a vehicle is emerging from a side road motorcyclists should slow down and be prepared to stop. Motorcyclists should always read the road ahead, anticipate and be prepared to react to any vehicle which may turn into their path.

What should a motorcyclist be more aware of when riding a higher powered motorcycle? AM0178RU19

They may have the impression that they are travelling slower than they actually are.

Powerful motorbikes tend to be quiet, produce little vibration and go fast without straining the engine. On such a bike, motorcyclists are at higher risks as they may gain speed without realising it and find themselves in a situation that they cannot control.

What should a motorcyclist do before changing lanes from left to right? AM0179RU19

Mirror, indicate and give 'life saver' look to the right.

Before changing from the left lane to the right lane, it is essential that motorcyclists use mirror-signal-manoeuvre routine to check that is is safe to proceed. To do this, they should check their mirrors, indicate and give a 'life saver' look to the right to make sure that it is safe

Bad roads, bad weather and bad times of day

As a motorcyclist, you are particularly vulnerable on uneven road surfaces, in bad weather and in poor lighting conditions. You must learn to deal with these hazards by adjusting your style of driving, and particularly by lowering your speed so that you can react safely and in good time to any changes in road or traffic conditions.

What lights should a motorcycle show if broken down at night on an unlit road? AM0181RU19

A white light to the front and a red light to the rear.

If a motorcycle is parked/ broken down on an unlit road at night, it creates a potential danger for other road users. It is the riders responsibility to ensure that their motorcycle can be seen, so they should switch on their vehicles parking lights (white to the front and red to the rear). On most motorcycles, this can be done by turning the key another click past the lock position on the ignition switch, after which the key can be removed.

How can strong winds affect a motorcyclist? AM0182

They can blow the motorcyclist off course.

A sudden gust of wind can blow a motorcyclist off course, especially in cross winds. Take extra care in windy conditions, as there is a danger that you will be blown into the path of other vehicles.

What should a motorcyclist do when travelling in fog? AM0183RU19

Slow down, use dipped headlight and keep to the centre of the driving lane.

When travelling in fog, motorcyclists should use their dipped headlamp/s and maintain a position in the centre of their lane. Avoid using main beam headlamps as this will reduce visibility. Maintaining a central position allows the motorcyclist to better react to situations in low visibility conditions. Drive with extreme caution and be prepared to react and respond to changes in road or traffic conditions. In addition, motorcyclists should ensure that all lights are working at all times.

What in particular should a motorcyclist be aware of when travelling in hot weather and the tar on the road is melting and soft? AM0184RU19

Tyre grip is reduced as the road surface softens.

In very hot weather, tarmac road surfaces can become soft. When this happens, motorcyclists should reduce speed and take extra care when braking and cornering, as tyre grip will be reduced.

Bright sunlight can make it difficult for other road users to see what? AM0185R

The indicators on a motorcycle.

In bright sunlight, a motorcycle's brake lights and indicators might not be clearly seen. In such circumstances, you should consider giving a clear hand signal to inform other road users of your intentions.

Scope of the motorcycle driving licences and learner permits

The questions in this section deal with what is allowed and what is not allowed by the various categories of motorcycle driving licence and learner permit.

Under what circumstances may the holder of a motorcycle learner permit carry a pillion passenger? AM0186RU19

Under no circumstances is this permitted.

It is against the law for the holder of a motorcycle learner permit to carry a pillion passenger at any time. As vulnerable road users, motorcyclists must not carry pillion passengers until they have completed the IBT initial basic training, passed the practical driving test and obtained their full driving licence for the category of motorcycle being used.

What is the maximum engine cubic capacity of the motorcycle that the holder of a category A1 driving licence may ride? AM0187RU19

125cc.

The holder of a category A1 driving licence is restricted to riding motorcycles not exceeding 125cc. This is in addition to any restrictions relating to engine power and power to weight ratio.

What is the maximum engine power of a motorcycle that may be ridden by a person holding a category A1 licence? AM0194U19

11 kilowatts.

A category A1 driving licence limits the holder to riding motorcycles with a maximum engine power output of 11 kilowatts. This is in addition to any restrictions relating to cubic capacity and power to weight ratio.

What is the minimum engine capacity that a motorcycle must have in order to travel on a motorway? AM0204U19

50cc

To travel on a motorway, a motorcycle must have an engine capacity of 50cc or more and be capable of travelling at least 50 km/h.

Other drivers and passengers

The questions in this section deal mainly with carrying pillion passengers legally and safely.

Under what circumstances may a child be allowed to ride a motorcycle in a public place? AM0195R

Never.

The minimum age at which a motorcycle can be ridden in a public place is 16. A motorcycle learner permit cannot be issued to anyone under this age.

How should a motorcyclist maintain their balance while carrying a pillion passenger on the motorcycle? AM0196RU19

Instruct the pillion passenger to lean over on bends in the same direction as the rider.

In order to maintain proper balance and control of your motorcycle when carrying a passenger, you should advise the passenger to lean the same way as you do when travelling around bends.

How should a motorcyclist maintain their balance while carrying a pillion passenger on the motorcycle? AM0197RU19

Instruct the pillion passenger to lean over in the same direction as the rider.

In order to maintain proper balance and control of your motorcycle when carrying a passenger, you should advise the passenger to lean the same way as you do when travelling around bends.

Under what circumstances is a pillion passenger allowed to sit sideways on a motorcycle? AM0199U19

Never.

Passengers should always sit on a motorcycle facing forward with both feet on the footrests.

Environmental impact of motorcycling

The motor industry is making substantial efforts to reduce the environmental damage caused by driving. Modern cars and motorcycles are generally much more efficient in their use of fuel, have lower greenhouse gas emissions, and cause less pollution.

As individual motorcyclists, we can also do quite a lot to reduce our personal carbon footprint and to minimise the impact our road use has on the environment.

What would be the effect of taking the exhaust off a motorcycle? AM0200

Noise and smoke pollution would increase.

The exhaust is fitted to an engine to control noise and smoke pollution. If it is removed, noise and smoke pollution is increased. The performance of the engine is also affected.

Which of the following is the environmentally friendly way to dispose of motorcycle waste engine oil? RSA01013

Bring it to a specialist waste disposal facility.

Waste engine oil is regarded as hazardous waste and you should only disposed of it by bringing it to a specialist waste disposable facility where it will be disposed of in an environmentally friendly manner.

Getting off the motorcycle

In general, you should get off the bike on the left side – this means that you will be on the side away from other traffic. When dismounting, pay attention to the difference in level between the road and the kerb, and be careful of slippery underfoot surfaces – such as loose gravel.

What is the final action a motorcyclist should do just before dismounting from a motorcycle? AM0201U19

Look behind to make sure it is safe.

The final action a motorcyclist should perform before dismounting the motorcycle is to always look behind to check for other road users and to ensure it is safe dismount. In general, they should dismount on the near-side (left side), away from traffic.

What should a motorcyclist do before a passenger dismounts from the motorcycle?

Look behind to make sure it is safe. AM0203U19

The final action a motorcyclist should perform before they or their passenger dismounts from the motorcycle is to always look behind to check for other road users and to ensure it is safe dismount. In general, they should dismount on the near-side (left side), away from traffic.

What should a motorcyclist do after overtaking a large vehicle on a motorway?

Check the left-hand mirror, signal, and move in to the left when it is safe to do so. AM0205U19

When you have overtaken a larger vehicle, Motorcyclists should check their mirror and signal, then make sure that it is safe to move back in to the left by checking mirrors once more, ensuring that they leave sufficient room for the larger vehicle.

Why should a motorcyclist dismount a motorcycle from the left side?

Because that side is usually away from passing traffic. RSA01012U19

For your own safety you should always dismount from a motorcycle on the left side as that is the side away from passing traffic.

Who is responsible for ensuring a pillion passenger is wearing a properly fitted crash helmet when travelling on a motorcycle? RSA01014

The rider.

It is the responsibility of the rider to make certain the passenger is wearing a properly fitted crash helmet.

All the questions in the Driver Theory Test – with all the right answers.

If you intend driving either a motorcycle, moped, car, tractor, or works vehicle in Ireland you must pass a Driver Theory Test before obtaining your learner permit. Further information on the steps involved is available on Pages 8 & 9 of this book.

This book contains all the questions you could be asked in a Driver Theory Test, together with the correct answers and a brief explanation.

You can book your Driver Theory Test or obtain information in the following ways:

Online
www.theorytest.ie

Phone (Locall rate)
1890 606 106 (English)
1890 606 806 (Gaeilge)

Post
Pick up an application form from your National Driver Licence Service (NDLS) or download it from www.theorytest.ie. Post the completed form to:

The Driver Theory Testing Service,
PO Box 15,
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